

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
FAMILY LAW DIVISION

CASE NO.: 2024-DR-001150 **DIVISION:** A

IN RE: THE MARRIAGE OF:

SARAH HANSON, Petitioner/Wife,

and

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, Respondent/Husband.

**RESPONDENT/HUSBAND'S REQUEST FOR JUDICIAL NOTICE OF RELATED
PROCEEDINGS UNDER §§ 90.201–90.204, FLA. STAT., AND OF EVIDENTIARY
IMPLICATIONS UNDER § 90.803(18)(b), FLA. STAT. (ADOPTIVE ADMISSION BY
SILENCE / TACIT HEARSAY)**

Respondent/Husband, **CHRISTOPHER HANSON**, appearing self-represented, pursuant to sections 90.201–90.204, Florida Statutes, respectfully requests that the Court take judicial notice of the records of related proceedings identified below, and of the evidentiary implications of those records under § 90.803(18)(b), Florida Statutes (adoptive admission by silence). In support, Respondent states as follows:

I. INTRODUCTION

1. The records identified in this Request are records of other Florida tribunals and of the Florida Bar's regulatory proceedings, all of which bear directly on issues set for hearing in this case. They are records of which the Court may take judicial notice under § 90.202, Florida Statutes — specifically, “[r]ecords of any court of this state” (§ 90.202(6)) and “[t]he official actions of the legislative, executive, and judicial departments of the United States and of any state” (§ 90.202(5)).
2. Section 90.204(1), Florida Statutes, provides that “[w]hen a court determines upon its own motion that judicial notice of a matter should be taken or when a party requests such notice and shows good cause for not furnishing the information necessary to comply with subsection (2), the court shall afford each party reasonable opportunity to present information relevant to the propriety of taking judicial notice.” Respondent has therefore attached copies of, previously provided, or offered accurate references to, each item identified below so that the Court and Petitioner have a complete record on which to evaluate this Request.
3. Furthermore, because Respondent is furnishing the underlying records as Exhibits 1-38 to this Request — with source, case number, date, and pinpoint references identified in the attached Exhibit Index — and is contemporaneously serving

Petitioner with notice of this Request through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal, the conditions of § 90.203, Florida Statutes, are also satisfied. Section 90.203 provides that “[a] court *shall* take judicial notice of any matter in s. 90.202 when a party: (1) Requests it and gives each adverse party such notice as the court may require to enable the adverse party to prepare to meet the request[;] [and] (2) Furnishes the court with sufficient information to enable it to take judicial notice of the matter.” Both conditions are satisfied here, and judicial notice of the records identified in Section II below is therefore compulsory rather than discretionary.

4. Respondent does not, by this Request, waive any argument and reserves all rights.

II. RECORDS OF WHICH JUDICIAL NOTICE IS REQUESTED

A. The Public-Records Mandamus Proceeding — Hillsborough County Case No. 25-CA-010255

5. Respondent has filed and is prosecuting a public-records mandamus action against the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, Judge Matthew Felix, Court Administrator Gina Justice, Mike Moore, and the Clerk of Court — captioned *Hanson v. Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court, et al.*, Case No. 25-CA-010255 (Fla. 13th Jud. Cir., Civil Div. B). That action seeks the April 4, 2025 hearing-room video recording (from a hearing in this case, in front of Judge Ayers), and judicial-branch records relating to the scheduling and conduct of the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings in this case, among other materials.
6. Two conflict judges from the 6th Circuit have independently found a *prima facie* case for the records sought despite obvious bias and unlawful judicial actions protecting the 13th Circuit from accountability and constitutional transparency:
 - a. Hon. Evan G. Frayman’s Alternative Writ entered January 13, 2026 (Doc. 47 in Case No. 25-CA-010255); and
 - b. Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman’s Alternative Writ entered February 17, 2026 (Doc. 62 in Case No. 25-CA-010255), after Judge Frayman’s disqualification.
7. The records of Case No. 25-CA-010255 — including the petition, alternative writs, responsive filings, hearing transcripts, the Orders including the one on Defendants’ Motion for Protective Order to Stay Discovery (Doc. 80), and the May 5, 2026 scheduling order (Doc. 81) — are records of which judicial notice is appropriate under § 90.202(6).

B. The Florida Bar Grievance Matters

8. Three Florida Bar grievance proceedings are directly related to the misconduct alleged in this dissolution action:
 - a. **Respondent’s Florida Bar Complaint Against Petitioner’s Counsel Scott P. Davis (RFA No. 25-6861).** Respondent filed a Florida Bar grievance complaint against attorney Scott P. Davis (FL Bar No. 115540), counsel of record for Petitioner in this case, on February 18, 2025. The complaint set forth Mr. Davis’s documented conduct in this case relating to mandatory financial disclosure under Florida Family Law Rule 12.285, the

“strategic trickle” production pattern, and child weaponization motions Respondent contends were filed for tactical purposes. The Florida Bar closed the matter without engagement with the substance.

b. The Ayers Bar Complaint Against Respondent (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)). Judge Kelly Ayers — already disqualified from this case as of April 28, 2025 — filed a Florida Bar complaint against Respondent on or about November 24, 2025. The complaint identifies no specific allegedly false statement made by Respondent; it cites vague unnamed allegations and attaches social-media screenshots. The Florida Bar’s processing file number is 2026-10,395(13F). The matter has remained pending more than six months without the Bar specifying any allegedly false statement — despite numerous requests from Respondent to all involved.

c. Respondent’s Bar Complaint Against Vivian Hodz (File No. 2026-10,601(13E)). Respondent filed a Florida Bar grievance complaint against attorney Vivian Hodz, originally docketed under Bar File No. 574643 on February 16, 2026, now processed by the Florida Bar under File No. 2026-10,601(13E). Ms. Hodz served as Respondent’s counsel during the November–December 2024 period in this case and is the subject of fact and credibility issues relevant to the retaliatory and obstructive nature of the GAL motion that the Court has set for further hearing.

C. Supporting Correspondence and Materials

9. Respondent has at all times documented his demands for specification of records and exemptions, his objections to identified conflicts, his waiver of any privilege, and the lack of substantive response from the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and the Florida Bar. Contemporaneous correspondence to the Trial Court Administrator, the Public Information Officer, and Bar Counsel — collected at the Exhibits identified in the attached Exhibit Index — documents that record.
10. The correspondence cluster expressly includes the November 24, 2025 written request-for-comment email sequence sent by Respondent that same morning to both the family-law-side recipients of record in this case, the senior administrative officials of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and the Florida Bar. The two emails, sent nine minutes apart, provided a link to a contemporaneous published article by Respondent regarding the conduct of attorneys, judges, and institutions alleged in this case and in the related public-records mandamus actions, and stated, in pertinent part: *“If you believe that anything stated in the article is untrue, please let me know so I can consider amending the article if appropriate.”* The recipients of the 10:18 a.m. EST email were Petitioner Sarah Hanson, Petitioner’s counsel of record Scott P. Davis, Family Law Division A (Judge Felix’s division), and Family Law Division D (the predecessor division). The recipients of the 10:27 a.m. EST email were senior administrative officials of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, including the Trial Court Administrator’s office inbox. The article referenced in both emails — Respondent’s *Foxes Guarding the Courthouse* — was published November 21, 2025. No recipient — neither Petitioner, nor either of the two active judicial divisions, nor any administrative official of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit or Florida Bar — provided any written response disputing, qualifying, or otherwise addressing the factual content of the article. Attorney Davis

responded with a threatening level making no specific objections to the factual narrative.

D. Hearing Transcripts in Related and Present Proceedings

11. The certified Lexitas transcript of the April 13, 2026 Zoom hearing in Case No. 25-CA-010255 before Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman (Lexitas Job No. 446278), and the certified transcript of the April 17, 2026 motions hearing in this case (2024-DR-001150) before Hon. Matthew Felix, are records of which the Court may take judicial notice under § 90.202(6) and which bear directly on the matters set for hearing in this case. The on-the-record exchanges from those proceedings are addressed in Section III below.
12. Respondent respectfully requests that the Court take judicial notice of the records identified in Sections II.A, II.B, II.C, and II.D so that this Court has a complete and accurate record of the related proceedings, and of the documented pattern of non-transparency, relevant to the matters set for hearing in this case.

III. EVIDENTIARY IMPLICATIONS: ADOPTIVE ADMISSIONS BY SILENCE UNDER § 90.803(18)(b), FLA. STAT.

A. Controlling Florida Authority

13. Section 90.803(18)(b), Florida Statutes, treats as non-hearsay “[a] statement of which the party has manifested an adoption or belief in its truth.” Where a party is on notice of a specific factual assertion that, if untrue, would naturally invite denial, and the party nevertheless fails to deny that assertion, the silence may be treated as an adoptive admission. The Florida Supreme Court has long recognized that silence in response to a written communication can constitute an adoptive admission when the circumstances are such that a denial would naturally be expected. *Sullivan v. McMillan*, 26 Fla. 543, 8 So. 450 (1890), holds that “[a] letter written by one party to a transaction to the other, giving his version of the transaction, and to which no reply is made, is admissible as an admission by silence if the circumstances are such that a denial would naturally be expected if the statements were untrue.” The rule is grounded in the relationship between the parties and the nature of the assertion. Where the recipient is in privity with the speaker, possesses direct knowledge of the facts asserted, and would naturally have responded with a denial if the assertion were false, the silence is treated as adoption.
14. The threshold elements of the rule, as restated by the Florida Supreme Court in *Globe v. State*, 877 So. 2d 663 (Fla. 2004), require: (i) the party understood the statement; (ii) the party had the ability to respond; (iii) the party would naturally have responded with a denial if the statement were false; and (iv) the party failed to do so.
15. Respondent acknowledges *Nicolaysen v. Flato*, 204 So. 2d 547 (Fla. 4th DCA 1967), which held that “the failure to reply to a letter is not an admission of the truth of its contents unless the relation between the parties is such that a reply would be expected.” *Nicolaysen* is inapposite here. In *Nicolaysen*, the letter at issue was a self-serving pre-litigation demand between arms-length commercial actors — no integrated relationship, no shared transactional facts, no judicial proceeding

underway between sender and recipient. The November 24, 2025 emails described in ¶ 10 above, by contrast, were addressed to the opposing party in this dissolution proceeding, to opposing counsel of record, to the active judicial division of this very Court (Family Law Division A), to the predecessor division (Family Law Division D), and to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit's senior administrative officials. Each recipient possessed direct, first-hand knowledge of the facts asserted, was an officer of the court or party to this proceeding or to the related mandamus, and was under both a natural impulse and an ethical duty of candor to deny any false accusation made in writing. The "relation between the parties" required by *Nicolaysen* is precisely the integrated relation present here.

B. Foundational Application to the November 24, 2025 Written Invitation to Deny

16. **Lead application.** The November 24, 2025 email sequence detailed in ¶ 10 above is offered as the foundational adoptive admission by silence under § 90.803(18)(b). Element-by-element under *Globe v. State*:

(i) Statement understood. Each email was successfully delivered to the active email addresses of record for the Petitioner, opposing counsel of record, both active and predecessor judicial divisions, and senior administrative officials of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit.

(ii) Ability to respond. No recipient was under any legal restraint or physical inability to reply. Each recipient is an attorney, judge, judicial assistant, party to the proceeding, or trained administrative official with routine access to email reply.

(iii) Natural impulse to deny. Each email expressly stated: "*If you believe that anything stated in the article is untrue, please let me know so I can consider amending the article if appropriate.*" An attorney, judge, or party who believed the article's factual content to be false would naturally — and immediately — issue a written denial to protect the record, to fulfill ethical obligations of candor, and to prevent further dissemination of an inaccurate account of a pending proceeding.

(iv) Failure to deny. No recipient provided any written response disputing, qualifying, or otherwise addressing the factual content of the article.

17. **The "didn't see it" defense is foreclosed by Judge Ayers's same-day retaliatory filing.** Respondent further submits that the only argument available to opposing parties — that the November 24, 2025 emails were not received, not read, or not appreciated — is independently foreclosed by the following undisputed timeline: the 10:18 a.m. EST email went to the family-law-side recipients in this case; the 10:27 a.m. EST email went to the administrative-side recipients within the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit; *later the same day*, November 24, 2025, Judge Kelly Ayers filed her Florida Bar grievance complaint against Respondent (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)). The temporal proximity between the formal written invitation to deny and Judge Ayers's responsive non-denial — taking the form of a retaliatory Bar complaint rather than a written correction — confirms that the emails were received, read, and appreciated. The conduct that followed was not a factual denial of the article's merits; it was an

assertive act of retaliation. The “didn’t see it” or “spam folder” defenses are foreclosed by the recipient’s own contemporaneous reaction.

C. Specific Matters Properly the Subject of Adoptive Admission

18. From the records identified in Section II above, the following matters are properly the subject of adoptive admission by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and warrant adverse inferences:

a. Failure to Identify precise materials withheld from production lack of any privilege or exemption log. Through more than seven months of public-records litigation in Case No. 25-CA-010255 (from the July 24, 2025 records requests through and including the April 28, 2026 protective-order ruling at Doc. 80), the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit produced no record-by-record privilege or exemption log. The absence of any timely-asserted, particularized exemption (despite the unlawful 3 bites at the apple gifted by the 6th Circuit) is an admission by conduct that responsive records exist and were withheld without a stated lawful basis as required by § 119.07(1)(f), Florida Statutes, and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(m)(2).

b. Failure to substantiate the surveillance-video exemption applied to the April 4, 2025 recording. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit has classified the April 4, 2025 hearing-room recording as “confidential surveillance video footage” exempt under § 119.071(3)(a), Florida Statutes, and Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(8). Respondent has, in formal correspondence and in repeated motions, challenged that classification, pointing out the “Logical Inconsistency” that video of the Trial Judge would be confidential Security footage. There is no place in the entire building where it is more obvious that video exists than the Bench where the Judge sits presiding over Hearings. Respondent has further pointed out that the trial judge presiding at the April 4, 2025 hearing (Judge Ayers) offered, on the record, to retrieve the very recording now claimed to be exempt. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit has filed no sworn affidavit, no system-level documentation, no in-camera tender, and no “no less restrictive measures” analysis as Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(9)(B)–(C) would require.

c. Failure to file the Motion to Determine Confidentiality of Court Records required by Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(e)(1). Although the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit has asserted confidentiality with respect to the April 4, 2025 recording for over nine months, it has never filed the formal Motion to Determine Confidentiality of Court Records that Rule 2.420(e)(1) requires for any contention that a court record is confidential — and has therefore never tendered the signed good-faith certification that rule mandates.

d. Failure to dispute the bait-and-switch and intentional-concealment allegations. Respondent’s filings in Case No. 25-CA-010255 directly allege that the August 21, 2025 production by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit was a calculated document dump that suppressed the records most relevant to this case — the scheduling communications for the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings — while producing 377 pages of unresponsive material. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit’s responsive filings have not denied those allegations.

e. Refusal to rule on vacatur after Judge Frayman’s disqualification. On January 21, 2026, Judge Frayman entered an order disqualifying himself in Case No. 25-CA-010255 (Doc. 50). Judge Frayman expressly addressed only the alternative relief of disqualification and did not rule on Respondent’s requested vacatur of the prior orders. The challenged orders therefore remained in force after disqualification — conduct that further supports the insider-protectionism themes Respondent had discussed months before in his article “Foxes Guarding the Courthouse” provided to the 13th Circuit Defendants on November 24, 2025 (as detailed in ¶¶ 10, 16–17 above).

f. Lack of any substantive response to Respondent’s August 26–October 9, 2025 follow-up correspondence regarding the video and related search methods. Respondent submitted follow-up correspondence on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025 requesting clarification on the surveillance-video classification, the search methods used, and affidavits confirming the completeness of the search. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit provided no substantive response to those follow-ups.

g. Refusal to make findings of fact on the structural-conflict ground despite repeated, preserved on-record demands. Respondent timely raised the structural-conflict ground — that the presiding trial judge in this dissolution matter is a named defendant in Respondent’s parallel public-records mandamus action, Case No. 25-CA-010255 — in (i) his December 19, 2025 Verified Motion to Disqualify All 13th Circuit Court Judges (Docket #255), (ii) his January 12, 2026 Motion to Vacate / For Rehearing (Docket #257), and (iii) his pre-hearing Notice of Invocation of Constitutional Rights (Docket #290) and Notice of Filing Additional Evidence of Structural Conflict (Docket #294). At the April 17, 2026 motions hearing, Respondent raised the structural-conflict ground and requested findings of fact on it not fewer than six times (April 17, 2026 Tr. pp. 32–34, 42, 50, 53–56, 180–181, 187–188, 239–240, 247), each request invoking *In re Murchison*, *Caperton v. A.T. Massey Coal Co.*, *Livingston v. State*, and Canon 3E(1). The Court’s recorded response was to “stand on” the January 8, 2026 Order (Docket #258) — an order that addressed only Rule 2.330(i) successive-motion sufficiency and did not analyze Judge Felix’s status as a party-defendant in Case No. 25-CA-010255 — and to state, verbatim, “*I can make the ruling without findings of facts, and if the Second DCA says I need to find facts, then I’ll do so*” (April 17, 2026 Tr. p. 181). Respondent thereafter filed his Emergency Motion for Written Findings of Fact, Conclusions of Law, and Entry of Orders on Pending Motions on May 1, 2026 (Docket #296), again expressly demanding “immediate, detailed written findings of fact and conclusions of law regarding the structural conflict of interest created by Judge Felix’s status as a named defendant in Case No. 25-CA-010255”; that motion was disposed of the same day on a form Emergency Motion Handling Order (Docket #298) checked as “not an emergency.” The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit has therefore made no finding of fact on the structural-conflict ground despite Respondent’s specific, repeated, on-record demands and constitutional requirements.

h. Generalized accusation that Respondent was “wrong on the law,” paired with on-record declination to specify. At the April 13, 2026 Zoom hearing in Case No. 25-CA-010255 (Coleman, presiding), the trial judge stated on the record: “*At past times, you have not been correct on the law.*” (Tr. 30:7–8). Respondent immediately, on the same record,

requested specification: *“Excuse me. When was I wrong on the law?”* (Tr. 30:14–15). The Court declined to identify any specific ruling, order, page, paragraph, statute, or rule, responding only: *“Mr. Hanson, you could probably go back and read over my orders and find those, but.”* (Tr. 30:16–17). Respondent renewed the request: *“I haven’t seen anything where I’ve been wrong in the law and I’d ask for you to support that statement.”* (Tr. 30:18–20). The Court did not return to or particularize the comment for the remainder of the proceedings nor in any subsequent orders or correspondence.

i. Silence of represented Defendants in response to the trial court’s generalized accusation. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Defendants in Case No. 25-CA-010255 were represented at the April 13, 2026 hearing by Senior Assistant Attorney General Jessica Schwieterman and observed by 13th Circuit Assistant General Counsel Chris Nauman (Tr. 6:17–21, 7:23–8:7). Neither objected, corrected, nor otherwise distanced the Defendants from the Court’s generalized characterization or from the Court’s subsequent declination to particularize, despite a natural opportunity to do so.

D. The Florida Bar — Two-Part Disparity and Stonewalling Pattern

19. **The Florida Bar’s silence on the substance of Respondent’s complaint against Mr. Davis (RFA No. 25-6861), paired with its concurrent advancement of Judge Ayers’s complaint against Respondent (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)), warrants notice as a documented institutional pattern.** Respondent submitted his complaint against attorney Scott P. Davis (FL Bar No. 115540) on February 18, 2025, supported by transcripts, emails, and docket entries from this case. The Florida Bar closed the matter without engagement with the substance; the Bar’s communication to Respondent stated, in substance, only that “this matter is closed,” with no engagement with any particular allegation or supporting evidence. By contrast, Judge Ayers’s November 24, 2025 complaint against Respondent — which identifies no specific allegedly false statement, cites only vague unnamed allegations, and attaches social-media screenshots — has remained pending and active for more than six months without the Bar specifying any allegedly false statement Respondent is alleged to have made.
20. **Respondent has placed the Bar on direct, repeated written notice of the specific concerns supporting this Request.** Respondent has corresponded directly and in writing with Bar staff (including communications with Bar staff members Sheridan and Kelley) and through formal grievance filings setting forth the conduct of Mr. Davis, the misconduct of Judge Ayers, the conduct of attorney Hodz, and the related pattern of concealment of records by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit. The Florida Bar’s responses to Respondent’s correspondence have been non-substantive or absent. Under § 90.803(18)(b) and consistent with *Sullivan v. McMillan*, the Bar — as a recipient with direct knowledge of the regulatory subject matter, in privity with Respondent through his pending grievance complaints, and under an institutional duty to discharge oversight responsibilities — is properly considered to have adopted the factual content of Respondent’s specific, written, evidence-supported submissions where it has neither rebutted nor engaged the substance.

21. Each of the matters identified in subparagraphs 18(a)–(i) above and 19–20 above is supported by the records of which Respondent requests judicial notice. To the extent the Court takes judicial notice of those records, Respondent respectfully submits the matters identified in this Section III are properly considered for evidentiary purposes under § 90.803(18)(b), Florida Statutes.
22. Furthermore, Respondent has sent the subpoenas attached at Exhibit 39 out for service to compel various witnesses from these related proceedings to testify at the May 29, 2026 hearing.

IV. RELIEF REQUESTED

WHEREFORE, Respondent/Husband respectfully requests that the Court enter an order:

A. Taking judicial notice, under §§ 90.201–90.204 and specifically §§ 90.202(5)–(6) and 90.203, Florida Statutes, of the records identified in Section II above;

B. Permitting Respondent to refer to and rely on the judicially-noticed records at any hearing in this case to the extent relevant to the issues before the Court;

C. Considering, under § 90.803(18)(b), Florida Statutes, and consistent with *Sullivan v. McMillan*, 26 Fla. 543, 8 So. 450 (1890), and *Globe v. State*, 877 So. 2d 663 (Fla. 2004), the evidentiary implications identified in Section III above; and

D. Granting such further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

CERTIFICATION

I, Christopher Hanson, both as Respondent/Husband and as an officer of the Court, declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Certified and executed on May 18, 2026.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

(727) 409-5738

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing has been furnished electronically via the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal on this 18th day of May, 2026, to the Court and counsel of record.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

(727) 409-5738

EXHIBIT LIST:

Ex.	Description	Source / Case	Date
1	Hearing Transcript — Jan. 13, 2026 (Hon. Evan G. Frayman)	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-13
2	Hearing Transcript — Feb. 6, 2026 (Successor Assignment; Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman)	2026-CA-010255	2026-02-06
3	Hearing Transcript — Apr. 13, 2026 (Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman) (excerpt)	2026-CA-010255	2026-04-13
4	Docket 047 — Alternative Writ in Mandamus (Frayman)	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-13
5	Docket 048 — Case Management Conference Order (Frayman)	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-13
6	Docket 049 — Motion to Vacate or Disqualify Frayman	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-16
7	Docket 050 — Order on Motion to Vacate (Frayman self-disqualification)	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-21
8	Docket 052 — Motion for Immediate Relief and Successor	2026-CA-010255	2026-01-27
9	Docket 059 — Order Granting Motion for Extension of Time	2026-CA-010255	2026-02-12
10	Docket 060 — Motion for Rehearing on Coleman Feb. 10 Order	2026-CA-010255	2026-02-16
11	Order on Protective Order to Stay Discovery (Coleman; mandates privilege log)	2026-CA-010255	2026-05-05
12	CCIS04 — Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus (v. The Florida Bar)	2025-CA-002469	2025-12-17
13	CCIS08 — Notice of Related Cases	2025-CA-002469	2025-12-17
14	CCIS26 — Motion for Immediate Issuance of Alternative Writ	2025-CA-002469	2026-01-22

15	CCIS28 — Florida Bar Defendants' Motion to Dismiss	2025-CA-002469	2026-01-27
16	CCIS31 — Plaintiff's Response in Opposition to Motion to Dismiss (w/ exhibits)	2025-CA-002469	2026-02-05
17	CCIS33 — Order Granting Motion to Dismiss and Final Judgment	2025-CA-002469	2026-02-13
18	CCIS34 — Plaintiff's Verified Motion for Rehearing	2025-CA-002469	2026-02-19
19	CCIS35 — Order Denying Motion for Rehearing	2025-CA-002469	2026-02-24
20	CCIS36 — Notice of Appeal (opens 1D26-0728)	2025-CA-002469	2026-03-08
21	CCIS06 — Appendix to Verified Petition (285 pp) — NOT REPRODUCED (volume); filed in 2469	2025-CA-002469	2025-12-17
22	Florida Bar Complaint — Scott Paul Davis, RFA No. 25-6861 (original, 25 pp)	The Florida Bar	2025-02-18
23	Florida Bar Complaint — File No. 2026-10,395(13F) (Ayers v. Hanson)	The Florida Bar	2025-12-03
24	Hanson Response to Florida Bar File No. 2026-10,395(13F)	The Florida Bar	2025-12-08
25	Florida Bar Notice to J. Sheridan re File No. 2026-10,395(13F)	The Florida Bar	2025-12-03
26	Florida Bar Complaint — Vivian Hodz, File No. 2026-10,601(13E) (w/ exhibits)	The Florida Bar	2026-05-17
27	Hodz Bar Complaint — Rebuttal (FINAL)	The Florida Bar	2026
28	JQC Closing Letter (re Ayers; Teage)	Fla. JQC	2025-10-28
29	Email — Hanson to JQC offering assistance	Correspondence	2025-10-23
30	Email — Hanson to Marrero re suppression of public disclosure	Correspondence	2025-11-20

31	Email — Hanson to JQC requesting reconsideration	Correspondence	2025-11-21
32	Email — Hanson to Dep. Gen. Counsel Courtemanche re Bar failures	Correspondence	2025-12-01
33	Email — Hanson to J. Sheridan & The Florida Bar re 2026-10,395(13F)	Correspondence	2025-12-08
34	Email — Hanson & Bar Counsel Kelley (scanned)	Correspondence	2026-03-19
35	Email — from Bar Counsel Kelley (scanned)	Correspondence	2026-03-20
36	Letter — Hanson to Kelley re sworn statement / conflict objection	Correspondence	2026-03-23
37	Email — Hanson to The Florida Bar (full chain; pattern)	Correspondence	2026-04-17
38	Compiled Bar Correspondence (through Apr. 30, 2026)	Correspondence	2026-04-30
39	Composite of Subpoenas for Hearing attendance issued	Pleadings	2026-05-18

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT,
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA — FAMILY LAW DIVISION
Case No. 2024-DR-001150, Division A
SARAH HANSON v. CHRISTOPHER HANSON**

**COMPENDIUM VOLUME I
Case No. 2026-CA-010255 Hearing Transcripts**

Filed with Respondent/Husband's Request for Judicial Notice — Hearing of May 29, 2026

EXHIBIT 1

Hearing Transcript — Jan. 13, 2026 (Hon. Evan G. Frayman)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-01-13 | 36 pp.

[Page 1]

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
OF THE STATE OF FLORIDA, IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY

CASE NO.: 25-CA-10255

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually
and as attorney for himself and
attorney/next friend for his
minor children (8 years old) and
(6 years old),

Plaintiffs,

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, CLERK
OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH
JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE
(AND/OR CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR),
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA,
JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE MATTHEW
FELIX, MIKE MOORE,

Defendants.

HEARING HELD BEFORE:
HONORABLE EVAN G. FRAYMAN

DATE: January 13, 2026
TIME: 1:30 p.m. - 2:02 p.m.
PLACE: Via videoconference
REPORTED BY: Lorial Milazzo, RPR
Notary Public
State of Florida at Large

[Page 2]

(1) A-P-P-E-A-R-A-N-C-E-S

(2)

(3) Appeared Pro Se:

(4) CHRISTOPHER HANSON, Esq.

3934 E Eden Roc Circle

(5) Tampa, Florida 33634

cahanson77@yahoo.com

(6)

(7) Appeared on behalf of Defendants Thirteenth Judicial
Circuit, Gina Justice (and/or current court

(8) administrator), Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella, Judge
Kelly Ayers, and Judge Matthew Felix:

(9)

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(16) Reporter's certificate.....29

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[Page 3]

(1) P-R-O-C-E-E-D-I-N-G-S

(2) THE COURT: All right. Let's make sure I can
(3) see who everybody is and everybody can hear me all
(4) right.

(5) Miss Milazzo, our court reporter, can you hear
(6) me, ma'am?

(7) THE COURT REPORTER: Yes, Your Honor. Thank you
(8) for asking.

(9) THE COURT: Very good.

(10) Miss Schwieterman, can you hear me all right?

(11) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes, I can, Your Honor.
(12) Thank you.

(13) THE COURT: All right. Mr. Hanson, can you hear
(14) me all right?

(15) MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor.

(16) THE COURT: All right. Now I've got an observer
(17) unidentified. Can you please unmute yourself and
(18) identify yourself for the Court.

(19) THE PARALEGAL: My name is Brittany. I'm a
(20) paralegal for the Thirteenth Circuit.

(21) THE COURT: Okay. Thank you.

(22) And then I've got Samsung SMS931U. Can you
(23) unmute yourself and identify yourself for the Court.
(24) Samsung SMS931U, can you identify --

(25) MR. F. HANSON: I'm sorry, Your Honor. My name

[Page 4]

(1) is Frank Hanson.

(2) THE COURT: Frank Hanson. All right.

(3) And then I've got Tracy Hanson. Can you hear me
(4) all right, ma'am? You're on mute.

(5) MS. T. HANSON: Yes, yes. Sorry. Yes, Your
(6) Honor. I apologize. I can hear you, sir.

(7) THE COURT: All right. And I've got a Jenny
(8) Raddatz. Can you hear me all right? You're on
(9) mute. There you go.

(10) MS. RADDATZ: Yes, sir. Hello.

(11) THE COURT: Hello.

(12) All right. It looks like I've got one more
(13) iPhone joining from the waiting room. Give that
(14) person a minute.

(15) Somebody who joined us as iPhone, can you unmute
(16) yourself and identify yourself for the Court,
(17) please.

(18) MS. HENDERSON: Yes. Hi, this is Nikki
(19) Henderson.

(20) THE COURT: All right. Is that C-K or K-K?

(21) MS. HENDERSON: N-I-K-K-I.

(22) THE COURT: Okay. All right. So I understand
(23) we have some observers here. If anybody is not
(24) actively participating in the proceeding or
(25) representing somebody actively participating in the

[Page 5]

(1) proceeding, I'm going to ask you to remain on mute;
(2) otherwise, we'll proceed as quickly as we can.

(3) We are here on Case Number 25- -- I guess it's
(4) 25-CA-10255. This is a proceeding in the Thirteenth
(5) Judicial Circuit Court in and for Hillsborough
(6) County, Florida. Case style is Christopher Hanson,
(7) Petitioner. I think it's individually and on behalf
(8) of his minor children. And it's against the
(9) Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court, Chief Judge
(10) Christopher C. Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, Judge
(11) Matthew Felix, Court Administrator Gina Justice,
(12) Mike Moore, and Clerk of the Court Victor Crist.
(13) Those are all of the respondents.

(14) I believe, Miss Schwieterman, you represent all
(15) of the respondents?

(16) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Your Honor, I'm only
(17) representing the served respondents, so that would
(18) be the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, Miss Gina
(19) Justice or the court administrator, Chief Judge
(20) Christopher Sabella, and Judge Kelly Ayers, as well
(21) as Judge Matthew Felix.

(22) THE COURT: Okay. Hold on a moment. On behalf
(23) of the served defendants, and I'm going to put that
(24) specifically. Can you go through that list slowly
(25) for me.

[Page 6]

(1) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes. The Thirteenth Judicial
(2) Circuit, the current court administrator, formerly
(3) Gina Justice. Now it is an interim or vacant
(4) position.

(5) THE COURT: Okay. Court administrator. I'm not
(6) going to --

(7) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: That's okay. Chief Judge
(8) Sabella.

(9) THE COURT: Okay.

(10) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Judge Ayers and Judge Felix.

(11) THE COURT: All right. So prior Court
(12) Administrator Gina Justice has not been served, Mike
(13) Moore has not been served, and Clerk of the Court
(14) Victor Crist has not been served. Is that your
(15) representation?

(16) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Gina Justice has been served,
(17) however, she is -- it's in her official capacity,
(18) and she is no longer in that role. So that
(19) administrator role has been served. But my
(20) understanding is the clerk of the court has not been
(21) served and neither has Mike Moore.

(22) THE COURT: Okay. All right. Perfect. All
(23) right.

(24) And then, Mr. Hanson, you are representing
(25) yourself; correct?

[Page 7]

(1) MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor.

(2) THE COURT: All right. It looks like I've got
(3) one more party coming in. Excuse me.

(4) All right. Mr. Lanham, can you hear me all
(5) right? You're on mute, sir. Mr. Lanham, Matt
(6) Lanham is what I'm reading on my Zoom screen. Can
(7) you hear the Court, and if so, can you please unmute
(8) yourself and confirm that you can hear the Court.

(9) MR. LANHAM: Yes, sir, I can hear.

(10) THE COURT: All right. You can go back on mute,
(11) unless you're representing a party involved in the
(12) dispute.

(13) All right. So we're here for a case management
(14) conference. Essentially this is just my opportunity
(15) to I guess sort of introduce myself, give you kind
(16) of the lay of the land of where I think the case is
(17) at from the Court's perspective and what I
(18) anticipate where we're headed from here.

(19) I have reviewed the -- I think it's the
(20) amended -- now the amended verified petition,
(21) complaint for writ of mandamus, declaratory relief,
(22) and attorney's fees. I've also reviewed the motion
(23) for immediate issuance and alternative writ of
(24) mandamus and the response in opposition to the
(25) amended petition for writ of mandamus and

[Page 8]

(1) incorporated memorandum of law. I've reviewed all
(2) of the Rules of Civil Procedure, as well as the
(3) Rules of Judicial Practice and General
(4) Administration that govern cases such as this
(5) seeking access to judicial records, whether they be
(6) court records or administrative records.

(7) What I can tell you is I'm in the process of
(8) finalizing an alternative writ of mandamus
(9) establishing what I am and am not finding that I
(10) have jurisdiction on and what does and does not
(11) establish a prima facie case at least warranting a
(12) response under Rule 1.140. I won't draw you out in
(13) suspense on that, and I'll give you an idea, because
(14) I was just in the process of drafting that.

(15) But what I am finding is that, A, the Court is
(16) without jurisdiction to address claims against
(17) individual judicial officers that relate to access
(18) to administrative records. The rule on that one is
(19) 2.420(1), and I believe that that specifically
(20) states that when a judge who has denied a request
(21) for access to records is the custodian, the action
(22) shall be filed in the court having appellate
(23) jurisdiction to review the decisions of the judge
(24) denying access, which in this case, of course, would
(25) be the Second DCA.

[Page 9]

(1) So to the extent I am granting the alternative
(2) writ, it will exempt out any claims against the
(3) individual judges -- that would be Judge Sabella,
(4) Ayers, and Felix -- for administrative records to
(5) the extent that they are alleged to be the
(6) custodians of such records. In addition, I also
(7) found that there is a lack of prima facie showing
(8) for entitlement to declaratory relief under Chapter
(9) 86 just as a matter of pleading.

(10) But notwithstanding those two exceptions, I'm
(11) otherwise going to be issuing the alternative writ
(12) directing the defendants collectively to respond to
(13) the amended complaint, as that's defined in my
(14) order, within the time period and otherwise in
(15) accordance with Rule 1.140 of the Florida Rules of
(16) Civil Procedure. So that's just a general sense of
(17) where I'm at and what I'm doing.

(18) Yes, Mr. Hanson, I'm going to give you a chance
(19) to speak in a moment. I just wanted to go through
(20) my thoughts before I opened the floor. So go ahead.
(21) You are the petitioner. I'll let you speak first.

(22) MR. HANSON: I understand, Your honor. I wasn't
(23) being impatient on that. Just something happened
(24) with my volume, and I can barely hear you. So I
(25) just was going to ask if you could just hold off for

[Page 10]

(1) one second while I try and get the volume back up.

(2) THE COURT: Okay. I don't know when that hand
(3) went up. I apologize. I was sort of looking
(4) askance at another computer screen.

(5) MR. HANSON: And I could kind of hear you, so it
(6) wasn't critical. I don't even see where the volume
(7) up is. Maybe it's in --

(8) THE COURT: So there's two volume settings. One
(9) is your computer itself. The other is under the
(10) audio tab at the bottom left of your Zoom screen.
(11) If you click on the up arrow and you go into your
(12) audio settings, you can affect the volume level
(13) there.

(14) MR. HANSON: Directly from the Zoom?

(15) THE COURT: Yeah, well, if your Zoom volume is
(16) down. So there is a little caret. It's like an up
(17) arrow next to the audio microphone. Click that, and
(18) then the bottom item is audio settings. Click that,
(19) and that should open a screen with output volume and
(20) microphone input volume so you can adjust those and
(21) test your speakers. If it's turned all the way up,
(22) then it's a computer problem.

(23) MR. HANSON: Yeah, it's turned all the way up,
(24) and I'm just on my phone. So it's almost like it
(25) went to handset phone speaker. I apologize for the

[Page 11]

(1) delay.

(2) THE COURT: That's okay. That I can't help you
(3) with. I am not a phone person.

(4) MR. HANSON: Oh, here is audio. I'm sorry, Your
(5) Honor, one more time, you said it's under audio
(6) and --

(7) THE COURT: I think you've already confirmed
(8) that the audio setting was turned all the way up
(9) volume-wise, so I'm not sure --

(10) MR. HANSON: On my phone it is. It's the app
(11) where I'm having a little bit of trouble here.

(12) THE COURT: So it's the microphone. There is a
(13) little up arrow next to the microphone, and you
(14) click the up arrow and then go into audio settings,
(15) and then it will show output volume for you to test
(16) the speaker, and you can see whether it's turned all
(17) the way up to a hundred percent.

(18) MR. HANSON: I do apologize, Your Honor. I
(19) guess what I'll do is just log into my computer,
(20) because it's not -- I don't see the microphone. I
(21) see a mute button, but I'm not seeing --

(22) THE COURT: Yeah, I don't know where the audio
(23) settings are in the Zoom app on the phone. I work
(24) on the computer side.

(25) MR. HANSON: And again, Your Honor, I'm sorry

[Page 12]

(1) for the delay here.

(2) THE COURT: That's okay.

(3) MS. HENDERSON: It's under the more. Like if
(4) you click the more icon, like you'll be able to go
(5) into the setting. I don't know if you have that.

(6) MR. HANSON: Yeah, I see the more one, and then
(7) I don't see --

(8) MS. HENDERSON: Then you go into settings after
(9) that, and then the audio is the bottom.

(10) THE COURT: Thank you, Miss Henderson.

(11) MS. HENDERSON: You're welcome.

(12) MR. HANSON: I have not had this issue before.
(13) I'm just joining the meeting now, Your Honor, on the
(14) separate -- can you hear me okay?

(15) THE COURT: I can hear you just fine. Can you
(16) hear me?

(17) MR. HANSON: Yes. Now I can, Your Honor. Thank
(18) you very much.

(19) THE COURT: All right. So I've already
(20) indicated sort of where the case is heading from the
(21) Court's perspective, and the only thing I left out
(22) was that upon the filing of the defendants'
(23) responses or upon the expiration of the time for a
(24) response pursuant to the rule, the parties shall set
(25) a CMC for the purpose of setting an evidentiary or

[Page 13]

(1) other hearing to the extent same is required for the
(2) Court to decide the merits of the case. So that was
(3) the only thing that I had left out in terms of the
(4) time planning.

(5) All right. Let me hear from Mr. Hanson first if
(6) there's anything he would like to address with the
(7) Court, and then I'll hear from Miss Schwieterman.

(8) MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor. I just want to
(9) briefly review, as you're drafting that order, the
(10) basis for my right to the access to these public
(11) records, and that's --

(12) THE COURT: That's not necessary. I'm not --
(13) the order doesn't go into the basis. It says
(14) whether or not you've established a prima facie case
(15) on the face of the document, which I have concluded
(16) that at least in part you have. So we're not here
(17) to argue the merits of your petition. I've already
(18) concluded that procedurally I'm required to issue
(19) the alternative writ if I find that there is at
(20) least a sufficient basis to have pled a prima facie
(21) case.

(22) Miss Schwieterman and her clients will now have
(23) the opportunity obviously to respond. Whether
(24) that's by way of motion to dismiss or an answer, I
(25) can't begin to conclude what it is that they are

[Page 14]

(1) going to file in response, but I can't -- as I
(2) understand it under the applicable case law and
(3) rules, I can't simply jump right to the merits.
(4) Even though they did file a -- even though they did
(5) file a response in opposition, technically I can't
(6) consider that and jump through the process of not
(7) issuing the alternative writ.

(8) So first I issue the alternative writ. Then
(9) they file an answer slash motion to dismiss or
(10) whatever it is that they want to do under 1.140, and
(11) then we come back for a determination on the merits.

(12) MR. HANSON: Where I was going with that, Your
(13) Honor, is the timelines and what additional options
(14) the Court gives the Thirteenth Circuit in defending
(15) this, and I need to review the Rule 2.420(1) that
(16) provides for expedited review of these mandamus
(17) actions.

(18) THE COURT: Correct, but the rule specifically
(19) says under 2.420 -- actually under 1.630 with the
(20) extraordinary remedies it requires me to give them,
(21) by way of due process, the opportunity to respond.
(22) So the first step that has to happen is I grant the
(23) preliminary -- we'll call it the alternative writ.
(24) Then they get an opportunity to respond under the
(25) rules, which gives them twenty days. That's right

[Page 15]

(1) in 1.630.

(2) After that we can set an expedited hearing on
(3) the merits, but until we're sort of at issue I've
(4) got to give them the due process right to respond,
(5) and I got to give them the twenty days within which
(6) to do that.

(7) MR. HANSON: Okay. And, Your Honor, I would
(8) argue that they've had a lot more than twenty days
(9) since they've been formally served, and I ask the
(10) Court to issue a --

(11) THE COURT: I'll take full responsibility for
(12) the delay in that regard. I'll be honest with you,
(13) Mr. Hanson. This is the first time I've ever seen a
(14) motion or a petition for mandamus relief at the
(15) circuit court level, so I wasn't a hundred percent
(16) familiar with the precise procedure, and it's a
(17) little bit esoteric, to say the least. It's not
(18) straight out in the Rules of Civil Procedure. You
(19) got to kind of comb through the Rules of Judicial
(20) Practice and General Administration in order to find
(21) how this procedure works.

(22) And I certainly appreciate you and Miss
(23) Schwieterman educating me on that process, and I
(24) think I've done my best to get us kind of back up to
(25) speed. But the delay in that regard is of my own

[Page 16]

(1) making, so I apologize for that.

(2) MR. HANSON: Okay. But given that delay and the
(3) expedited nature that's written right into the rule,
(4) I'd like to at least make a record of some arguments
(5) about the events to date and why even a more
(6) accelerated path is appropriate in these facts.

(7) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I'm going to cut you
(8) off. We are not here on a notice of hearing for the
(9) substance of your arguments, and I guarantee you I
(10) have read every one of your submissions, voluminous
(11) as they are, including the attachments that you've
(12) submitted. I am well familiar with your position.

(13) I understand your request for expedited relief,
(14) and when they have answered or filed a motion in
(15) response, you can certainly request an expedited
(16) hearing, which is why I'm including in my order that
(17) the parties are to set a CMC immediately upon the
(18) expiration of the answer time so that we can get
(19) this matter back before the Court without any
(20) further delay.

(21) But it's not necessary for us to rehash the
(22) record that you have well-established in the
(23) documentation that you have submitted to the Court.

(24) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, were you able to read
(25) my reply to the attorney general's objection to the

[Page 17]

(1) petition?

(2) THE COURT: I have.

(3) MR. HANSON: The one that I just sent over
(4) today?

(5) THE COURT: I think it was an e-mail, but it
(6) wasn't today. It was a couple days ago.

(7) MR. HANSON: No, no. This was something that I
(8) e-mailed over early this morning and e-filed early
(9) this morning.

(10) THE COURT: No, I haven't seen anything that was
(11) filed today. And again, we're not here on the
(12) merits of anything. I've made the preliminary
(13) determination to issue the alternative writ. I'm
(14) not going to hear any further argument on that.

(15) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I understand that you
(16) don't want to hear the facts, and none of the
(17) judges --

(18) THE COURT: No, that's not what I said,
(19) Mr. Hanson. Mr. Hanson, I said I've reviewed the --

(20) MR. HANSON: I understand that's what you're
(21) saying.

(22) THE COURT: No, you're going to listen to me or
(23) I'm going to mute you; okay? I have reviewed the
(24) facts. Because I have reviewed the facts, I have
(25) made the preliminary determination that you have

[Page 18]

(1) made a prima facie case warranting a response. They
(2) are now entitled to respond. I don't need to hear
(3) you reiterate the facts that I've already read in
(4) exhaustive fashion.

(5) So we're only here on a case management
(6) conference, not on a substantive hearing. You'll
(7) have ample opportunity to present your evidence and
(8) to present your argument at a merits hearing. This
(9) is not that; okay?

(10) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, so in terms of your
(11) review of the materials, I would hope that there
(12) would be a bit more empathy for my position and the
(13) need to get a record out, given the events that have
(14) taken place to date, and I would expect that perhaps
(15) that the Court would allow some accelerated path
(16) beyond the full twenty days again now.

(17) THE COURT: We're retreading on old ground at
(18) this point, Mr. Hanson, so unless you have something
(19) new to present to the Court that's related to the
(20) case management conference or my alternative writ of
(21) mandamus, I am going to move on to Miss Schwieterman
(22) and let her make some comments here before we
(23) conclude.

(24) So, Miss Schwieterman --

(25) MR. HANSON: So you're refusing to let me make a

[Page 19]

(1) further record; is that fair?

(2) THE COURT: I have established, Mr. Hanson, that
(3) your record is in documented form exhaustively
(4) stating your cause. This is not --

(5) MR. HANSON: And I'm --

(6) THE COURT: No, you're going to listen again.
(7) This is not a merits hearing. There is no argument
(8) to be presented. There is no record to be made,
(9) because I am not making any decisions today; okay?
(10) So simply giving you the floor to reiterate
(11) everything that you have demonstrated to the Court
(12) in your voluminous filings is just unnecessary;
(13) okay?

(14) MR. HANSON: You're telling me what I'm going to
(15) say.

(16) THE COURT: Your record has been made in
(17) writing.

(18) MR. HANSON: And I understand that you're saying
(19) that, Your Honor. Are you refusing to allow me to
(20) speak more? Because I won't --

(21) THE COURT: I'm allocating the time in this
(22) hearing equitably among the parties. I've gone
(23) around and around with you and explained the Court's
(24) perspective and the fact that I'm actually granting
(25) the relief that you've requested, and so I'm now

[Page 20]

(1) going to give Miss Schwieterman an opportunity to
(2) respond within the time frame of this hearing.

(3) If you'd like to continue to monopolize the
(4) hearing and continue to press a point that I've
(5) already essentially ruled against you on, you can
(6) continue to do so, but it's not helping your case.

(7) MR. HANSON: I think for me it's more important
(8) to make a record, so that would be my preference and
(9) my request.

(10) THE COURT: All right. Well, I'm already
(11) denying the request to make a further record. I've
(12) made it very clear that the record has been
(13) sufficient to enable the Court to make a
(14) determination on the alternative writ of mandamus,
(15) which will issue forthwith immediately upon the
(16) conclusion of this hearing.

(17) So, Miss Schwieterman, do you have any comments
(18) for the Court?

(19) MR. HANSON: And I apologize, Your Honor. The
(20) last thing I want to add --

(21) THE COURT: No, Mr. Hanson, I've muted you,
(22) because I've already made it clear that you have had
(23) enough floor time and it is only fair to give
(24) Miss Schwieterman an opportunity to respond.

(25) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: And, Your Honor, I'm just

[Page 21]

(1) seeking clarification, which I believe may be in the
(2) order, but I just want to ensure that I have all of
(3) my dates and everything clear. So you will be
(4) issuing -- you'll be issuing an alternative writ,
(5) which will address jurisdictional issues and things
(6) that I more or less would not need to respond to; is
(7) that correct?

(8) THE COURT: That's correct.

(9) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Okay.

(10) THE COURT: Essentially what I'm saying is that
(11) any request for administrative record sought from
(12) Chief Judge Chris Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, and
(13) Judge Matthew Felix would not be within the purview
(14) of my jurisdiction.

(15) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Okay. Thank you. And I will
(16) have twenty days from the date the order is entered;
(17) is that correct?

(18) THE COURT: That's per Rule 1.140, correct.

(19) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Thank you. I have no further
(20) questions.

(21) THE COURT: All right. I'm going to open or
(22) allow Mr. Hanson to unmute himself.

(23) Mr. Hanson, if you're there, you can unmute
(24) yourself. Do you have any questions regarding what
(25) the Court has ordered or is anticipating ordering in

[Page 22]

(1) the alternative writ?

(2) MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor. The Court is
(3) still going to order production?

(4) THE COURT: No, I'm not ordering production of
(5) anything. The process is very straightforward. You
(6) have established a prima facie case. That requires
(7) a response from the other side. Once they have
(8) responded, then we have to have a merits
(9) determination as to whether or not the relief that
(10) you're seeking is appropriate, and at that hearing
(11) you'll be able to argue everything you want to
(12) argue, present all of your evidence, and persuade
(13) the Court or not as to whether or not you're
(14) entitled to the relief sought. That's where the
(15) decision will occur.

(16) Are you there? Did you freeze? He may have
(17) frozen. We're going to give him a minute.

(18) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: And, Your Honor, when
(19) Mr. Hanson does come back, I do have one more I
(20) guess scheduling question that will impact
(21) Mr. Hanson as well.

(22) THE COURT: All right. Just hold for a moment
(23) until we can get him back on the line.

(24) Mr. Hanson, are you there?

(25) MR. HANSON: Yes. I don't know what happened

[Page 23]

(1) there. I was --

(2) THE COURT: Okay. I'm not sure where you -- I'm
(3) not sure where you froze, so --

(4) MR. HANSON: It was probably at least forty-five
(5) seconds that I was trying to figure it out. It said
(6) I was still in the room. I just --

(7) THE COURT: What's the last thing you heard me
(8) say? Did you freeze again?

(9) MR. HANSON: No, I'm still here. I'm just
(10) trying to remember, because I was frantic trying to
(11) get back in and it --

(12) THE COURT: That's all right. I'll try and
(13) encapsulate what I was saying, but basically you
(14) were asking if I was going to order production, and
(15) my answer to that was, no, the procedure isn't that
(16) I make the determination on the merits of your
(17) mandamus petition. All I do is make a determination
(18) that you've established a prima facie case. Then
(19) the defense is entitled to assert their defenses.

(20) Then we have a merits hearing, and at that
(21) merits hearing you'll be given the opportunity to
(22) present your evidence supporting your request for
(23) the records, and if at that hearing I conclude that
(24) you have persuaded me that you're entitled to the
(25) relief, then you'll get an order directing

[Page 24]

(1) production of the records. But that's how the
(2) procedure has to work, according to the rules.

(3) MR. HANSON: And I misspoke, Your Honor. I
(4) understand that the order is for them to offer an
(5) explanation or a justification.

(6) THE COURT: Okay.

(7) MR. HANSON: But the question I was trying to
(8) get to is you mentioned that you were not going to
(9) cover Judge Ayers -- the individual judges for
(10) administrative records.

(11) THE COURT: Correct.

(12) MR. HANSON: The court as the custodian can
(13) still be compelled on that; correct? It's not as
(14) though all Judge Ayers' records --

(15) THE COURT: Correct. It's only -- it literally
(16) says when a judge who has been denied a request for
(17) access to records is the custodian. So in other
(18) words, if Judge Ayers, for example, were the
(19) custodian of certain records that were otherwise
(20) defined as administrative records, then you would
(21) have to seek relief at the Second DCA, but if those
(22) very same records are held by a custodian that is
(23) otherwise named, for example, the clerk of the
(24) court, then relief can certainly be provided in this
(25) court.

[Page 25]

(1) MR. HANSON: And, Your Honor, I think one issue
(2) that may arise is what actually qualifies as a
(3) judicial record versus an administrative record.

(4) THE COURT: I anticipate that will be an issue,
(5) sure.

(6) MR. HANSON: Okay.

(7) THE COURT: But they are well-defined terms in
(8) the context of the rules, and I've laid those
(9) definitions out in my alternative writ, so it should
(10) be clear to everybody what it is that I am and am
(11) not doing, at least to the best of my ability. So
(12) we'll go from here.

(13) All right. Miss Schwieterman, you mentioned you
(14) had one more question.

(15) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes. And just so that I'm
(16) clear, you stated that we will be scheduling a CMC,
(17) and then from there we will be scheduling our
(18) evidentiary hearing; is that correct?

(19) THE COURT: If an evidentiary hearing is
(20) necessary, yes.

(21) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Okay.

(22) THE COURT: I mean, my anticipation is the
(23) quickest way for us to get this back for our final
(24) determination is twenty days runs, you all set a CMC
(25) for the twenty-first day, and we get it right on the

[Page 26]

(1) calendar and get it determined. It's not my
(2) inclination to delay any further than that.

(3) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Okay. And then my next
(4) question would be for scheduling purposes, because
(5) this case is in the Thirteenth Circuit, however, you
(6) are not, would it be easier for us to contact your
(7) judicial assistant to get that on your calendar?

(8) THE COURT: Yes. Absolutely.

(9) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Thank you.

(10) THE COURT: All right.

(11) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, just one more
(12) administrative issue and moving forward, depending
(13) on how the order finding a prima facie case in
(14) certain aspects and not in others, if I feel like I
(15) need depositions or discovery, how would I go about
(16) achieving that? I tried to set depositions with
(17) some of the defendants earlier, and I've received no
(18) response or cooperation.

(19) THE COURT: I would anticipate that Rule 1.280
(20) applies to a mandamus petition just as any other
(21) civil action, so I would assume discovery is
(22) available to you. If you're not getting what you
(23) need, then file an appropriate motion.

(24) MR. HANSON: Okay. And then, Your Honor, the
(25) last thing I would offer is that there were things

[Page 27]

(1) in the reply that I put together based upon the
(2) recent response from the attorney general's office
(3) that I would like to argue and offer as argument to
(4) encourage you to strip away certain defenses and
(5) exemptions, because I don't think that they should
(6) apply at this point.

(7) THE COURT: Those are issues that we will
(8) address at the merits hearing. Essentially I
(9) haven't considered anything in the response in
(10) opposition at this juncture. I have limited my
(11) analysis to the consideration of the facial pleading
(12) that you submitted and determined what is and is not
(13) facially sufficient. That's all I've done.

(14) So with regard to any response or reply to their
(15) defenses, those are all preserved and will be
(16) addressed at a merits hearing subsequent to the
(17) filing of the answer; okay?

(18) MR. HANSON: Okay. I just would proffer that
(19) argument, then, just for purposes of the record.

(20) THE COURT: Just make sure it gets in the court
(21) record, Mr. Hanson. I am not going to take up our
(22) time today. We've got limited time set for this
(23) hearing; all right? With that, any further
(24) questions?

(25) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: No, Your Honor.

[Page 28]

(1) THE COURT: All right. I'll get the alternative
(2) writ out momentarily, and thank you all for your
(3) time.

(4) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Thank you.

(5) MR. HANSON: Thank you.

(6) (Hearing adjourned at 2:02 p.m. on
(7) 1/13/26.)

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[Page 29]

(1) STATE OF FLORIDA)

(2) COUNTY OF SARASOTA)

(3)

(4) I, LORIAL L. MILAZZO, Registered Professional

(5) Reporter, certify that I was authorized to and did

(6) stenographically report the foregoing proceedings, pages

(7) 1 through 28, and that the transcript is a true and

(8) complete record of my stenographic notes.

(9)

(10)

(11) DATED this 15th day of January, 2026.

(12)

(13)

(14)

(15)

LORIAL L. MILAZZO, RPR

(16)

Notary Public

(17)

State of Florida

(18)

My Commission #HH 483860

(19)

Expires: March 02, 2028

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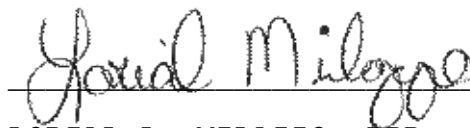
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A A-P-P-E-A-R-A... 2:1 ability 25:11 able 12:4 16:24 22:11 Absolutely 26:8 accelerated 16:6 18:15 access 8:5,17,21,24 13:10 24:17 achieving 26:16 action 8:21 26:21 actions 14:17 actively 4:24,25 add 20:20 addition 9:6 additional 14:13 address 8:16 13:6 21:5 27:8 addressed 27:16 adjourned 28:6 adjust 10:20 Administration 8:4 15:20 administrative 8:6,18 9:4 21:11 24:10,20 25:3 26:12 administrator 1:12 2:8 5:11,19 6:2,5,12,19 affect 10:12 ago 17:6 ahead 9:20 alleged 9:5 allocating 19:21 allow 18:15 19:19 21:22 alternative 7:23 8:8 9:1,11 13:19 14:7,8,23 17:13 18:20 20:14 21:4 22:1 25:9 28:1	amended 7:20,20 7:25 9:13 ample 18:7 analysis 27:11 and/or 1:12 2:7 answer 13:24 14:9 16:18 23:15 27:17 answered 16:14 anticipate 7:18 25:4 26:19 anticipating 21:25 anticipation 25:22 anybody 4:23 apologize 4:6 10:3 10:25 11:18 16:1 20:19 app 11:10,23 Appeared 2:3,7 appellate 8:22 applicable 14:2 applies 26:20 apply 27:6 appreciate 15:22 appropriate 16:6 22:10 26:23 argue 13:17 15:8 22:11,12 27:3 argument 17:14 18:8 19:7 27:3,19 arguments 16:4,9 arrow 10:11,17 11:13,14 askance 10:4 asking 3:8 23:14 aspects 26:14 assert 23:19 assistant 26:7 assume 26:21 attachments 16:11 attorney 1:6 2:10 16:25 27:2 attorney's 7:22 attorney/next 1:6	audio 10:10,12,17 10:18 11:4,5,8,14 11:22 12:9 authorized 29:5 available 26:22 Ayers 1:13 2:8 5:10 5:20 6:10 9:4 21:12 24:9,18 Ayers' 24:14 B back 7:10 10:1 14:11 15:24 16:19 22:19,23 23:11 25:23 barely 9:24 based 27:1 basically 23:13 basis 13:10,13,20 behalf 2:7 5:7,22 believe 5:14 8:19 21:1 best 15:24 25:11 beyond 18:16 bit 11:11 15:17 18:12 bottom 10:10,18 12:9 briefly 13:9 Brittany 3:19 button 11:21 C C 1:12 2:8 5:10 C-K 4:20 cahanson77@y... 2:5 calendar 26:1,7 call 14:23 capacity 6:17 caret 10:16 case 1:2 5:3,6 7:13 7:16 8:11,24 12:20 13:2,14,21 14:2 18:1,5,20 20:6	22:6 23:18 26:5 26:13 cases 8:4 cause 19:4 certain 24:19 26:14 27:4 certainly 15:22 16:15 24:24 certificate 2:16 certify 29:5 chance 9:18 Chapter 9:8 Chief 1:12 2:8 5:9 5:19 6:7 21:12 children 1:7 5:8 Chris 21:12 Christopher 1:5 1:12 2:4,8 5:6,10 5:20 Circle 2:4 circuit 1:1,1,10,11 2:7 3:20 5:5,9,18 6:2 14:14 15:15 26:5 civil 8:2 9:16 15:18 26:21 claims 8:16 9:2 clarification 21:1 clear 20:12,22 21:3 25:10,16 clerk 1:10 5:12 6:13 6:20 24:23 click 10:11,17,18 11:14 12:4 clients 13:22 CMC 12:25 16:17 25:16,24 collectively 9:12 comb 15:19 come 14:11 22:19 coming 7:3 comments 18:22 20:17 Commission
--	--	---	---

29:18 compelled 24:13 complaint 7:21 9:13 complete 29:8 computer 10:4,9 10:22 11:19,24 conclude 13:25 18:23 23:23 concluded 13:15 13:18 conclusion 20:16 conference 7:14 18:6,20 confirm 7:8 confirmed 11:7 consider 14:6 consideration 27:11 considered 27:9 contact 26:6 context 25:8 continue 20:3,4,6 cooperation 26:18 correct 6:25 14:18 21:7,8,17,18 24:11 24:13,15 25:18 County 1:1 5:6 29:2 couple 17:6 course 8:24 court 1:1,11,12 2:7 3:2,5,7,9,13,16,18 3:21,23 4:2,7,11,16 4:20,22 5:5,9,11 5:12,19,22 6:2,5,5 6:9,11,11,13,20,22 7:2,7,8,10 8:6,15 8:22 10:2,8,15 11:2,7,12,22 12:2 12:10,15,19 13:2,7 13:12 14:14,18 15:10,11,15 16:7,19	16:23 17:2,5,10,18 17:22 18:15,17,19 19:2,6,11,16,21 20:10,13,18,21 21:8,10,18,21,25 22:2,4,13,22 23:2 23:7,12 24:6,11,12 24:15,24,25 25:4 25:7,19,22 26:8 26:10,19 27:7,20 27:20 28:1 Court's 7:17 12:21 19:23 cover 24:9 Crist 5:12 6:14 critical 10:6 current 1:12 2:7 6:2 custodian 8:21 24:12,17,19,22 custodians 9:6 cut 16:7	defense 23:19 defenses 23:19 27:4,15 defined 9:13 24:20 definitions 25:9 delay 11:1 12:1 15:12,25 16:2,20 26:2 demonstrated 19:11 denied 8:20 24:16 denying 8:24 20:11 depending 26:12 depositions 26:15 26:16 determination 14:11 17:13,25 20:14 22:9 23:16 23:17 25:24 determined 26:1 27:12 directing 9:12 23:25 Directly 10:14 discovery 26:15,21 dismiss 13:24 14:9 dispute 7:12 document 13:15 documentation 16:23 documented 19:3 doing 9:17 25:11 drafting 8:14 13:9 draw 8:12 due 14:21 15:4	easier 26:6 Eden 2:4 educating 15:23 empathy 18:12 enable 20:13 encapsulate 23:13 encourage 27:4 ensure 21:2 entered 21:16 entitled 18:2 22:14 23:19,24 entitlement 9:8 equitably 19:22 esoteric 15:17 Esq 2:4,9 essentially 7:14 20:5 21:10 27:8 establish 8:11 established 13:14 19:2 22:6 23:18 establishing 8:9 EVAN 1:19 events 16:5 18:13 everybody 3:3,3 25:10 evidence 18:7 22:12 23:22 evidentiary 12:25 25:18,19 example 24:18,23 exceptions 9:10 Excuse 7:3 exempt 9:2 exemptions 27:5 exhaustive 18:4 exhaustively 19:3 expect 18:14 expedited 14:16 15:2 16:3,13,15 expiration 12:23 16:18 Expires 29:19 explained 19:23 explanation 24:5
D			
date 1:21 16:5 18:14 21:16 DATED 29:11 dates 21:3 day 25:25 29:11 days 14:25 15:5,8 17:6 18:16 21:16 25:24 DCA 8:25 24:21 decide 13:2 decision 22:15 decisions 8:23 19:9 declaratory 7:21 9:8 defendants 1:14 2:7 5:23 9:12 26:17 defendants' 12:22 defending 14:14			
E			
E 2:4,10 e-filed 17:8 e-mail 17:5 e-mailed 17:8 earlier 26:17 early 17:8,8			

extent 9:1,5 13:1 extraordinary 14:20 F F 3:25 face 13:15 facial 27:11 facially 27:13 facie 8:11 9:7 13:14 13:20 18:1 22:6 23:18 26:13 fact 19:24 facts 16:6 17:16,24 17:24 18:3 fair 19:1 20:23 familiar 15:16 16:12 fashion 18:4 feel 26:14 fees 7:22 Felix 1:13 2:8 5:11 5:21 6:10 9:4 21:13 figure 23:5 file 14:1,4,5,9 26:23 filed 8:22 16:14 17:11 filing 12:22 27:17 filings 19:12 final 25:23 finalizing 8:8 find 13:19 15:20 finding 8:9,15 26:13 fine 12:15 first 9:21 13:5 14:8 14:22 15:13 floor 9:20 19:10 20:23 Florida 1:1,25 2:5 2:11 5:6 9:15 29:1 29:17 foregoing 29:6	form 19:3 formally 15:9 formerly 6:2 forthwith 20:15 forty-five 23:4 forward 26:12 found 9:7 frame 20:2 Frank 4:1,2 frantic 23:10 FRAYMAN 1:19 freeze 22:16 23:8 friend 1:6 Frontage 2:10 froze 23:3 frozen 22:17 full 15:11 18:16 further 16:20 17:14 19:1 20:11 21:19 26:2 27:23 G G 1:19 general 2:10 8:3 9:16 15:20 general's 16:25 27:2 getting 26:22 Gina 1:11 2:7 5:11 5:18 6:3,12,16 give 4:13 7:15 8:13 9:18 14:20 15:4,5 20:1,23 22:17 given 16:2 18:13 23:21 gives 14:14,25 giving 19:10 go 4:9 5:24 7:10 9:19,20 10:11 11:14 12:4,8 13:13 25:12 26:15 going 5:1,23 6:6 9:11,18,25 14:1,12 16:7 17:14,22,23	18:21 19:6,14 20:1 21:21 22:3,17 23:14 24:8 27:21 good 3:9 govern 8:4 grant 14:22 granting 9:1 19:24 ground 18:17 guarantee 16:9 guess 5:3 7:15 11:19 22:20 H hand 10:2 handset 10:25 Hanson 1:5 2:4 3:13,15,25 4:1,2,3 4:5 5:6 6:24 7:1 9:18,22 10:5,14,23 11:4,10,18,25 12:6 12:12,17 13:5,8 14:12 15:7,13 16:2 16:7,24 17:3,7,15 17:19,19,20 18:10 18:18,25 19:2,5,14 19:18 20:7,19,21 21:22,23 22:2,19 22:21,24,25 23:4 23:9 24:3,7,12 25:1,6 26:11,24 27:18,21 28:5 happen 14:22 happened 9:23 22:25 headed 7:18 heading 12:20 hear 3:3,5,10,13 4:3,6,8 7:4,7,8,9 9:24 10:5 12:14,15 12:16 13:5,7 17:14 17:16 18:2 heard 23:7 hearing 1:18 13:1 15:2 16:8,16 18:6	18:8 19:7,22 20:2 20:4,16 22:10 23:20,21,23 25:18 25:19 27:8,16,23 28:6 held 1:18 24:22 Hello 4:10,11 help 11:2 helping 20:6 Henderson 4:18 4:19,21 12:3,8,10 12:11 HH 29:18 Hi 4:18 Hillsborough 1:1 5:5 hold 5:22 9:25 22:22 honest 15:12 honor 3:7,11,15,25 4:6 5:16 7:1 9:22 11:5,18,25 12:13,17 13:8 14:13 15:7 16:24 17:15 18:10 19:19 20:19,25 22:2,18 24:3 25:1 26:11,24 27:25 HONORABLE 1:19 hope 18:11 hundred 11:17 15:15 I I-N-D-E-X 2:15 icon 12:4 idea 8:13 identify 3:18,23,24 4:16 immediate 7:23 immediately 16:17 20:15 impact 22:20 impatient 9:23
--	--	--	--

important 20:7 inclination 26:2 including 16:11,16 incorporated 8:1 indicated 12:20 individual 8:17 9:3 24:9 individually 1:5 5:7 input 10:20 interim 6:3 introduce 7:15 involved 7:11 iPhone 4:13,15 issuance 7:23 issue 12:12 13:18 14:8 15:3,10 17:13 20:15 25:1,4 26:12 issues 21:5 27:7 issuing 9:11 14:7 21:4,4 item 10:18	juncture 27:10 jurisdiction 8:10 8:16,23 21:14 jurisdictional 21:5 Justice 1:11 2:7 5:11,19 6:3,12,16 justification 24:5	lot 15:8	morning 17:8,9 motion 7:22 13:24 14:9 15:14 16:14 26:23 move 18:21 moving 26:12 mute 4:4,9 5:1 7:5 7:10 11:21 17:23 muted 20:21
J	K	M	N
January 1:21 29:11 Jenny 4:7 JESSICA 2:9 jessica.schwiet... 2:11 joined 4:15 joining 4:13 12:13 judge 1:12,13,13 2:8,8,8 5:9,10,10 5:19,20,21 6:7,10 6:10 8:20,23 9:3 21:12,12,13 24:9 24:14,16,18 judges 9:3 17:17 24:9 judicial 1:1,10,11 2:7 5:5,9,18 6:1 8:3,5,17 15:19 25:3 26:7 jump 14:3,6	K-K 4:20 Kelly 1:13 2:8 5:10 5:20 21:12 kind 7:15 10:5 15:19,24 know 10:2 11:22 12:5 22:25	ma'am 3:6 4:4 making 16:1 19:9 management 7:13 18:5,20 mandamus 7:21 7:24,25 8:8 14:16 15:14 18:21 20:14 23:17 26:20 March 29:19 materials 18:11 Matt 7:5 matter 9:9 16:19 Matthew 1:13 2:8 5:11,21 21:13 mean 25:22 meeting 12:13 memorandum 8:1 mentioned 24:8 25:13 merits 13:2,17 14:3 14:11 15:3 17:12 18:8 19:7 22:8 23:16,20,21 27:8 27:16 microphone 10:17 10:20 11:12,13,20 Mike 1:13 5:12 6:12 6:21 Milazzo 1:24 3:5 29:4,15 minor 1:7 5:8 minute 4:14 22:17 misspoke 24:3 moment 5:22 9:19 22:22 momentarily 28:2 monopolize 20:3 Moore 1:13 5:12 6:13,21	N-I-K-K-I 4:21 name 3:19,25 named 24:23 nature 16:3 necessary 13:12 16:21 25:20 need 14:15 18:2,13 21:6 26:15,23 neither 6:21 new 18:19 Nikki 4:18 Notary 1:24 29:16 notes 29:8 notice 16:8 notwithstanding 9:10 Number 5:3
	L		O
	L 29:4,15 lack 9:7 laid 25:8 land 7:16 Lanham 7:4,5,6,9 Large 1:25 law 8:1 14:2 lay 7:16 LEE 2:9 left 10:10 12:21 13:3 Let's 3:2 level 10:12 15:15 limited 27:10,22 line 22:23 list 5:24 listen 17:22 19:6 literally 24:15 little 10:16 11:11,13 15:17 log 11:19 longer 6:18 looking 10:3 looks 4:12 7:2 Lorial 1:24 29:4,15		objection 16:25 observer 3:16 observers 4:23 obviously 13:23 occur 22:15 offer 24:4 26:25 27:3 office 2:10 27:2 officers 8:17 official 6:17 Oh 11:4 okay 3:21 4:22 5:22 6:5,7,9,22 10:2 11:2 12:2,14

15:7 16:2 17:23 18:9 19:9,13 21:9 21:15 23:2 24:6 25:6,21 26:3,24 27:17,18 old 1:7,7 18:17 Once 22:7 open 10:19 21:21 opened 9:20 opportunity 7:14 13:23 14:21,24 18:7 20:1,24 23:21 opposition 7:24 14:5 27:10 options 14:13 order 9:14 13:9,13 15:20 16:16 21:2 21:16 22:3 23:14 23:25 24:4 26:13 ordered 21:25 ordering 21:25 22:4 output 10:19 11:15	persuaded 23:24 petition 7:20,25 13:17 15:14 17:1 23:17 26:20 petitioner 5:7 9:21 phone 10:24,25 11:3,10,23 place 1:23 18:14 Plaintiffs 1:8 planning 13:4 pleading 9:9 27:11 please 3:17 4:17 7:7 pled 13:20 point 18:18 20:4 27:6 position 6:4 16:12 18:12 Practice 8:3 15:20 precise 15:16 preference 20:8 preliminary 14:23 17:12,25 present 18:7,8,19 22:12 23:22 presented 19:8 preserved 27:15 press 20:4 prima 8:11 9:7 13:14,20 18:1 22:6 23:18 26:13 prior 6:11 Pro 2:3 probably 23:4 problem 10:22 procedurally 13:18 procedure 8:2 9:16 15:16,18,21 23:15 24:2 proceed 5:2 proceeding 4:24 5:1,4 proceedings 29:6 process 8:7,14	14:6,21 15:4,23 22:5 production 22:3,4 23:14 24:1 Professional 29:4 proffer 27:18 provided 24:24 provides 14:16 public 1:24 13:10 29:16 purpose 12:25 purposes 26:4 27:19 pursuant 12:24 purview 21:13 put 5:23 27:1	regarding 21:24 Registered 29:4 rehash 16:21 reiterate 18:3 19:10 relate 8:17 related 18:19 relief 7:21 9:8 15:14 16:13 19:25 22:9,14 23:25 24:21,24 remain 5:1 remedies 14:20 remember 23:10 reply 16:25 27:1,14 report 29:6 REPORTED 1:24 reporter 3:5,7 29:5 Reporter's 2:16 represent 5:14 representation 6:15 representing 4:25 5:17 6:24 7:11 request 8:20 16:13 16:15 20:9,11 21:11 23:22 24:16 requested 19:25 required 13:1,18 requires 14:20 22:6 respond 9:12 13:23 14:21,24 15:4 18:2 20:2,24 21:6 responded 22:8 respondents 5:13 5:15,17 response 7:24 8:12 12:24 14:1,5 16:15 18:1 22:7 26:18 27:2,9,14 responses 12:23
P P-R-O-C-E-E-D... 3:1 p.m 1:22,22 28:6 pages 29:6 paralegal 3:19,20 part 13:16 participating 4:24,25 parties 12:24 16:17 19:22 party 7:3,11 path 16:6 18:15 percent 11:17 15:15 Perfect 6:22 period 9:14 person 4:14 11:3 perspective 7:17 12:21 19:24 persuade 22:12		Q qualifies 25:2 question 22:20 24:7 25:14 26:4 questions 21:20 21:24 27:24 quickest 25:23 quickly 5:2	
		R Raddatz 4:8,10 read 16:10,24 18:3 reading 7:6 received 26:17 record 16:4,22 18:13 19:1,3,8,16 20:8,11,12 21:11 25:3,3 27:19,21 29:8 records 8:5,6,6,18 8:21 9:4,6 13:11 23:23 24:1,10,14 24:17,19,20,22 refusing 18:25 19:19 regard 15:12,25 27:14	

responsibility 15:11 retreading 18:17 review 8:23 13:9 14:15,16 18:11 reviewed 7:19,22 8:1 17:19,23,24 right 3:2,4,10,13,14 3:16 4:2,4,7,8,12 4:20,22 6:11,22 6:23 7:2,4,5,10,13 12:19 13:5,10 14:3 14:25 15:4 16:3 20:10 21:21 22:22 23:12 25:13,25 26:10 27:23 28:1 Road 2:10 Roc 2:4 role 6:18,19 room 4:13 23:6 RPR 1:24 29:15 rule 8:12,18 9:15 12:24 14:15,18 16:3 21:18 26:19 ruled 20:5 rules 8:2,3 9:15 14:3,25 15:18,19 24:2 25:8 runs 25:24	6:1,7,10,16 13:7,22 15:23 18:21,24 20:1,17,24,25 21:9 21:15,19 22:18 25:13,15,21 26:3,9 27:25 28:4 screen 7:6 10:4,10 10:19 Se 2:3 second 8:25 10:1 24:21 seconds 23:5 see 3:3 10:6 11:16 11:20,21 12:6,7 seeing 11:21 seek 24:21 seeking 8:5 21:1 22:10 seen 15:13 17:10 sense 9:16 sent 17:3 separate 12:14 served 5:17,23 6:12 6:13,14,16,19,21 15:9 set 12:24 15:2 16:17 25:24 26:16 27:22 setting 11:8 12:5 12:25 settings 10:8,12,18 11:14,23 12:8 show 11:15 showing 9:7 side 11:24 22:7 simply 14:3 19:10 sir 4:6,10 7:5,9 slash 14:9 slowly 5:24 SMS931U 3:22,24 somebody 4:15,25 sorry 3:25 4:5 11:4 11:25 sort 7:15 10:3 12:20 15:3	sought 21:11 22:14 speak 9:19,21 19:20 speaker 10:25 11:16 speakers 10:21 specifically 5:24 8:19 14:18 speed 15:25 State 1:1,25 29:1,17 stated 25:16 states 8:20 stating 19:4 stenographic 29:8 stenographically 29:6 step 14:22 straight 15:18 straightforward 22:5 strip 27:4 style 5:6 submissions 16:10 submitted 16:12 16:23 27:12 subsequent 27:16 substance 16:9 substantive 18:6 sufficient 13:20 20:13 27:13 Suite 2:10 supporting 23:22 sure 3:2 11:9 23:2 23:3 25:5 27:20 suspense 8:13	technically 14:5 tell 8:7 telling 19:14 terms 13:3 18:10 25:7 test 10:21 11:15 thank 3:7,12,21 12:10,17 21:15,19 26:9 28:2,4,5 thing 12:21 13:3 20:20 23:7 26:25 things 21:5 26:25 think 5:7 7:16,19 11:7 15:24 17:5 20:7 25:1 27:5 Thirteenth 1:1,10 1:11 2:7 3:20 5:4,9 5:18 6:1 14:14 26:5 thoughts 9:20 time 1:22 9:14 11:5 12:23 13:4 15:13 16:18 19:21 20:2 20:23 27:22,22 28:3 timelines 14:13 today 17:4,6,11 19:9 27:22 Tracy 4:3 transcript 29:7 tried 26:16 trouble 11:11 true 29:7 try 10:1 23:12 trying 23:5,10,10 24:7 turned 10:21,23 11:8,16 twenty 14:25 15:5 15:8 18:16 21:16 25:24 twenty-first 25:25 two 9:10 10:8
S Sabella 1:12 2:8 5:10,20 6:8 9:3 21:12 Samsung 3:22,24 SARASOTA 29:2 saying 17:21 19:18 21:10 23:13 says 13:13 14:19 24:16 scheduling 22:20 25:16,17 26:4 Schwieterman 2:9 3:10,11 5:14,16	T T 4:5 tab 10:10 take 15:11 27:21 taken 18:14 Tampa 2:5,11		

U understand 4:22 9:22 14:2 16:13 17:15,20 19:18 24:4 understanding 6:20 unidentified 3:17 unmute 3:17,23 4:15 7:7 21:22,23 unnecessary 19:12 V v 1:9 vacant 6:3 verified 7:20 versus 25:3 Victor 5:12 6:14 videoconference 1:23 volume 9:24 10:1 10:6,8,12,15,19,20 11:15 volume-wise 11:9 voluminous 16:10 19:12 W waiting 4:13 want 13:8 14:10 17:16 20:20 21:2 22:11 wanted 9:19 warranting 8:11 18:1 wasn't 9:22 10:6 15:15 17:6 way 10:21,23 11:8 11:17 13:24 14:21 25:23 we'll 5:2 14:23 25:12 we're 7:13,18 13:16	15:3 17:11 18:5,17 22:17 We've 27:22 welcome 12:11 well-defined 25:7 well-established 16:22 went 10:3,25 words 24:18 work 11:23 24:2 works 15:21 writ 7:21,23,25 8:8 9:2,11 13:19 14:7,8 14:23 17:13 18:20 20:14 21:4 22:1 25:9 28:2 writing 19:17 written 16:3 X Y Yeah 10:15,23 11:22 12:6 years 1:7,7 Z Zoom 7:6 10:10,14 10:15 11:23 o o2 29:19 1 1 29:7 1.140 8:12 9:15 14:10 21:18 1.280 26:19 1.630 14:19 15:1 1/13/26 28:7 1:30 1:22 13 1:21 15th 29:11 2	2.420 14:19 2.420(1) 8:19 14:15 2:02 1:22 28:6 200 2:10 2026 1:21 29:11 2028 29:19 25- 5:3 25-CA-10255 1:2 5:4 28 29:7 29 2:16 3 33607 2:11 33634 2:5 3507 2:10 3934 2:4 4 483860 29:18 5 6 6 1:7 7 8 8 1:7 86 9:9
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EXHIBIT 2

Hearing Transcript — Feb. 6, 2026 (Successor Assignment; Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-02-06 | 96 pp.

[Page 1]

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually
and as attorney for himself and
attorney/next friend for his minor
children,

Plaintiff/Petitioner,

vs.

CASE NO. 25-CA-10255

DIVISION: B

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
CLERK OF THE COURT (CINDY STUART),
GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT
ADMINISTRATOR), CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER
C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE
MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE,

Defendant/Respondent.

_____ /

PLACE: PINELLAS COUNTY Justice CENTER
14250 49th Street
Courtroom A
Clearwater, FL

DATE: February 6, 2026
Commencing at 9:30 a.m.

REPORTED BY: MARIA E. RODRIGUEZ, RPR, FPR-C
Certified Court Reporter
Notary Public at Large

MOTIONS For IMMEDIATE RELIEF And
RECONSIDERATION Of INCOMPLETE ORDER And
IMMEDIATE ASSIGNMENT OF NEUTRAL SUCCESSOR

1 - 79

[Page 2]

(1) A P P E A R A N C E

(2)

(3)

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(4)

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(25)

[Page 3]

(1) WHEREUPON, the following proceedings were
(2) stenographically reported, via Zoom videoconferencing,
(3) and transcribed as follows:

(4) THE COURT: All right. Good morning,
(5) everybody. My name is Judge Sherwood
(6) Coleman. We'll be on the record at this
(7) time in Case 25-CA-010255, which is 13th
(8) Circuit case being heard here in Pinellas
(9) County by assignment of the Florida Supreme
(10) Court.

(11) I was assigned and, therefore, asked
(12) the parties to appear remotely or otherwise
(13) for this hearing today. It's been noticed
(14) for a hearing for Motion for Immediate
(15) Relief and Reconsideration of Incomplete
(16) Order and Immediate Assignment of Neutral
(17) Successor that's been filed by The Plaintiff
(18) in this matter.

(19) I'll have The Plaintiff announce
(20) themselves and make their appearance for the
(21) record, and then I'll have The Defendant who
(22) is present identify themselves and make
(23) their appearance for the record.

(24) Appearing on behalf of The Plaintiff?

(25) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor,

[Page 4]

(1) this is Chris Hanson as Plaintiff and
(2) attorney for Plaintiff.

(3) THE COURT: All right. And counsel
(4) present here in the courtroom, if you want
(5) to state your names and the party that you
(6) represent?

(7) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes, Your Honor.
(8) Jessica Schwieterman on behalf the 13th
(9) Judicial Circuit as well as the judges and
(10) the court administrator.

(11) THE COURT: All right.

(12) MS. WILKERSON: Good morning, Your
(13) Honor. My name is Keiana Wilkerson. I'm
(14) appearing on behalf of The Clerk of the
(15) Court for Hillsborough County.

(16) THE COURT: All right. Very well. I
(17) think that's everybody we have present. And
(18) just for clarity of the record, upon request
(19) of The Plaintiff and under the discretion
(20) permitted to The Court under the Rules of
(21) Judicial Administration and General
(22) Practice, The Court did afford everyone the
(23) opportunity to appear by Zoom using
(24) communication technology as allowed by The
(25) Rules here. You know, Mr. Hanson, is using

[Page 5]

(1) communication technology.

(2) If there is any disruption or
(3) connection or anything else, Mr. Hanson, I
(4) will pause right away and wait for you to
(5) reconnect for five minutes. And if you
(6) haven't reconnected, you'll want to get in
(7) touch with my judicial assistant
(8) electronically so we can try work through
(9) those issues, but we won't continue any
(10) proceedings unless all of us are connected
(11) and able to see and hear each other. Okay?

(12) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor.

(13) THE COURT: The staff attorney who is
(14) also on the Zoom. First name is L-U-Z.
(15) Last name spelled, B-A-S-T-O-S.

(16) Mr. Hanson, this your motion as the
(17) moving party. I'll have you proceed
(18) first.

(19) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor.
(20) And I appreciate you allowing me to attend
(21) by Zoom. And also giving us a couple of
(22) hours here to address these issues. So I'll
(23) start by addressing the most recent motion
(24) relating to Judge Frayman's
(25) disqualifications.

[Page 6]

(1) And it really goes back to the writ
(2) that he entered. The writ that he enters is
(3) problematic in several ways. He raised
(4) affirmative defenses for The Defendant that
(5) they hadn't raised. And under the case law
(6) that I've cited in my Motion for Immediate
(7) Relief filed here at Docket 52. And, I
(8) believe, there's also some case law on it at
(9) Docket Number 49, which is the Motion to
(10) Vacate the Writ that Judge Frayman had
(11) entered.

(12) And not only did he raise defenses that
(13) Defendant hadn't raised, he ruled on them.
(14) And he literally muted me. He wouldn't let
(15) me create a record. So he's acting as
(16) defense counsel and eliminating any opposing
(17) view, not even allowing me to express the
(18) facts of the case.

(19) And, Your Honor, I'm not here by choice
(20) or because I like to be a troublemaker.
(21) I've litigated workers comp for 16 years,
(22) which is high-volume, intense litigation.
(23) I've never had a bar against me; I never
(24) made a bar complaint against anyone. I am
(25) not a troublemaker.

[Page 7]

(1) I have a very painful issue in my
(2) underlying divorce, which involves some
(3) betrayal, and I would like some discovery
(4) related to it. Two attorneys told me it was
(5) routine and I would get it.

(6) All I've encountered in trying to
(7) accomplish that is corruption and
(8) obstruction. And I use those words openly
(9) now because I've used kinder terms for a
(10) year, and it just continues.

(11) And it's become something that is
(12) multiple levels of it. I drafted a document
(13) and posted on Twitter it's included with
(14) Docket Number, I believe, it's 37. Yeah. I
(15) believe it's an attachment to Docket Number
(16) 37, which is the Motion for Immediate Writ
(17) that was filed.

(18) And it explains the progression of
(19) Judge Ayers not doing anything about Judge
(20) Davis' conduct. The chief judge supporting
(21) Judge Ayers. Concealing the documents and
(22) the video that's at issue in this case. The
(23) Florida Bar not following their own rules or
(24) even opening an investigation on a 25-page
(25) Bar complaint that describes in detail

[Page 8]

(1) unrefuted, intentional and ongoing actions
(2) that are harming me and my kids that have no
(3) basis in fact or law.

(4) It simple obstruction. My kids have
(5) been weaponized with no basis in fact or law
(6) for doing it. The timing of it makes it
(7) clear that it's intentional in efforts to
(8) push me off of this simple discovery issue
(9) regarding concealed marital assets.

(10) I pleaded with The Court back in May of
(11) 2024 for efficiency. I didn't want this to
(12) effect my children. I wanted to move
(13) through the situation efficiently.

(14) And I think, Your Honor, if you follow
(15) the steps that I've taken, I don't know how
(16) anyone could disagree with any of the things
(17) that I've done, given what I've encountered.

(18) My choices are to allow corruption into
(19) my family and control our future, and allow
(20) an unethical bullying attorney to be
(21) dishonest and place my family at risk of
(22) further damage by just rolling over and just
(23) letting the corruption take over or one can
(24) do exactly what I've done, Your Honor.

(25) And I've told the truth at every single

[Page 9]

(1) step. And the number of judges and
(2) attorneys that have looked at this -- and I
(3) know they look at it and think, "Wow, this
(4) is pretty extreme." But the go-to highest
(5) value of those that reviewed it so far is
(6) protecting insiders.

(7) Insiders have done some pretty bad
(8) things here and consequences are necessary
(9) because people are getting hurt by the bad
(10) and dishonest and unethical things that are
(11) happening. And nobody wants to hear about
(12) that.

(13) Judge Frayman was so bothered by what I
(14) had written that he couldn't even allow me
(15) to speak. He had just bias and hostility
(16) towards me, and I really hope that he would
(17) provide an explanation for why that is,
(18) given that the only explanation I see is the
(19) systemic insider protectionism that this
(20) case exemplifies throughout.

(21) I had just filed the article -- the
(22) dockets regard the courthouse I believe a
(23) day or two before that January 13th hearing,
(24) and Judge Frayman's actions throughout it
(25) exemplifies exactly what the article says.

[Page 10]

(1) And I'm in a situation now wherein my
(2) underlying family law case, one of the
(3) defendants in this case is still the judge
(4) refusing to step aside. And he has control
(5) over evidence that could be harmful to
(6) himself. He's able to protect himself in
(7) the manner in which he handles my case, but
(8) the 13th Circuit has him continuing on as my
(9) judge.

(10) The absurdity of that, that is a
(11) structural conflict. Anything that he does
(12) is void ab initio. I just had a hearing on
(13) Monday where I explained all of that, yet he
(14) continues to persists on the case. And he
(15) has -- we have a hearing coming up on a
(16) guardian ad litem issue where the defense
(17) counsel has suppressed information from the
(18) kid's school to explain how wonderfully
(19) they're doing. They don't see therapists.
(20) They are happy, healthy, strong kids. And
(21) their using them as pawns, and the courts
(22) are just supporting that.

(23) And if one looks at the facts, this
(24) isn't a gray issue. There is no gray. One
(25) of the things that I'm requesting is

[Page 11]

(1) materials related to an April, 2025 request
(2) from Judge Ayers. We had attended a hearing
(3) on the guardian ad litem on April 4th of
(4) 2025, the video of which is one of the main
(5) things at issue here.

(6) But Judge Ayers asked Mr. Davis to
(7) write up a summary of his client's
(8) testimony. And he initially agreed to do
(9) it, but then failed to do it and then on a
(10) hearing on April 22nd, after I had already
(11) filed a motion compelling him -- I wanted
(12) him to comply with The Court's instructions
(13) to complete the summary -- because he's
(14) never once throughout this matter provided
(15) any written justification for a guardian ad
(16) litem for my kids.

(17) He's just gotten away with just vague
(18) insinuations, actually using as evidence to
(19) support the need for a guardian ad litem my
(20) filing from May of 2024 where I explain how
(21) difficult this was for me and how I was
(22) undergoing some treatment because it was so
(23) stressful.

(24) And I've done incredibly well since
(25) then, my kids continue to do well. But the

[Page 12]

(1) amount of stress that I'm under and knowing
(2) that my career as an attorney is probably
(3) over, in at least Florida. I'm probably the
(4) most hated attorney in Hillsborough County
(5) because I've told the truth.

(6) And that's a pretty upsetting situation
(7) to find myself in when I've got two young
(8) kids that I need to support. So Judge
(9) Frayman's dismissal of me and my situation
(10) is a pretty traumatic development. It shows
(11) actual animosity. And I won't go so far as
(12) hatred, but the transcript probably doesn't
(13) do justice of how aggressive he was to my
(14) simple request for acknowledgement of my
(15) constitutional rights to due process and
(16) transparency.

(17) So going back to Judge Frayman's order,
(18) so he raised defenses not raised by
(19) Defendants, ruled on them while silencing
(20) me, and there is no notice provided to me
(21) that we were going to be discussing any of
(22) this.

(23) And then he gives The Defendants a
(24) do-over in responding to the Petition for
(25) Writ of Mandamus. They were served December

[Page 13]

(1) 19th. Their response was due and was filed,
(2) I believe, it was January 8th. I believe
(3) that's at Docket Number 40. And then I
(4) filed a reply to that at Docket Number 45.
(5) But there is no basis under the law to
(6) order -- or to give them an additional 20
(7) days to do what was already due a week
(8) before the hearing.

(9) So that's unlawful. And raising the
(10) defenses is unlawful. And when one looks at
(11) the facts, the 13th Circuit has failed to
(12) refute my allegations that they have
(13) intentionally concealed records. Your
(14) Honor, there's case law of what happens to
(15) attorneys when they do stuff like that, but
(16) when judges do stuff like that, the response
(17) is to protect them? To help them along the
(18) process in giving them more time to figure
(19) out a way to better hide the records?
(20) That's not a sustainable system.

(21) And I'm in a unique position that I can
(22) do something about this because I've
(23) litigated discovery issues for many years.
(24) And it really frightens me to think this may
(25) be happening much more often than what's

[Page 14]

(1) getting reported. And the fact that the
(2) courts have been so slow to acknowledge it
(3) and so quick to silence me and attempt to
(4) discredit me and paint me as a disgruntled
(5) litigant and a bad father all baselessly.

(6) It's very problematic, Your Honor. So
(7) there's nothing under the facts that would
(8) suggest or support such deviation from we're
(9) at a hearing whereas responsible and
(10) completed. I filed a Motion for Immediate
(11) writ. I have issues on appeal that are
(12) directly related to the public records
(13) request. So every part of his order is
(14) unlawful except for where he does note that
(15) I've demonstrated a prima facie case for
(16) mandamus relief. So that part is correct,
(17) but everything else isn't.

(18) Everything else is delays, bias,
(19) insider systemic protectionism motivated.
(20) And, Your Honor, I don't envy the position
(21) you're in. I regret that I'm coming to The
(22) Court in this situation, but I beg of you to
(23) look at the records, and look at the
(24) conduct. Look of the lack of any
(25) allegations from The Defendants that even

[Page 15]

(1) refute my statements of fact.

(2) The truth exists and I've documented it
(3) throughout here. As I've seen corruption,
(4) I've documented it. And The Court's base
(5) function is to find the truth and operate in
(6) the truth. And the record that I have here
(7) shows that Florida courts are doing
(8) everything that they can to suppress and
(9) avoid the truth when it comes to insider
(10) misconduct.

(11) And I plead with this court to put a
(12) stop to that today. And, Your Honor, I
(13) can -- it's such a long history now I can
(14) get into stuff with The Florida Bar, the
(15) DCAs. And, Your Honor, I will, but I know
(16) I've been talking for a long time, so I'll
(17) pause here. But I just want to state this:
(18) Part of the problem is that so many have
(19) looked the other way and allowed this to
(20) continue that the scope of it is terrifying.

(21) And the number of hours I'm putting in
(22) trying to protect my rights and my kids,
(23) it's not sustainable, Your Honor. So I just
(24) beg of you to put a stop to this today. To
(25) order production of the documents

[Page 16]

(1) immediately. And, Your Honor, thank you for
(2) giving me the time and opportunity to at
(3) least put that on the record.

(4) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, you're
(5) certainly welcome to make any remarks or any
(6) other things like that. I want to make sure
(7) that each litigant before this the court is
(8) fully heard. So I do want to like, I guess,
(9) narrow the focus a little bit.

(10) As you indicated, there is quite a
(11) broad scope of things that are raised by
(12) your remarks today. But the matter that's
(13) been noticed for hearing, which as you --
(14) you were describing one of the issues you
(15) had with Judge Frayman's hearing was that
(16) things were brought up that weren't noticed.

(17) I want to make sure we stay focused on
(18) what's noticed for hearing here today, so
(19) that I can rule on that. I'm not ruling on
(20) a whole case today. I'm not addressing the
(21) whole scope of issues that you might have
(22) today. I find it better to move in clearly
(23) defined steps so the litigants can know what
(24) they're responding to and what they're
(25) arguing for.

[Page 17]

(1) So what I want to move forward to now
(2) would be -- given the background that you've
(3) brought to The Court, let's talk about your
(4) requested relief for this motion, and then
(5) I'll -- and then I'll permit a response, if
(6) counsel wishing to make it.

(7) So the motion that I've pulled from the
(8) Hillsborough County docket that's noticed
(9) today identifies four specific classes of
(10) relief that you're asking The Court to grant
(11) you based upon this motion here today.

(12) Do you -- do you have that motion?

(13) MR. HANSON: I do, Your Honor.

(14) THE COURT: Okay. So I'm just moving
(15) down just so that we can all stay on the
(16) same page and figuratively here.

(17) MR. HANSON: Sure.

(18) THE COURT: The filing stamp indicates
(19) it's page 6. I assume it's also page 6 in
(20) the wherefore clause?

(21) MR. HANSON: Yes Your Honor.

(22) THE COURT: All right. So there's four
(23) separate sections there that I've got
(24) highlighted for the relief that you're
(25) asking The Court to grant as a result of

[Page 18]

(1) this motion. And so maybe if I could have
(2) you address those for me, I'll ask here and
(3) then it will be easier for me to line up the
(4) responses that counsel may wish to make to
(5) those particular prongs of the relief.

(6) So first let's address number one,
(7) which requests that The Court immediately
(8) assign this case to a neutral judge outside
(9) the 13th Judicial Circuit. I stopped at the
(10) comma there. I think that's the essential
(11) clause of the sentence of which you're
(12) asking for.

(13) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, are you done
(14) or did you --

(15) THE COURT: Yes. No. Go ahead. Go
(16) ahead.

(17) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor. I
(18) think that's likely moot -- I appreciate
(19) that you made time this week and you got
(20) this on the calendar. So I do not have
(21) specific relief in that regard that I'm
(22) asking at this time.

(23) THE COURT: Okay. And I know maybe the
(24) core of what we're talking about is in
(25) number two and number three, but let me move

[Page 19]

(1) to number four just to address that. That
(2) may be an issue that's not -- there's a
(3) different type. Since two and three are
(4) interlocking; in other words, I'd rather
(5) move to four.

(6) Prong four you are asking for this
(7) court to transfer the underlying family law
(8) case to a neutral circuit. I don't
(9) believe -- but I'm going to hear your
(10) argument on -- it's not immediately apparent
(11) to me whether I would have the authority to
(12) grant you the relief requested by paragraph
(13) four of your wherefore clause.

(14) Is that correct or do you have
(15) different authority that you wish for The
(16) Court to consider?

(17) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, that's not
(18) something that I've had time to specifically
(19) research, in all candor. My argument is
(20) that Judge Felix is a defendant in
(21) proceedings before you. And I assume that
(22) you want a fair process where the evidence
(23) comes out as it should and every party has a
(24) fair chance.

(25) Safe assumptions, Your Honor?

[Page 20]

(1) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson I don't know why
(2) you would assume anything different about
(3) me.

(4) MR. HANSON: Okay. Your Honor, and
(5) that's where I would beg of you to look at
(6) the history here.

(7) THE COURT: Look, I understand you want
(8) me to look at the history, and there's
(9) probably stages in the case where The Court
(10) is going to get ample opportunity to look at
(11) all sorts of things, I would assume, but
(12) I've also learned not to make assumptions,
(13) so I try to proceed in small incremental
(14) steps and move forward carefully.

(15) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor.

(16) THE COURT: So step four of your
(17) wherefore clause is asking The Court to
(18) transfer the underlying family law case to a
(19) neutral circuit.

(20) And what I'm asking you is: Is there
(21) any authority that you're aware of where I
(22) under the assignment order have the
(23) authority to grant part four of your
(24) wherefore clause?

(25) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I think as the

[Page 21]

(1) judge and the trier of -- presiding over
(2) this case, I believe that your interest in
(3) having a fair trial require you to address
(4) the situation where The Defendant is serving
(5) as a judge in the pending litigation
(6) directly relating to the litigation before
(7) you.

(8) So my argument would be that as a
(9) circuit court judge, you have an interest in
(10) ensuring fairness in your courtroom. And I
(11) don't know how you could expect there to be
(12) fairness when one of The Defendants is
(13) serving as his own judge in a
(14) directly-related litigation. Or if there's
(15) a mechanism where it could be referred to
(16) the Supreme Court.

(17) My concern, Your Honor, is that I filed
(18) a Writ of Prohibition trying to ensure that
(19) the 13th Circuit, specifically Judge Felix,
(20) is not able to take any further action.
(21) I've had other issues in the appellate
(22) courts that have not gone quickly at all.
(23) And there's this hearing on April 17th
(24) where, Your Honor, the most important thing
(25) in my life is at the mercy of someone who

[Page 22]

(1) despises me who I've told the truth about,
(2) but told the truth when he wanted to keep
(3) that silent.

(4) And he's a participant and can work to
(5) suppress evidence that would be harmful to
(6) his own interests. And I just -- I really
(7) don't understand how a court system can
(8) allow that to happen, although I do
(9) understand your jurisdictional question,
(10) which is why I raised the responsibility of
(11) a direct referral to the Supreme Court.
(12) Something where I don't have this hanging
(13) over my head that, you know, my children are
(14) at risk.

(15) THE COURT: I just want to make sure
(16) that you have adequate time to put forward
(17) any argument for the different prongs that
(18) you're asking for. So I'm not trying to
(19) repeat the question for any purpose other
(20) than to make sure that I understand
(21) completely the basis for what somebody's
(22) asking me to do.

(23) So I understand that you might wish The
(24) Court or might wish another court to enter a
(25) particular order regarding transferring

[Page 23]

(1) litigation, but as far as addressing this
(2) motion and as far as addressing it today,
(3) are there specific authorities or bases for
(4) part four that need to be brought to The
(5) Court's attention that would give it the
(6) authority as the circuit judge in this case
(7) to transfer a family law case from another
(8) circuit to a different circuit?

(9) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I'm just
(10) looking for the exact citation. You know, I
(11) practice workers comp law, and there is a
(12) provision there. It looks like there's a
(13) corresponding one in upon the circuit court
(14) judges that explains that they have broad
(15) plenary powers within their jurisdiction to
(16) manage their courtrooms to ensure justice
(17) and manage their docket.

(18) And I would argue that the jurisdiction
(19) to manage the courtroom and ensure justice
(20) would encompass within those broad plenary
(21) powers, the ability to address something
(22) tangential but directly at issue to whether
(23) justice can be served in the proceedings
(24) before your court.

(25) THE COURT: Okay.

[Page 24]

(1) MR. HANSON: But that would be all the
(2) authority that I have at this time, Your
(3) Honor.

(4) THE COURT: All right. Thank you,
(5) Mr. Hanson. So let's turn then and I'll
(6) invite a response on part four before we
(7) turn to two and three.

(8) Either counsel present here wish to
(9) respond to, one, as Mr. Hanson has noted, it
(10) appears to be moot, based upon this court --
(11) this judge being assigned at this stage.

(12) And what are the Defendant's responses
(13) to part four of the Request to Relief in the
(14) motion set for hearing today?

(15) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Your Honor, Jessica
(16) Schwieterman and on behalf of the 13th
(17) Judicial Circuit and the judges. Your
(18) Honor, I don't believe that there is
(19) authority for this court to intervene in
(20) another circuit the court and transfer
(21) judges or provide any intervention.

(22) That would more or less be a lateral
(23) move, and I don't think it's appropriate. I
(24) don't think this court has the authority to
(25) do that, so I would say that it's

[Page 25]

(1) inappropriate. And I would request that
(2) this court deny his request that they have a
(3) lack of jurisdiction to do that.

(4) MS. WILKERSON: Keiana Wilkerson, on
(5) behalf of The Clerk of Courts for
(6) Hillsborough County. I would agree that
(7) Request Number 1 is moot, given the
(8) assignment happened to you. And as The
(9) Clerk voluntarily appeared in this matter,
(10) we're not entirely sure of all the ins and
(11) outs of the case. But, as I mentioned
(12) before, I'm not aware of any authority that
(13) would give The Court that ability to, I
(14) guess, what The Plaintiff's request in the
(15) underlying case. Otherwise, I have no
(16) position. I'm just not aware of any
(17) authority.

(18) THE COURT: Okay. All right. Anything
(19) in response to those, Mr. Hanson?

(20) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I would just
(21) add -- I forgot to place an objection on the
(22) record, but I do object to the Attorney
(23) General's office opposing my petition in
(24) this matter. I think it creates separation
(25) of powers concerns and whether the Attorney

[Page 26]

(1) General's office can comply with their
(2) duties to uphold The Constitution when there
(3) is so clearly deficiency in how the 13th
(4) Circuit Court handled this. But, other than
(5) getting that objection out, Your Honor, I
(6) don't have anything more to add on the
(7) transfer issue.

(8) THE COURT: All right. Let's move to
(9) part two and part three, which is, as I
(10) understand it, are the core issues and are
(11) somewhat interlocking here, Mr. Hanson, or
(12) at least that you're requesting in today's
(13) motion.

(14) So since The Court is taking over as
(15) the successors post-disqualification of the
(16) proceeding judge, Judge Frayman, we're in a
(17) little bit of a unique procedural posture
(18) regarding what's being asked for here today
(19) and what The Court's authority is to act in
(20) that space, with respect to prior rulings
(21) entered by a different judge.

(22) So what is -- what is the point at
(23) which you're seeking to have this the court
(24) reconsider? Which ruling is it -- if I can
(25) use the nomenclature of your motion here?

[Page 27]

(1) The reconsideration of incomplete order. So
(2) maybe I can put it more succinctly, I'll
(3) endeavor to do that so it will make it
(4) easier for everybody to have a response
(5) to.

(6) What are you asking this the court
(7) specifically to do in its order from today's
(8) hearing with respect to Judge Frayman's
(9) order that your motion is directed against?

(10) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I think The
(11) Court needs to vacate the unlawful parts of
(12) it. There's no basis in the law to change
(13) what is an expedited procedure under
(14) 2.4.0(L). "We're just going to start over."
(15) "I'm going to give you some advice on how
(16) you should defense this." "I'm going to
(17) strike some claims for ya, and then you get
(18) a do-over. You get another 20 days."
(19) There's no basis under the law to do that.

(20) All of the facts go in the complete
(21) opposite direction where the 13th Circuit
(22) Court doesn't deserve any additional time.
(23) There needs to be sanctions for the conduct
(24) that they've engaged in to try and conceal
(25) these records.

[Page 28]

(1) And so my argument is that the writ
(2) that Judge Frayman entered should have been
(3) a former writ compelling production within
(4) 20 days. The Defendants had their 20 days
(5) after service. They had the complaints for
(6) much longer than that. I never filed a law
(7) suit before this, so it took me some time to
(8) get the summons and get everything paid. So
(9) they've had plenty of time.

(10) I've been engaging with them by E-mail
(11) on these issues for months trying to get
(12) simple answers to whether Judge Ayers was
(13) even aware that Davis did not want to appear
(14) for a hearing where his misconduct was the
(15) central issue to be addressed.

(16) So, Your Honor, the presumption is in
(17) favor of public access. There is a strong
(18) presumption in favor of public access
(19) according to the Baron v. Freedom Newspapers
(20) case at 531 So 2d 113. Under the media
(21) general convergence, the chief judge of the
(22) 13th Circuit case at 840 So 2d 1008, it
(23) explains that the -- any exemptions to that
(24) public access presumption need to be limited
(25) and narrow tailored.

[Page 29]

(1) The 13th Circuit Court had an
(2) opportunity to claim exemptions at the time
(3) that I sent these public records. They had
(4) an opportunity -- a public records request,
(5) Your Honor. I apologize. I'm sorry.

(6) So that was their first opportunity to
(7) raise exemptions; they didn't do it. They
(8) said that they had records and go ahead and
(9) pay with a check, and pick up paper copies.
(10) When I scanned the double-sided copies back
(11) into them and told them, "Hey, you sent me a
(12) bunch of stuff I didn't ask for, but you
(13) didn't sent me what I did ask for. You
(14) know, I've had the opportunity to
(15) potentially still claim exemptions.

(16) They didn't do it. They remained
(17) silent. They had opportunity to raise
(18) exemptions when they filed their normal
(19) response. I believe that's January 8th, 20
(20) days out with their service for the summons.
(21) They didn't do it. So the hearing that we
(22) were at with Judge Frayman, the petition for
(23) writ was ripe.

(24) He noted that I had prima facie case
(25) for relief, but failed to require them to do

[Page 30]

(1) anything. The law requires him to actually
(2) have them produce the records within 20
(3) days or show cause as to why they shouldn't
(4) have to.

(5) He gave them a whole other do-over, and
(6) a full 20 days just to get started again.
(7) So the February 2nd response that they
(8) issued, there's no basis for them to have
(9) issued that because there's no basis to give
(10) them additional time. The Court should rule
(11) today on the initial writ -- the petition.
(12) Actually, it's the amended petition for writ
(13) and to the extent it incorporates the
(14) initial petition, based upon the response
(15) that was issued on January 8th.

(16) That's the proper mechanism for dealing
(17) with the Petition for Writ of Mandamus.
(18) Judge Frayman just abandoned it in every
(19) respect possible in the extreme direction of
(20) protecting the 13th Circuit, unlawfully.

(21) The case law that I've cited is clear
(22) that sua sponte assertion of affirmative
(23) defenses not raised by Defendants. The
(24) Defendants didn't even say that they needed
(25) more time, yet Judge Frayman gave them a

[Page 31]

(1) free 20 days not required by the law.

(2) He was instructive to them about how to
(3) proceed against this, although I think that
(4) he's wrong with what his plan was to move
(5) things towards exemptions. I don't think he
(6) was -- it's not correct under the law, but
(7) all of that is harmful error that's really
(8) difficult to, to remedy. But, certainly,
(9) striking the subsequent response that was
(10) just filed I believe February 2nd to which
(11) there is no basis for them to have the right
(12) to do that, that should be stricken, and
(13) this writ issue is ripe today.

(14) THE COURT: Well, that's not what's
(15) noticed for hearing today, Mr. Hanson. So I
(16) want to focus, again, on -- to the motion,
(17) because my concern is -- and I'm asking you
(18) this question and I'm also asking the
(19) counsel that are here in court to respond to
(20) this question after you, when I give them
(21) the opportunity to respond, is that if you
(22) ask me to vacate -- which I interpret what
(23) you're doing is you're asking me to vacate
(24) the alternative Writ of Mandamus issued by
(25) Judge Frayman on January 13th where he

[Page 32]

(1) directs it --

(2) MR. HANSON: No.

(3) THE COURT: Hang on. Hang on,
(4) Mr. Hanson. I heard you out so if you
(5) interrupt, it cuts us both out on the Zoom,
(6) and the court reporter cannot take us down
(7) both at the same time, okay. So please bear
(8) with me.

(9) MR. HAHN: Okay.

(10) THE COURT: If I vacate Judge Frayman's
(11) order or alternative writ dated January 13th
(12) of this year directing certain responses,
(13) but finding that he -- The Court is without
(14) jurisdiction, then don't I move back to a
(15) point in time where this court needs to
(16) conduct its responsibilities under the rules
(17) of making its own determination about
(18) whether or not there's a prima facie case?

(19) And then if I do find that have to
(20) afford The Defendants the opportunity to
(21) respond because Judge Frayman's order didn't
(22) order them to respond to all of the things
(23) in your pleadings? So don't I just end up
(24) all the way back at the status quo ante of
(25) January 12th before Judge Frayman ever

[Page 33]

(1) issued his ultimate Writ of Mandamus.

(2) MR. HANSON: No, Your Honor. You can
(3) vacate the order in parts. You can state
(4) that they had -- they were on notice, that
(5) they needed to respond. And I'm not sure I
(6) understand the basis of the idea that you
(7) wouldn't be able to simply vacate the parts
(8) of the order that are unlawful, but keep the
(9) other parts moving.

(10) You know, the prejudice -- I'm
(11) concerned that The Court is so concerned
(12) about prejudice to the 13th Circuit in light
(13) of the history here. And right here in the
(14) motion under Number 3, I'm placing at issue
(15) issuing the, quote -- Number 3, issue the
(16) alternative Writ of Mandamus, Docket Number
(17) 47, requiring the 13th Circuit to produce
(18) the records or show cause within 48 hours.

(19) So as part of the Motion for Immediate
(20) Relief is inextricably linked to the motion
(21) to vacate The Court's order or The Court's
(22) writ. And in that, there is a request for
(23) entry of the -- of a reasonable order in
(24) light of the fact that we were done with the
(25) proceedings before The Court issues the

[Page 34]

(1) writ.

(2) The proceedings, as I understand it, is
(3) there's a Petition for Writ, there is 20
(4) days to respond, and then The Court, if
(5) there's a prima facie case, they order
(6) production within 20 days or to show cause
(7) as to why records should not be produced.

(8) And it's not complicated what they've
(9) been ordered to produce. They haven't
(10) tagged anything as confidential. They
(11) reference judicial immunity, which has no
(12) application in mandamus cases. And they've
(13) already confirmed that they've located and
(14) have responsive records, so there's no
(15) issue. There is no mystery.

(16) Everyone -- the facts are clearly
(17) documented. Giving them additional time
(18) only harms my family, costs us money, and
(19) we'll be back her in the same situation.
(20) And it's -- it is an enormous injustice to
(21) consider the 13th Circuit's potential desire
(22) for additional time over my family's
(23) constitutional rights.

(24) So I -- I continue to argue for entry
(25) of the formal writ today based upon the

[Page 35]

(1) pleadings that were filed and noticed for
(2) the hearing today.

(3) THE COURT: So is it your argument that
(4) The Court's prima facie review is supposed
(5) to -- I guess I'm not clear on where you
(6) place that responsibility in the light of
(7) authorities like Ake vs. Moore and other
(8) cases. Isn't the prima facie review that
(9) The Court is supposed to engage in supposed
(10) to precede the issuance of the alternative
(11) writ and mandamus?

(12) MR. HANSON: I'm sorry. Repeat the
(13) question one more time.

(14) THE COURT: Where in the sequence of
(15) events do you argue that the prima facie
(16) review of The Court is supposed to take
(17) place, I would cite you to some other
(18) authorities, but I think from the Second
(19) District Court of Appeal. I'm not sure if
(20) I'm pronouncing it correctly, Ake vs. Moore
(21) seems to anticipate that The Court is
(22) supposed to engage in the prima facie
(23) review, and then The Court upon fulfilling
(24) that responsibility and completing that task
(25) is supposed to issue the alternative writ.

[Page 36]

(1) And then, then respondents have the
(2) opportunity to respond to that. That seems
(3) to be the framework laid out by that
(4) authority, which is relatively recent.

(5) Do you argue that the prima facie
(6) review is supposed to occur at some other
(7) point?

(8) MR. HANSON: Yes. I argue that the
(9) hearing on January 13th was the time for
(10) analysis regarding the prima facie case.
(11) And once Judge Frayman found that that
(12) exists, that triggers -- they have the right
(13) to show cause as to why the records should
(14) not be produced, but it's not something
(15) where it's just another response and come
(16) back for another hearing.

(17) There is pressure on them to actually
(18) produce documents. There's been many delays
(19) beyond what's reasonable throughout the past
(20) several months. And I believe that delaying
(21) issuing the writ actually requiring the
(22) production of documents within 20 days is
(23) required at that first hearing. They had
(24) the 20 days to issue the response.

(25) We attend a hearing, and if I --

[Page 37]

(1) remember, Judge, there is a presumption in
(2) favor of public access. There is no burden
(3) on me other than to identify records that
(4) are public in nature. And there's
(5) custodians at the court that had a duty to
(6) do that, have actually done that. They've
(7) identified the administrative records and
(8) produced them for me, so there is no dispute
(9) on the prima facie case questions.

(10) And they had an obligation to identify
(11) what they believed to be confidential or
(12) exempt in the initial response to public
(13) records, and they didn't do that. And my
(14) follow-up in trying to get clarification on
(15) why these records didn't exist. They had an
(16) obligation to state that the records were
(17) confidential or exempt. They haven't done
(18) that.

(19) Failing to do it within the formal
(20) response to my writ, with -- beyond any
(21) argument, waives any defenses or exceptions
(22) that they may argue because they just missed
(23) the opportunity. Even looking at the
(24) response that the Attorney General's office
(25) filed on behalf of the 13th Circuit, I don't

[Page 38]

(1) see where they identify any exemptions.

(2) They don't identify documents that they
(3) are concealing. They just -- they try to
(4) phrase things in terms of even though there
(5) are administrative records regarding
(6) scheduling, we want to treat them like they
(7) are -- like they have mental impressions in
(8) them.

(9) And you can't rebrand misconduct as
(10) mental impressions, and then just say,
(11) "Well, that's enough. I've established an
(12) exemption." They haven't produced anything
(13) to support that the video that the judge on
(14) the case actively offered to get -- there is
(15) video of the judge rolling her eyes at me
(16) and offering to get the video as sort of a
(17) threat to me, not to challenge her, but I
(18) had just seen it.

(19) And that's the experience that I've had
(20) for months with her, was her rejecting every
(21) good faith argument under the fact and law
(22) that should have put this issue to bed long
(23) ago. And the active rolling her eyes at me
(24) did exist on the video.

(25) She offered to confirm -- offered to

[Page 39]

(1) get the video and produced it, and has
(2) refused to ever since. That sends a
(3) terrible message regarding the justice
(4) system in that if there's evidence that a
(5) judge is biased and dishonest, the court
(6) system is going to hide the records. That
(7) just does not seem like something that
(8) should be happening in a the court of law.

(9) And the lack -- you look at the
(10) presumption in favor of public access. That
(11) just exists. You look at the fact that the
(12) circuit identified responsive records. They
(13) never said that they couldn't figure out
(14) what I was saying, that it was too broad.
(15) They identified records. They labeled them
(16) as administrative. The court administrator
(17) produced documents. They hid documents.
(18) They concealed documents.

(19) And now they're trying to get you to
(20) give them more time. And all that does is
(21) potentially buy them time to come up with a
(22) story to replace the facts of the last
(23) several months to try and destroy me and
(24) sweep all this under the rug. But there's
(25) no basis in the fact or the law for that,

[Page 40]

(1) Your Honor.

(2) There are no exemptions that have been
(3) asserted and proven with respect to any
(4) records. There needs to be a comprehensive
(5) order that grants the relief requested in my
(6) Petitions for Writ of Mandamus. And that
(7) should happen today.

(8) THE COURT: Anything else that you want
(9) to argue with respect to part two and part
(10) three before I allow sometime for response?

(11) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, there's quite
(12) a bit. You know, I don't want to monopolize
(13) The Court's time. You know, if it's okay
(14) with Your Honor, I can give up the floor and
(15) allow the state attorney to respond to what
(16) I've said, and then I can continue at that
(17) point. And, Your Honor, a lot of it depends
(18) on what your concerns or questions are.

(19) If you're not inclined to push this
(20) forward -- if I understand why, I can save
(21) The Court some time by not reviewing a bunch
(22) of facts and arguments that aren't germane.

(23) Does that make sense what I'm
(24) proposing?

(25) THE COURT: I'll allow you to reserve

[Page 41]

(1) time for rebuttal, and I'll permit responses
(2) from counsel who are present here on behalf
(3) of The Court and The Clerk, whichever. Who
(4) would like to proceed first?

(5) MS. WILKERSON: Hi, yes. Keiana
(6) Wilkerson on behalf of The Clerk. Just a
(7) couple of points in response to what
(8) Plaintiff said. Concerning the instances he
(9) mentioned that defendants were served, the
(10) defendants had time or, as I've seen on the
(11) docket, that allegedly service was made on
(12) the 23rd of December. I missed wanting to
(13) object to any characterization that that
(14) might have included The Clerk as being
(15) served.

(16) The Clerk wasn't served and just
(17) recently became aware of kind of the relief
(18) that Plaintiff was seeking. So I just
(19) wanted to clarify that for The Court moving
(20) forward just in response to any alternative
(21) writ or the writ that Plaintiff requested.

(22) This court just granted a joint motion
(23) by -- or an agreed motion by both Plaintiff
(24) and The Clerk to extend the time for The
(25) Clerk to respond to the petition to March

[Page 42]

(1) 4th. And, I believe, this court did that --
(2) if you would give me a second, Your Honor.
(3) I believe it was -- I believe it was maybe a
(4) day or two ago, but we did submit a motion
(5) asking for time to respond to that.

(6) But to the extent that The Clerk is
(7) kind of aware of the general relief that
(8) Plaintiff is seeking, these appear to be
(9) records of The Court and not The Clerk, so
(10) we are not sure that we would have any of
(11) these records to begin with.

(12) So we would prepare a more substantial
(13) response and a look into what Plaintiff is
(14) alleging in our response due on the 4th, by
(15) the 4th, but I wanted to put that before
(16) Your Honor and kind of make that clear that
(17) The Clerk wasn't served and voluntarily
(18) appeared. Just out of an abundance of
(19) caution and just wanted to make that known
(20) on the record.

(21) That's all I have to say, Your Honor.
(22) There is no questions, and I would turn it
(23) over to the Attorney General.

(24) THE COURT: Counsel.

(25) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes, Your Honor.

[Page 43]

(1) Jessica Schwieterman. Your Honor,
(2) procedurally, we believe Mr. Hanson is
(3) flawed in his assessment. Mr. Hanson filed
(4) a Writ of Mandamus to which the appropriate
(5) procedural next step would be for The Court
(6) to review the mandamus petition to determine
(7) whether or not the petition is facially
(8) sufficient.

(9) And that is in multiple cases including
(10) Smith v. State, which is at 335 So 3d 795
(11) and that was a 2022 case at which point The
(12) Court has to determine if the petition is
(13) facially sufficient. If it is, then The
(14) Court issues an alternative Writ to
(15) Mandamus which the Defendants need to
(16) respond, and they are allotted 20 days.

(17) Mr. Hanson's belief that 20 days from
(18) service is what needs to be responded to.
(19) That is incorrect. The response is due 20
(20) days from the order being entered.

(21) In this case there was concern that
(22) there was going to be additional documents
(23) filed, and that's why the Defendant
(24) responded predating the order; however,
(25) procedurally that is incorrect.

[Page 44]

(1) The petition -- if the petition has
(2) addressed issues and has a prima facie case,
(3) then the order needs to be entered by The
(4) Court. If not, The Court has the
(5) determination to dismiss the petition. And,
(6) accordingly, I believe that The Court has
(7) done that.

(8) Judge Frayman previously entered that
(9) order; however, if this court feels that
(10) that order needs to be vacated, the
(11) appropriate action would be to issue a new
(12) writ, but this court would still have to do
(13) the initial assessment, review to determine
(14) if a prima facie case exist, and allot the
(15) Defendants an additional 20 days to respond,
(16) as required by the Florida Supreme Court,
(17) Second DCA, and procedurally appropriate.

(18) When a trial court receives a petition
(19) of Writ of Mandamus, it's initially tasked
(20) in assessing the petition, determine if it's
(21) facially sufficient. If it's not facially
(22) sufficient, The Court may dismiss the
(23) petition.

(24) So a response from the
(25) respondents/defendants is not required until

[Page 45]

(1) that order is entered. And, Your Honor,
(2) that's from Davis v. State, that is a So 2d
(3) case -- or Florida Second DCA case from
(4) 2003. I'm sorry. And that's exactly the
(5) procedural point that we're at now.

(6) So if Mr. Hanson is requesting that the
(7) order that was issued on January 13th or --
(8) yeah, I believe, 13th be vacated, then we
(9) are now at a position where we are
(10) ultimately starting over, based on
(11) Mr. Hanson's own request.

(12) So if this court is required to issue a
(13) new writ, then Your Honor would have to do
(14) the exact same thing that Mr. Hanson is
(15) objecting to and in Judge Frayman's order.
(16) And we would have -- we would be required to
(17) have time to respond based on the issues
(18) that The Court ultimately the original order
(19) of Writ of Mandamus is Order to Show cause.
(20) And we would need to respond to that Order
(21) to Show Cause appropriately. And at which
(22) point Your Honor would then schedule a
(23) hearing for us to address the issues, if the
(24) petition and the answer to the alternative
(25) writ raised disputed factual issues, Your

[Page 46]

(1) Honor would then be required to resolve
(2) these issues upon evidence submitted by the
(3) parties, which could result in a hearing or
(4) Your Honor could, you know, review the
(5) documentation, but that's -- I mean, that
(6) goes all the way back to Florida Supreme
(7) Court case law from the 1930s.

(8) That's State -- or Johnson vs. Roberts
(9) and that's 134 Florida 326, and then also
(10) 184 So 14, page 14 from 1938. And, again,
(11) we have Excess vs. State and, again, that's
(12) from 1935, which states the same thing:
(13) That if there is conflicting information,
(14) then Your Honor needs to assess the
(15) evidence. So this isn't -- it's not
(16) appropriate to just issue a ruling stating,
(17) "Oh, this is what he's requesting. He has a
(18) prima facie case. This is how he needs to
(19) proceed."

(20) There are Florida Supreme Court case
(21) law stating that's not the procedure. So we
(22) just Ask that the procedure be followed. If
(23) Your Honor is inclined to vacate the order,
(24) as Plaintiff requests, then the Respondents
(25) would just request that the case law and

[Page 47]

(1) procedure be followed and that the new
(2) alternative Writ of Mandamus be issued after
(3) reviewing Mr. Hanson's Amended Petition, at
(4) which time the Respondents would respond to
(5) the alternative and Writ of Mandamus as an
(6) Order to Show cause, as required by
(7) procedure. Thank you.

(8) THE COURT: Well, moving back to judge
(9) 48 man's order of January 13th. The issue
(10) that Mr. Hanson highlights and I think is
(11) part of the focus of his motion as the
(12) Plaintiff kind of goes to that point about
(13) what is -- what is the proper procedure and
(14) what are the proper responsibilities here
(15) and what is the review level that is
(16) appropriate for The Court upon receipt of
(17) the Petition for Writ of Mandamus.

(18) Because I think, if I'm understanding
(19) Mr. Hanson's argument correctly here today,
(20) and his argument in his -- in his filing is
(21) that Judge Frayman raised defenses and
(22) dismissed certain claims of his and did that
(23) without outside of the scope of review that
(24) he should have been engaged in under the
(25) rules and under the authorities.

[Page 48]

(1) So I'm not asking you to agree or
(2) disagree with Judge Frayman, but I'm asking
(3) you to point out to this the court -- this
(4) court or any other court that is engaging in
(5) the prima facie review or I see described in
(6) other authorities that is the facial
(7) review for facial sufficiency for a Petition
(8) of Writ of Mandamus.

(9) What exactly is The Court looking
(10) for -- should The Court have delved into
(11) issues such as Chapter 86 applicability or
(12) jurisdictional issues as Judge Frayman's
(13) order does or should it simply be restricted
(14) to the face of the document?

(15) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: And, Your Honor, I
(16) don't think there is specific case law that
(17) gives that kind of guidance. Like, Your
(18) Honor, I have only seen The Court's initial
(19) task involves attesting whether the petition
(20) is facially sufficient. And, I mean,
(21) unfortunately, all of the case law I have
(22) found is limited to that language, but I
(23) have seen in the initial review as to
(24) whether or not it states a claim for the
(25) relief requested, and I believe that is what

[Page 49]

(1) Judge Frayman did.

(2) But, again, I'm not going to assume
(3) Judge Frayman's decision-making; however, in
(4) this scenario, it's -- I believe that's what
(5) was done that the Judge Frayman reviewed it,
(6) determined what was facially sufficient, and
(7) then made the determination, as the case law
(8) does allow for dismissal.

(9) I don't know why dismissal is certain
(10) facially insufficient claim wouldn't be
(11) inappropriate.

(12) THE COURT: Facial sufficiency seems to
(13) be a relatively level of review by The Court
(14) receiving the petition, isn't it?

(15) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: I would say so.
(16) Yes, Your Honor.

(17) THE COURT: Anything else you wish to
(18) offer in response before I permit Mr. Hanson
(19) to have some rebuttal time?

(20) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: No, Your Honor.

(21) THE COURT: From The Clerk?

(22) MS. WILKERSON: No, Your Honor.

(23) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson?

(24) MR. HANSON: Thank you, Your Honor. I
(25) was just looking at a case that was cited by

[Page 50]

(1) Attorney General, Radford vs. Broughton.
(2) And it says that when a the court gets a
(3) Petition for Writ of Madamus, the initial
(4) action is to review it for whether it
(5) establishes a prima facie case for relief
(6) through mandamus. And everything that I've
(7) seen suggests that they have the 20 days to
(8) respond under the Rules of Civil Procedure
(9) to respond to the writ. And after that, The
(10) Court finds that there's a prima facie case
(11) or dismisses it.

(12) But if they find there's a prima facie
(13) case, there's actually a writ that actually
(14) orders them to produce the documents or show
(15) cause.

(16) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, let me just
(17) make sure I'm following you. So it seems in
(18) the authorities that are being argued here
(19) that the ordering of steps argued by the
(20) Attorney General is petition received, then
(21) next petition reviewed by court for prima
(22) facie sufficiency, then next if prima facie
(23) sufficiency found by the court, court
(24) directs response to the -- we'll call them
(25) defendant here -- to the Defendants to

[Page 51]

(1) respond in issuance of an alternative Writ
(2) of Mandamus.

(3) Those are the steps that are argued and
(4) you seem to be -- I just want to make sure I
(5) understand you -- arguing that petition
(6) received by The Court, response due within
(7) 20 days, then The Court makes a prima facie
(8) finding after the response. So somebody is
(9) getting step two and step three right and
(10) somebody is getting it reversed.

(11) And that's where I would turn you back
(12) to this Moore vs. Ake, that's A-K-E, case in
(13) 1997 in the Second District in what must be
(14) noted is very brief single paragraph
(15) decision. It says, in the pertinent part
(16) here, "We reverse because the trial court
(17) had an obligation under Florida Rule of
(18) Procedure Rule 1.630 to review Mr. Morris'
(19) complaint when it was filed, comma, decide
(20) whether it established a prima facie case,
(21) comma, and issue an alternative Writ of
(22) Mandamus, if the petition was facially
(23) adequate, period." And then it cites
(24) authority for that decision from other
(25) district courts of appeal.

[Page 52]

(1) The next sentence: "The petitioner was
(2) not required to serve the respondent with
(3) the complaint and could not serve the
(4) alternative writ until the trial the court
(5) had performed the tasks required of it under
(6) The Rule." So doesn't Moore vs. Ake says
(7) that the steps are petition received by The
(8) Court, petition reviewed for prima facie
(9) sufficiency by The Court, and then third
(10) step if prima facie sufficiency is found by
(11) The Court, alternative Writ of Mandamus
(12) issues directing response within 20 days.
(13) Isn't that --

(14) MR. HANSON: The records.

(15) THE COURT: What's that?

(16) MR. HANSON: I'm sorry, Your Honor. I
(17) didn't mean to talk over you.

(18) THE COURT: Go ahead, Mr. Hanson.

(19) MR. HANSON: When you say respond
(20) within 20 days, that means to produce the
(21) records or show cause why they should not be
(22) produced or just issue a response to the
(23) pleadings.

(24) THE COURT: Well, it appears that it
(25) says to the next step here is, "to review

[Page 53]

(1) complaint when it's filed, comma, decide
(2) whether it is established a prima facie case
(3) and issue an alternative Writ of Mandamus if
(4) the petition was facially adequate.

(5) MR. HANSON: Right.

(6) THE COURT: That's the step work. It's
(7) not -- and they can respond how they wish to
(8) respond, I guess, depending on what The
(9) Court's writ is, but the Court is step two
(10) in that process is the prima facie review,
(11) then they are put on the clock to respond or
(12) produce.

(13) MR. HANSON: I think that it's just a
(14) different case. I mean, one big difference
(15) is I filed a Motion for Immediate Writ. So
(16) I believe that, at a minimum, it's a fact
(17) that should push The Court towards urgency
(18) here. You know, no one is disputing my
(19) statements of fact regarding what's gone on
(20) in the 13th Circuit and how inappropriate it
(21) is.

(22) So I would hope that The Court would
(23) reconsider those facts, number one. And
(24) then the Motion for Immediate Writ -- and,
(25) Your Honor, I'm trying to learn many

[Page 54]

(1) different areas of the law right now, so
(2) forgive me that I don't know this off the
(3) top of my head, but I believe that the
(4) Motion for Writ does require that The Court
(5) actually require them to produce documents.

(6) So I think maybe some of the confusion
(7) here is a 20-day response. You can have a
(8) 20-day response to the Petition for Writ
(9) just like the one that's due under civil
(10) procedure. Judge Frayman actually
(11) referenced the civil procedure order, so
(12) it's the same thing that The Defendants had
(13) already filed. He was just giving them
(14) another clock to do that again, which I
(15) definitely don't think that there's any
(16) basis in the law for doing that, regardless
(17) of the egregious facts that are in my case.

(18) My position is, especially in light of
(19) the Motion for Immediate Writ and lack of
(20) any response to that, The Court on January
(21) 13th had an obligation, once it found a
(22) prima facie case to issue a writ with some
(23) teeth where they needed to either produce
(24) the records or show cause as to why not.

(25) And further, Judge, they had the chance

[Page 55]

(1) to file the response at 20 days that was
(2) filed back on January 8th. Any other
(3) response should be stricken because there
(4) wasn't a basis to give them an additional 20
(5) days. Now, I suppose they can take the
(6) response that they did and rework that and
(7) make it into a show cause. You know --
(8) forgive me name of the motion doesn't come
(9) to me at the moment, but they could turn it
(10) into that type of a document if they thought
(11) that there were exemptions or
(12) confidentiality in some of the records that
(13) were responsive.

(14) I argue that it's too late. That
(15) they've waived those rights, but there
(16) should be something compounding actual
(17) production of materials sooner rather than
(18) later. This has gone on too far, and the
(19) 13th Circuit it has not acted in good faith,
(20) Your Honor. And I would hope that that
(21) would play a role in your decisions here.
(22) These are public records that we're talking
(23) about. The Court is hiding them because
(24) it's embarrassing for them and it shows
(25) misconduct. That is immensely damaging to

[Page 56]

(1) competence in the judiciary system.

(2) The litigants who understand that and
(3) note that that's happening going to court
(4) knowing that if the judge needs something
(5) out of it, they're going to get something
(6) out of it, no matter what the law or the
(7) facts are for me.

(8) And it's a real distressing position to
(9) be in, and I believe it's directly relevant
(10) to the issues before this case where you
(11) have a judge who's defying clearly federal
(12) and state authority on structural conflicts
(13) where he's trying to continue to serve as
(14) the -- his own judge. He's trying to
(15) continue to control a case that has an
(16) impact on his culpability and potential
(17) consequences related to the matter. So
(18) action sooner rather than later is
(19) imperative.

(20) There's kids at issue here that are
(21) really getting a very unfair couple years of
(22) their childhood because of what's gone on
(23) with this court. Not your court, Your
(24) Honor, but because of what started within
(25) the 13th Circuit courts. And there's no

[Page 57]

(1) excuse for it, there's no dispute regarding
(2) whether it occurred. And it gets very, very
(3) concerning how long it's continuing to --
(4) everyone buries their head in the sand to
(5) the reality of what's happened.

(6) I think that now is a very appropriate
(7) time to give them a short time frame. They
(8) know what the records are. They haven't
(9) even told me if anyone has watched this
(10) video. You know, I imagine that somebody
(11) within the circuit has watched it and if it
(12) weren't damaging to the judge, they would
(13) have figured out a way -- and they've only
(14) implied that it's security video. Their
(15) correspondence doesn't even say outright
(16) that it's a security video.

(17) They certainly haven't produced
(18) anything that I've requested in terms of
(19) documentation supporting that it's actually
(20) on a security system and not courtroom
(21) proceeding recordings. So I -- I urge The
(22) Court, I plead with The Court to force them
(23) to produce records or show cause.

(24) I agree that they do have that show
(25) cause option still, but anything other than

[Page 58]

(1) forcing them to produce records in a short
(2) time is a continuation of violating due
(3) process and transparency rights because
(4) there really is no excuse for what Judge
(5) Frayman did on January 13th.

(6) THE COURT: Anything else to be argued
(7) at this point by any counsel?

(8) MR. HANSON: If you can just give me
(9) one moment please, Your Honor.

(10) THE COURT: Certainly.

(11) MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Your Honor, we would
(12) just reiterate that the position of The
(13) Respondents is that Mr. Hanson does not
(14) understand the procedural requirements and
(15) that the alternative writ that would be
(16) issued would be requiring The Respondent to
(17) show cause as to why the writ should not be
(18) issued. And what Mr. Hanson is requesting
(19) is the issuance of more or less specific
(20) performance in this case, which is not
(21) procedurally appropriate.

(22) MS. WILKERSON: Your Honor, just on
(23) behalf of The Clerk, just reiterating that
(24) we weren't served and voluntarily appeared
(25) still becoming a Plaintiff in this.

[Page 59]

(1) However, in briefly reviewing Florida Rules
(2) Civil Procedure 1.630 and the case law that
(3) you've cited regarding Moore v. Ake, it
(4) appears to me also that the normal course
(5) would be for the writ to be issued, and then
(6) for the time to respond to start then after
(7) The Court were to determine if there were a
(8) prima facie case.

(9) THE COURT: All right. Thank you. You
(10) want more time, Mr. Hanson? It's fine if
(11) you do.

(12) MR. HANSON: Okay. Yeah, I do have
(13) something I want to respond to that, then
(14) I'll just finish reviewing my notes a second
(15) here, but with respect to the writ process,
(16) there is an obligation to respond to a
(17) Petition for Writ of Mandamus once it's
(18) formally served on Defendants. That's the
(19) 20-day requirement under the Rules of Civil
(20) Procedure.

(21) There is nothing under the law that I'm
(22) aware of that allows a judge to order a redo
(23) of that. There's a prima facie case in
(24) Judge Frayman's finding and he already
(25) issued a writ. The writ just doesn't have

[Page 60]

(1) any teeth. He issued a writ that just gives
(2) them a complete redo under the Rules of
(3) Civil Procedure. That's not the correct
(4) process.

(5) The first response in the first 20 days
(6) would be meaningless then, especially in
(7) light of the fact that time is of the
(8) essence, there's a Motion for Immediate Writ
(9) filed with no response, and there's been
(10) nothing where they said they need more time.

(11) To give them additional time when
(12) they're not even asking for it after
(13) actively assisting with their defense and
(14) making rulings in their favor without
(15) allowing me to talk, that's the situation
(16) we're dealing with.

(17) When I look at what's happening here,
(18) Your Honor, it's really, really distressing
(19) and discouraging because it couldn't be more
(20) obvious what's appropriate here. Judge
(21) Frayman acted extremely inappropriately and
(22) shows the entitlement attitude that judges
(23) don't think that they need -- and, Your
(24) Honor, I'm not talking about you, but
(25) certain judges don't feel they have subject

[Page 61]

(1) to accountability.

(2) They don't believe that they have to
(3) follow the law. They think that they can
(4) choose sides and act based upon
(5) relationships. That is no okay. And, Your
(6) Honor, I would request that whatever order
(7) The Court enters that The Court provide some
(8) basis in the law for the time period given
(9) and if there's not some actual affirmative
(10) requirement to either produce or show cause
(11) to provide some basis in the law for that
(12) because all of my reviews suggested that
(13) once there's a prima face case there's a
(14) writ to produce it because there is such a
(15) strong presumption in favor of public
(16) access.

(17) The judiciary in Florida is
(18) self-regulated. The mechanism and the
(19) constitutional provision that protects
(20) citizens from corruption. That's always a
(21) possibility within a self-regulating system
(22) is transparency. And the manner in which
(23) the 13th Circuit and The Florida Bar have
(24) fought transparency when there's extensive
(25) underlying evidence of the misconduct that

[Page 62]

(1) the request for public records seeks to
(2) expose, it looks really, really bad.

(3) And perhaps this is the way that the
(4) courts are going, but I strongly object to
(5) it and encourage The Court to look at the
(6) facts and consider the welfare of the
(7) children, consider what factors support
(8) giving them more time without forcing them
(9) to actually do something.

(10) And I would be -- it would very
(11) difficult to understand giving them
(12) additional time when they haven't asked for
(13) it, and I'm not aware of anything under the
(14) law. And they've been trying to put this
(15) off and avoid it for months including
(16) deceitful and dishonest tactics like bait
(17) and switch and document dumping. So those
(18) are the facts, Your Honor.

(19) I plead with The Court to look at the
(20) strong presumption in favor of public
(21) access. Their burden and their response to
(22) demonstrate confidentiality or some
(23) exemption. They just play fast and loose on
(24) whether there's any additional records that
(25) exist. They say that judicial immunity

[Page 63]

(1) covers them, which it's completely
(2) inapplicable to the mandamus case.

(3) So, you know, we are months into this,
(4) you know, hundreds of hours of work and
(5) thousands of dollars of expenses, and I just
(6) plead with The Court to proceed with the
(7) urgency that the facts require and to look
(8) over the record and the filings just to see
(9) how -- Plaintiffs one objective has remained
(10) consistent for nearly two years. We waived
(11) any attorney-client privilege with both
(12) attorneys that I had. They were free to
(13) produce anything that I communicated with
(14) them, anything in my files because I've been
(15) so consistent on just needing peace of mind
(16) on this one issue.

(17) And I don't know what I could do
(18) differently, and it's scary that the justice
(19) system just locks you out if you're on the
(20) wrong side of what insiders want. And I'm
(21) just hoping someone within the justice
(22) system will do the right thing.

(23) THE COURT: If y'all bear with me for a
(24) moment, I will take a moment to read over a
(25) couple of things and notes that I've made

[Page 64]

(1) during the hearing, given that the matter is
(2) encouraged to be reviewed and ruled upon as
(3) expeditiously as possible.

(4) I want to endeavor to give you a ruling
(5) to the extent possible today. And, of
(6) course, that's always tempered by The
(7) Courts's primary obligation, which is to get
(8) it right. So I want to make sure I read
(9) over a couple more things from the filings
(10) here as well as the pertinent rules and so
(11) if y'all don't mind standing my here.

(12) (Brief pause.)

(13) THE COURT: All right. Oh, I see you
(14) have your hand raised, Mr. Hanson. Go
(15) ahead.

(16) MR. HANSON: Yes, your Honor. I think
(17) what some of the confusion was about the
(18) substance of the writ. The question is
(19) whether The Defendant should get the benefit
(20) of the show cause option. These things are
(21) supposed to move quickly. The responses are
(22) supposed to happen quickly, and then the
(23) petition showing the prima facie case.

(24) And because the circuit court for The
(25) Defendants should have addressed these

[Page 65]

(1) issues and should have asserted
(2) confidentiality defenses back at the time
(3) that the records were requested, they have
(4) those 20 days to put up their defense of why
(5) the records should not be granted as public
(6) access. And Defense in this case had not.
(7) I don't even think that they've alleged an
(8) exemption for any of these records.

(9) So The Court should issue the writ
(10) compelling them to produce the requested
(11) documents in my petitions without
(12) qualification. The gift that sometimes
(13) courts will give is the show cause, the
(14) alternate parts, is the show cause part.

(15) So not having the teeth is a whole
(16) other leap outside of what the law provides
(17) for, which is either writ-compelling
(18) production or a writ-compelling production
(19) or, in the alternative, show cause.

(20) THE COURT: All right. So, I'm
(21) sorry --

(22) MR. HANSON: Then -- sorry.

(23) THE COURT: -- I didn't know if you put
(24) your hand up again or if you were finished.
(25) I'm sorry. I looked -- I was looking down

[Page 66]

(1) at the paper.

(2) Are you -- is there other, other
(3) argument you wish to make, Mr. Hanson?

(4) MR. HANSON: Just real briefly, Your
(5) Honor. So I have requested some additional
(6) records in the months that followed. And
(7) suddenly there's these exorbitant fees for
(8) the records I've requested now. Just to pay
(9) for the technology and review, I believe, is
(10) \$5,000 that the court is asking for, which
(11) just shows this continuing pattern of
(12) none-compliance with the transparency
(13) requirements directly related to a situation
(14) where there's serious allegations of insider
(15) protectionism and attorney judicial
(16) misconduct. So I think that's further
(17) confirmation that the writ-compelling
(18) production or the documents requested is
(19) appropriate.

(20) I think they've waived the opportunity
(21) to show cause.

(22) THE COURT: Are there authorities that
(23) you're citing to The Court that allow it to
(24) step outside the Rule of Civil Procedure
(25) that governs mandamus 1.630 because that's

[Page 67]

(1) what it sounds like you're asking the Court
(2) to do?

(3) MR. HANSON: Well, Your Honor, I think
(4) that the responsive pleading under 1.360
(5) happened January 8th. I don't think that
(6) they're entitled to a second round of 20
(7) days under the Rules of Civil Procedure.
(8) They already had that. So when they got
(9) served, 20 days clock starts. They filed
(10) their response writ at 20 days.

(11) THE COURT: But, Mr. Hanson, The Court
(12) had never engaged in its task, which is to
(13) review for prima facie sufficiency before
(14) ordering an alternative writ to be issued
(15) upon The Respondents.

(16) MR. HANSON: But you don't need to --
(17) you don't need to issue an alternative writ.
(18) You can issue a writ to that just directs
(19) them to produce documents based upon the
(20) pleadings.

(21) THE COURT: But, Mr. Hanson, and I'm
(22) sorry, I just feel that's a very narrow
(23) point, so I feel we can address it directly.

(24) The Court has a responsibility under
(25) the rules of procedure to conduct that

[Page 68]

(1) review as laid out by 1.630 part D, doesn't
(2) it?

(3) MR. HANSON: And Judge Frayman, who
(4) couldn't have been more biased against me,
(5) already said that I had met that burden.

(6) THE COURT: Oh, so you want to keep
(7) what you liked, but if he disagreed with
(8) you, you want The Court to disregard it? Is
(9) that --

(10) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I think that
(11) stating it as he disagreed with me is a
(12) massive understatement. He did things with
(13) no basis in the law to assist the 13th
(14) Circuit. He acted as defense counsel. He
(15) didn't say some things that were against me.
(16) He did things that were unlawful.

(17) And, yes, I think that we should throw
(18) those out, and the fact that I pled a prima
(19) facie case that's so obvious that even
(20) someone who had culpable animosity towards
(21) me still knew that he had to say there's a
(22) prima facie case.

(23) So I don't think it's unreasonable to
(24) ask this court to throw out Judge Frayman's
(25) unlawful orders designed to help protect

[Page 69]

(1) insiders, but to keep the part of the order
(2) that says that addresses the facts and would
(3) move the case forward, absent his work to
(4) further delay and disrupt, which his manner
(5) of disqualification further declared things.

(6) THE COURT: Well, you moved for his
(7) disqualification, didn't you, Mr. Hanson?

(8) MR. HANSON: Conditionally, Your Honor.
(9) I think the outrage that he doesn't have to
(10) explain himself --

(11) THE COURT: Is there -- I'm not -- it's
(12) not the motion for today, and it's not
(13) anything else. I'm not aware of that
(14) particular vehicle and haven't done any
(15) research on it, so I don't want us to get
(16) distracted from dealing with what is
(17) actually set for hearing today.

(18) So I'm prepared to rule here today from
(19) the bench. An order from The Court will be
(20) forthcoming expeditiously. And with respect
(21) to The Plaintiff's Motion for Immediate
(22) Relief and Reconsideration of Incomplete
(23) Order and Immediate Assignment of a Neutral
(24) Successor, The Court finds -- and I don't
(25) believe there's an objection -- that within

[Page 70]

(1) the requested relief part one, requesting
(2) that the matter be immediately assigned to a
(3) neutral judge outside the 13th Judicial
(4) Circuit is moot.

(5) With respect to part two, vacating the
(6) dismissal of the writ and part three
(7) issuing the alternative writ of mandamus,
(8) The Court will grant the motion in part and
(9) vacate the January 13th alternative writ of
(10) mandamus issued by Judge Frayman in its
(11) entirety.

(12) The Court will not grant the request to
(13) issue a new alternative writ of mandamus
(14) immediately until this court, this judge,
(15) has had the opportunity to fulfill their
(16) responsibility under Rule 1.630(d) to see if
(17) the complaint shows a prima facie case for
(18) relief.

(19) If The Court, upon conducting that
(20) review, which I anticipate will take less
(21) than one week, finds that the complaint
(22) shows a prima facie case for relief, then
(23) The Court will issue an alternative writ in
(24) mandamus as described by 1.630(d)(2), and
(25) all other parts explicitly in 1.630 and

[Page 71]

(1) incorporated by reference in 1.630,
(2) including 1.140 would come into play, but
(3) first something as fundamental as order of
(4) operation, The Court must fulfill its
(5) responsibility and complete its task to
(6) determine whether or not there has been a
(7) prima facie case for relief shown as
(8) described by numerous authorities.

(9) With respect to part four of the
(10) requested relief, this court has been
(11) requested to transfer the underlying family
(12) law case to a neutral circuit. The Court
(13) denies that request since there appears to
(14) be no authority beyond the broad plenary
(15) powers of this court that are argued to give
(16) this court the authority to intervene in an
(17) ongoing case in a different circuit.

(18) It simply seems to be beyond the
(19) authority of this judge, pursuant to the
(20) orders that have been issued that bring this
(21) case before me here. So the order for
(22) Motion for Immediate Relief and
(23) Reconsideration of Incomplete Order and
(24) Immediate Assignment of Neutral Successor is
(25) granted in part and denied in part for the

[Page 72]

(1) reasons that we've stated here.

(2) I will endeavor to complete an order
(3) promptly and simultaneously engage in the
(4) prima facie review that I've described and
(5) is anticipated by the authorities. And once
(6) that is completed, The Court will issue
(7) appropriate orders and rulings based on its
(8) assessment of --

(9) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, if I may --

(10) THE COURT: -- whether that threshold
(11) has been met. Yes, Mr. Hanson.

(12) MR. HANSON: I would like to ask that
(13) The Court take judicial notice of Judge
(14) Frayman's finding of a prima facie case. No
(15) one's asked you to reconsider that. You
(16) know, I have a right to move my case
(17) forward. He made that finding. What gives
(18) The Court the right to -- and, Judge, the
(19) only purpose of this is to delay it.

(20) It's -- you know, it's so obvious to me
(21) and I think to any neutral observer that the
(22) courts just want to make things expensive
(23) and difficult for me. And, you know, I --
(24) what's the court's response in taking
(25) judicial notice of the original judge's

[Page 73]

(1) decision?

(2) THE COURT: I'm not sure I understand
(3) you the necessity of you asking me to take
(4) judicial notice of an order that I've
(5) already indicated that I've read and I've
(6) cited to as part of my ruling, but I think
(7) my ruling is clear and sufficient for the
(8) purposes of ruling on your motion today,
(9) and --

(10) MR. HANSON: It's not, Your Honor.
(11) It's not. It's not at all. It ignores the
(12) facts, it protects fellow elite class
(13) members like yourself and other judges who
(14) are putting my family through hell, and
(15) you're part of that now, Judge. And, you
(16) know, I don't know if I can have you
(17) disqualified, but I will certainly make an
(18) effort.

(19) I think what you're doing is an
(20) absolute, obviously, a miscarriage of
(21) justice, but it's worse than that. It's
(22) gaslighting me like the judicial system has
(23) now for months. And, you know, there's
(24) going to be a lot of defendants in the
(25) federal litigation that I -- the state

[Page 74]

(1) courts are corrupt and, you know, I
(2) challenge anyone to have that debate with me
(3) and a neutral arbiter of fact address those
(4) facts because they're so clear in here.

(5) What is The Court's basis for not
(6) finding a prima facie case today? I'm a
(7) citizen. There is a presumption that I get
(8) records. Records exist. They've identified
(9) them. Why can't The Court either accept the
(10) prima facie case that was already found by a
(11) judge who was incredibly biased against me
(12) or just look at the facts today and tell me
(13) what's lacking in the prima facie case?

(14) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I've granted
(15) your motion in part, and I'm going to
(16) discharge my responsibility under --

(17) MR. HANSON: You're going to delay and
(18) protect the insiders elite.

(19) THE COURT: I'm sorry. Mr. Hanson, I'm
(20) sorry. Mr. Hanson, I thought you were done
(21) talking and so I was trying to answer your
(22) question, but if you want to continue, you
(23) can.

(24) MR. HANSON: No, I just want that to be
(25) clear for the record. That's what you're

[Page 75]

(1) doing. I don't know of any basis in the law
(2) so I look forward to getting your order for
(3) how you're going to explain justifying this
(4) delay. I didn't expect this. I didn't
(5) expect vacating his order finding a prima
(6) facie case taking away the one honest thing
(7) that he did to delay things further, but,
(8) you know, I guess creativity.

(9) But I'm very comfortable telling you
(10) these things, Judge, because they're true.

(11) THE COURT: All right. The Court will
(12) prepare its order granting a motion in part,
(13) and then The Court will conduct it's prima
(14) facie review, as required by Rule 1.360
(15) promptly and, as appropriate, issue an order
(16) in the form of an alternative writ and
(17) mandamus if that is what's appropriate after
(18) this court has had the opportunity to review
(19) that matter. Thank you y'all.

(20) MR. HANSON: Does The Court have any
(21) answer for why it can't review the prima
(22) facie case today? If it was requested in
(23) the motion, is there the reason why The
(24) Court is not prepared to address that today?

(25) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, The Court

[Page 76]

(1) wanted to address your motion and wanted to
(2) get it heard promptly, but The Court will
(3) conduct its own prima facie review as to
(4) whether or not you have met your burden
(5) before it issues any alternative writ of
(6) mandamus.

(7) MR. HANSON: I'm just curious what the
(8) basis and the law of fact. I understand the
(9) delay. I just don't understand how you're
(10) trying to justify it.

(11) THE COURT: Well, my or the should
(12) sufficiently explain that. And if it
(13) doesn't sufficiently explain that,
(14) certainly, you have the opportunity and the
(15) right to take what actions you want to take
(16) based on that. I've done my best here to
(17) rule on the relief requested according to
(18) the law and the authority of the state of
(19) Florida, and that's the best I can do for
(20) you today, sir, but I understand that you
(21) disagree with The Court's ruling.

(22) MR. HANSON: Yeah. And I hope you
(23) understand what you're doing to my family
(24) and young kids, so that's on you, Judge.
(25) That's on the other judges that think

[Page 77]

(1) protecting themselves and their elite class
(2) it's entitled them to hurt people like me,
(3) but I don't think it's right and I'll keep
(4) fighting against it.

(5) THE COURT: Anything else you want to
(6) put as part of the record today, Mr. Hanson,
(7) before I conclude you the proceeding?

(8) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, you're not
(9) going to -- there's 100 different arguments,
(10) in fact, that I could lay out for you that
(11) demonstrate how fair and dishonest of the
(12) activity of the 13th Circuit is. You
(13) wouldn't care about any of it.

(14) You have this mandate that you have to
(15) put things off just like Judge Frayman did,
(16) just like Judge Felix is doing. It is an
(17) absolute outrage and things are so objective
(18) and black and white in my case that I'm just
(19) going to keep pointing that out, Your Honor,
(20) and it will probably make me even less
(21) popular, but, you know, I'm protecting my
(22) kids from having a corrupt system during
(23) more years of their life.

(24) And, you know, I hope some day a judge
(25) will do something other than what you're

[Page 78]

(1) doing, which is just silently -- you know
(2) what I'm saying is true. If you think
(3) anything I've said is false, I would please
(4) request that you advise me of it because I
(5) want to -- I want to have the truth out
(6) there.

(7) If there's anything that I've said that
(8) you think is an exaggeration or is
(9) incorrect, I would really appreciate you
(10) putting that in the order because I think
(11) that it's all well-documented and provable.
(12) So, you know, absent the order addressing
(13) that, I think that The Court's actions
(14) are -- the motivations are clear. The
(15) basis -- I'll look at the order and I'll
(16) file what I feed to.

(17) THE COURT: All right. Thank you,
(18) Mr. Hanson. That will conclude our
(19) proceeding here today for the record. An
(20) order is forthcoming. Thank you.

(21) MR. HANSON: Okay. I'd like to order
(22) to the transcript, Madam Court Reporter.

(23) (Concluded at 11:20 a.m.)

(24)

(25)

[Page 79]

(1) STATE OF FLORIDA)
(2)) CERTIFICATE OF REPORTER
COUNTY OF PINELLAS)

(3)

(4) I, MARIA E. RODRIGUEZ, Notary Public in and for the
(5) State of Florida at Large, hereby certify that the
(6) foregoing proceedings was held.

(7) I FURTHER CERTIFY that the proceeding was reported
(8) in Stenotype by me, and that the foregoing pages
(9) constitute a true and correct transcription of my
(10) recordings thereof.

(11) I FURTHER CERTIFY that I am neither an attorney
(12) nor of counsel for the parties to this cause, nor a
(13) relative or an employee of any attorney or parties
(14) connected with this litigation, and that I have no
(15) interest in the outcome of this action.

(16) WITNESS my hand and seal this 1st day of March,
(17) 2025, at Tampa, Hillsborough County, Florida.

(18)

(19)

(20)


Maria E. Rodriguez

MARIA E. RODRIGUEZ, RPR, FPR

(21)

Notary Public At Large

Commission Number: HH 363312

(22)

Expires: 2/15/27

(23)

(24)

(25)

A			
A-K-E 51:12	18:6 19:1 21:3	alternate 65:14	appropriate
a.m 1:18 78:23	23:21 45:23 67:23	alternative 31:24	24:23 43:4 44:11
ab 10:12	74:3 75:24 76:1	32:11 33:16 35:10	44:17 46:16 47:16
abandoned 30:18	addressed 28:15	35:25 41:20 43:14	57:6 58:21 60:20
ability 23:21 25:13	44:2 64:25	45:24 47:2,5 51:1	66:19 72:7 75:15
able 5:11 10:6	addresses 69:2	51:21 52:4,11 53:3	75:17
21:20 33:7	addressing 5:23	58:15 65:19 67:14	appropriately
absent 69:3 78:12	16:20 23:1,2 78:12	67:17 70:7,9,13,23	45:21
absolute 73:20	adequate 22:16	75:16 76:5	April 11:1,3,10
77:17	51:23 53:4	amended 30:12	21:23
absurdity 10:10	Administration	47:3	arbiter 74:3
abundance 42:18	4:21	amount 12:1	areas 54:1
accept 74:9	administrative	ample 20:10	argue 23:18 34:24
access 28:17,18,24	37:7 38:5 39:16	analysis 36:10	35:15 36:5,8
37:2 39:10 61:16	administrator 1:9	AND/OR 1:9	37:22 40:9 55:14
62:21 65:6	4:10 39:16	animosity 12:11	argued 50:18,19
accomplish 7:7	advice 27:15	68:20	51:3 58:6 71:15
accountability	advise 78:4	announce 3:19	arguing 16:25 51:5
61:1	affirmative 6:4	answer 45:24	argument 19:10
acknowledge 14:2	30:22 61:9	74:21 75:21	19:19 21:8 22:17
acknowledgem...	afford 4:22 32:20	answers 28:12	28:1 35:3 37:21
12:14	aggressive 12:13	ante 32:24	38:21 47:19,20
act 26:19 61:4	ago 38:23 42:4	anticipate 35:21	66:3
acted 55:19 60:21	agree 25:6 48:1	70:20	arguments 40:22
68:14	57:24	anticipated 72:5	77:9
acting 6:15	agreed 11:8 41:23	apologize 29:5	article 9:21,25
action 21:20 44:11	ahead 18:15,16	apparent 19:10	aside 10:4
50:4 56:18 79:15	29:8 52:18 64:15	appeal 14:11 35:19	asked 3:11 11:6
actions 8:1 9:24	Ake 35:7,20 51:12	51:25	26:18 62:12 72:15
76:15 78:13	52:6 59:3	appear 3:12 4:23	asking 17:10,25
active 38:23	Akerman 2:15	28:13 42:8	18:12,22 19:6
actively 38:14	allegations 13:12	appearance 3:20	20:17,20 22:18,22
60:13	14:25 66:14	3:23	27:6 31:17,18,23
activity 77:12	alleged 65:7	appeared 25:9	42:5 48:1,2 60:12
actual 12:11 55:16	allegedly 41:11	42:18 58:24	66:10 67:1 73:3
61:9	alleging 42:14	appearing 3:24	asserted 40:3 65:1
ad 10:16 11:3,15,19	allot 44:14	4:14	assertion 30:22
add 25:21 26:6	allotted 43:16	appears 24:10	assess 46:14
additional 13:6	allow 8:18,19 9:14	52:24 59:4 71:13	assessing 44:20
27:22 30:10 34:17	22:8 40:10,15,25	appellate 21:21	assessment 43:3
34:22 43:22 44:15	49:8 66:23	applicability	44:13 72:8
55:4 60:11 62:12	allowed 4:24 15:19	48:11	assets 8:9
62:24 66:5	allowing 5:20 6:17	application 34:12	assign 18:8
address 5:22 18:2	60:15	appreciate 5:20	assigned 3:11
	allows 59:22	18:18 78:9	24:11 70:2

assignment 1:23 3:9,16 20:22 25:8 69:23 71:24 assist 68:13 assistant 5:7 assisting 60:13 assume 17:19 19:21 20:2,11 49:2 assumptions 19:25 20:12 attachment 7:15 attempt 14:3 attend 5:20 36:25 attended 11:2 attention 23:5 attesting 48:19 attitude 60:22 attorney 1:3 2:11 4:2 5:13 8:20 12:2 12:4 25:22,25 37:24 40:15 42:23 50:1,20 66:15 79:11,13 attorney-client 63:11 attorney/next 1:4 attorneys 7:4 9:2 13:15 63:12 authorities 23:3 35:7,18 47:25 48:6 50:18 66:22 71:8 72:5 authority 19:11,15 20:21,23 23:6 24:2,19,24 25:12 25:17 26:19 36:4 51:24 56:12 71:14 71:16,19 76:18 avoid 15:9 62:15 aware 20:21 25:12 25:16 28:13 41:17 42:7 59:22 62:13 69:13 Ayers 1:10 7:19,21 11:2,6 28:12	B B 1:7 B-A-S-T-O-S 5:15 back 6:1 8:10 12:17 29:10 32:14,24 34:19 36:16 46:6 47:8 51:11 55:2 65:2 background 17:2 bad 9:7,9 14:5 62:2 bait 62:16 bar 6:23,24 7:23 7:25 15:14 61:23 Baron 28:19 base 15:4 based 17:11 24:10 30:14 34:25 45:10 45:17 61:4 67:19 72:7 76:16 baselessly 14:5 bases 23:3 basis 8:3,5 13:5 22:21 27:12,19 30:8,9 31:11 33:6 39:25 54:16 55:4 61:8,11 68:13 74:5 75:1 76:8 78:15 bear 32:7 63:23 becoming 58:25 bed 38:22 beg 14:22 15:24 20:5 behalf 3:24 4:8,14 24:16 25:5 37:25 41:2,6 58:23 belief 43:17 believe 6:8 7:14,15 9:22 13:2,2 19:9 21:2 24:18 29:19 31:10 36:20 42:1,3 42:3 43:2 44:6 45:8 48:25 49:4 53:16 54:3 56:9 61:2 66:9 69:25 believed 37:11	bench 69:19 benefit 64:19 best 76:16,19 betrayal 7:3 better 13:19 16:22 beyond 36:19 37:20 71:14,18 bias 9:15 14:18 biased 39:5 68:4 74:11 big 53:14 bit 16:9 26:17 40:12 black 77:18 bothered 9:13 brief 51:14 64:12 briefly 59:1 66:4 bring 71:20 broad 16:11 23:14 23:20 39:14 71:14 brought 16:16 17:3 23:4 Broughton 50:1 bullying 8:20 bunch 29:12 40:21 burden 37:2 62:21 68:5 76:4 buries 57:4 buy 39:21 C C 1:10 2:1 cahanson77@y... 2:6 calendar 18:20 call 50:24 candor 19:19 care 77:13 career 12:2 carefully 20:14 case 1:6 3:7,8 6:5,8 6:18 7:22 9:20 10:2,3,7,14 13:14 14:15 16:20 18:8 19:8 20:9,18 21:2 23:6,7 25:11,15	28:20,22 29:24 30:21 32:18 34:5 36:10 37:9 38:14 43:11,21 44:2,14 45:3,3 46:7,18,20 46:25 48:16,21 49:7,25 50:5,10,13 51:12,20 53:2,14 54:17,22 56:10,15 58:20 59:2,8,23 61:13 63:2 64:23 65:6 68:19,22 69:3 70:17,22 71:7 71:12,17,21 72:14 72:16 74:6,10,13 75:6,22 77:18 cases 34:12 35:8 43:9 cause 30:3 33:18 34:6 36:13 45:19 45:21 47:6 50:15 52:21 54:24 55:7 57:23,25 58:17 61:10 64:20 65:13 65:14,19 66:21 79:12 caution 42:19 CENTER 1:14 central 28:15 certain 32:12 47:22 49:9 60:25 certainly 16:5 31:8 57:17 58:10 73:17 76:14 CERTIFICATE 79:2 Certified 1:20 certify 79:5,7,11 challenge 38:17 74:2 chance 19:24 54:25 change 27:12 Chapter 48:11 characterization
--	--	--	--

41:13 check 29:9 chief 1:9 7:20 28:21 childhood 56:22 children 1:4 8:12 22:13 62:7 choice 6:19 choices 8:18 choose 61:4 Chris 4:1 CHRISTOPHER 1:3,9 2:5 CINDY 1:8 Circle 2:5 circuit 1:1,1,8 3:8 4:9 10:8 13:11 18:9 19:8 20:19 21:9,19 23:6,8,8 23:13 24:17,20 26:4 27:21 28:22 29:1 30:20 33:12 33:17 37:25 39:12 53:20 55:19 56:25 57:11 61:23 64:24 68:14 70:4 71:12 71:17 77:12 Circuit's 34:21 citation 23:10 cite 35:17 cited 6:6 30:21 49:25 59:3 73:6 cites 51:23 citing 66:23 citizen 74:7 citizens 61:20 civil 50:8 54:9,11 59:2,19 60:3 66:24 67:7 claim 29:2,15 48:24 49:10 claims 27:17 47:22 clarification 37:14 clarify 41:19 clarity 4:18	class 73:12 77:1 classes 17:9 clause 17:20 18:11 19:13 20:17,24 clear 8:7 30:21 35:5 42:16 73:7 74:4,25 78:14 clearly 16:22 26:3 34:16 56:11 Clearwater 1:16 Clerk 1:8 4:14 25:5 25:9 41:3,6,14,16 41:24,25 42:6,9,17 49:21 58:23 client's 11:7 clock 53:11 54:14 67:9 Coleman 3:6 come 36:15 39:21 55:8 71:2 comes 15:9 19:23 comfortable 75:9 coming 10:15 14:21 comma 18:10 51:19,21 53:1 Commencing 1:18 Commission 79:21 communicated 63:13 communication 4:24 5:1 comp 6:21 23:11 compelling 11:11 28:3 65:10 competence 56:1 complaint 6:24 7:25 51:19 52:3 53:1 70:17,21 complaints 28:5 complete 11:13 27:20 60:2 71:5 72:2 completed 14:10 72:6	completely 22:21 63:1 completing 35:24 complicated 34:8 comply 11:12 26:1 compounding 55:16 comprehensive 40:4 conceal 27:24 concealed 8:9 13:13 39:18 concealing 7:21 38:3 concern 21:17 31:17 43:21 concerned 33:11 33:11 concerning 41:8 57:3 concerns 25:25 40:18 conclude 77:7 78:18 Concluded 78:23 Conditionally 69:8 conduct 7:20 14:24 27:23 32:16 67:25 75:13 76:3 conducting 70:19 confidential 34:10 37:11,17 confidentiality 55:12 62:22 65:2 confirm 38:25 confirmation 66:17 confirmed 34:13 conflict 10:11 conflicting 46:13 conflicts 56:12 confusion 54:6 64:17 connected 5:10	79:14 connection 5:3 consequences 9:8 56:17 consider 19:16 34:21 62:6,7 consistent 63:10 63:15 constitute 79:9 Constitution 26:2 constitutional 12:15 34:23 61:19 continuation 58:2 continue 5:9 11:25 15:20 34:24 40:16 56:13,15 74:22 continues 7:10 10:14 continuing 10:8 57:3 66:11 control 8:19 10:4 56:15 convergence 28:21 copies 29:9,10 core 18:24 26:10 correct 14:16 19:14 31:6 60:3 79:9 correctly 35:20 47:19 correspondence 57:15 corresponding 23:13 corrupt 74:1 77:22 corruption 7:7 8:18,23 15:3 61:20 costs 34:18 counsel 4:3 6:16 10:17 17:6 18:4 24:8 31:19 41:2 42:24 58:7 68:14 79:12 County 1:1,14 3:9
---	--	---	---

4:15 12:4 17:8 25:6 79:2,17 couple 5:21 41:7 56:21 63:25 64:9 course 59:4 64:6 court 1:1,8,8,20 3:4,10 4:3,10,11,15 4:16,20,22 5:13 8:10 14:22 15:11 16:4,7 17:3,10,14 17:18,22,25 18:7 18:15,23 19:7,16 20:1,7,9,16,17 21:9,16 22:7,11,15 22:24,24 23:13,24 23:25 24:4,10,19 24:20,24 25:2,13 25:18 26:4,8,14 26:23 27:6,11,22 29:1 30:10 31:14 31:19 32:3,6,10,13 32:15 33:11,25 34:4 35:3,9,14,16 35:19,21,23 37:5 39:5,8,16 40:8,21 40:25 41:3,19,22 42:1,9,24 43:5,12 43:14 44:4,4,6,9 44:12,16,18,22 45:12,18 46:7,20 47:8,16 48:3,4,4,9 48:10 49:12,13,17 49:21,23 50:2,10 50:16,21,23,23 51:6,7,16 52:4,8,9 52:11,15,18,24 53:6,9,17,22 54:4 54:20 55:23 56:3 56:23,23 57:22,22 58:6,10 59:7,9 61:7,7 62:5,19 63:6,23 64:13,24 65:9,20,23 66:10 66:22,23 67:1,11 67:11,21,24 68:6,8	68:24 69:6,11,19 69:24 70:8,12,14 70:19,23 71:4,10 71:12,15,16 72:6 72:10,13,18 73:2 74:9,14,19 75:11,11 75:13,18,20,24,25 75:25 76:2,11 77:5 78:17,22 court's 11:12 15:4 23:5 26:19 33:21 33:21 35:4 40:13 48:18 53:9 72:24 74:5 76:21 78:13 courthouse 9:22 courtroom 1:15 4:4 21:10 23:19 57:20 courtrooms 23:16 courts 10:21 14:2 15:7 21:22 25:5 51:25 56:25 62:4 65:13 72:22 74:1 Courts's 64:7 covers 63:1 create 6:15 creates 25:24 creativity 75:8 culpability 56:16 culpable 68:20 curious 76:7 CURRENT 1:9 custodians 37:5 cuts 32:5	day 9:23 42:4 77:24 79:16 days 13:7 27:18 28:4,4 29:20 30:3 30:6 31:1 34:4,6 36:22,24 43:16,17 43:20 44:15 50:7 51:7 52:12,20 55:1 55:5 60:5 65:4 67:7,9,10 DCA 44:17 45:3 DCAs 15:15 dealing 30:16 60:16 69:16 debate 74:2 deceitful 62:16 December 12:25 41:12 decide 51:19 53:1 decision 51:15,24 73:1 decision-making 49:3 decisions 55:21 declared 69:5 defendant 3:21 6:4,13 19:20 21:4 43:23 50:25 64:19 Defendant's 24:12 Defendant/Res... 1:11 defendants 10:3 12:19,23 14:25 21:12 28:4 30:23 30:24 32:20 41:9 41:10 43:15 44:15 50:25 54:12 59:18 64:25 73:24 DEFENDANTS... 2:9 defense 6:16 10:16 27:16 60:13 65:4 65:6 68:14 defenses 6:4,12 12:18 13:10 30:23	37:21 47:21 65:2 deficiency 26:3 defined 16:23 definitely 54:15 defying 56:11 delay 69:4 72:19 74:17 75:4,7 76:9 delaying 36:20 delays 14:18 36:18 delved 48:10 demonstrate 62:22 77:11 demonstrated 14:15 denied 71:25 denies 71:13 deny 25:2 depending 53:8 depends 40:17 described 48:5 70:24 71:8 72:4 describes 7:25 describing 16:14 deserve 27:22 designed 68:25 desire 34:21 despises 22:1 destroy 39:23 detail 7:25 determination 32:17 44:5 49:7 determine 43:6,12 44:13,20 59:7 71:6 determined 49:6 development 12:10 deviation 14:8 difference 53:14 different 19:3,15 20:2 22:17 23:8 26:21 53:14 54:1 71:17 77:9 differently 63:18 difficult 11:21 31:8 62:11 72:23
--	--	---	---

direct 22:11 directed 27:9 directing 32:12 52:12 direction 27:21 30:19 directly 14:12 21:6 23:22 56:9 66:13 67:23 directly-related 21:14 directs 32:1 50:24 67:18 disagree 8:16 48:2 76:21 disagreed 68:7,11 discharge 74:16 discouraging 60:19 discovery 7:3 8:8 13:23 discredit 14:4 discretion 4:19 discussing 12:21 disgruntled 14:4 dishonest 8:21 9:10 39:5 62:16 77:11 dismiss 44:5,22 dismissal 12:9 49:8,9 70:6 dismissed 47:22 dismisses 50:11 dispute 37:8 57:1 disputed 45:25 disputing 53:18 disqualification 69:5,7 disqualifications 5:25 disqualified 73:17 disregard 68:8 disrupt 69:4 disruption 5:2 distracted 69:16	distressing 56:8 60:18 district 35:19 51:13 51:25 DIVISION 1:7 divorce 7:2 do-over 12:24 27:18 30:5 docket 6:7,9 7:14 7:15 13:3,4 17:8 23:17 33:16 41:11 dockets 9:22 document 7:12 48:14 55:10 62:17 documentation 46:5 57:19 documented 15:2 15:4 34:17 documents 7:21 15:25 36:18,22 38:2 39:17,17,18 43:22 50:14 54:5 65:11 66:18 67:19 doing 7:19 8:6 10:19 15:7 31:23 54:16 73:19 75:1 76:23 77:16 78:1 dollars 63:5 double-sided 29:10 drafted 7:12 due 12:15 13:1,7 42:14 43:19 51:6 54:9 58:2 dumping 62:17 duties 26:2 duty 37:5	efficiency 8:11 efficiently 8:13 effort 73:18 efforts 8:7 egregious 54:17 either 24:8 54:23 61:10 65:17 74:9 electronically 5:8 eliminating 6:16 elite 73:12 74:18 77:1 embarrassing 55:24 employee 79:13 encompass 23:20 encountered 7:6 8:17 encourage 62:5 encouraged 64:2 endeavor 27:3 64:4 72:2 engage 35:9,22 72:3 engaged 27:24 47:24 67:12 engaging 28:10 48:4 enormous 34:20 ensure 21:18 23:16 23:19 ensuring 21:10 enter 22:24 entered 6:2,11 26:21 28:2 43:20 44:3,8 45:1 enters 6:2 61:7 entirely 25:10 entirety 70:11 entitled 67:6 77:2 entitlement 60:22 entry 33:23 34:24 envy 14:20 error 31:7 especially 54:18 60:6	ESQUIRE 2:5,11 2:14 essence 60:8 essential 18:10 established 38:11 51:20 53:2 establishes 50:5 events 35:15 everybody 3:5 4:17 27:4 evidence 10:5 11:18 19:22 22:5 39:4 46:2,15 61:25 exact 23:10 45:14 exactly 8:24 9:25 45:4 48:9 exaggeration 78:8 exceptions 37:21 Excess 46:11 excuse 57:1 58:4 exemplifies 9:20 9:25 exempt 37:12,17 exemption 38:12 62:23 65:8 exemptions 28:23 29:2,7,15,18 31:5 38:1 40:2 55:11 exist 37:15 38:24 44:14 62:25 74:8 exists 15:2 36:12 39:11 exorbitant 66:7 expect 21:11 75:4,5 expedited 27:13 expeditiously 64:3 69:20 expenses 63:5 expensive 72:22 experience 38:19 Expires 79:22 explain 10:18 11:20 69:10 75:3
--	---	--	---

76:12,13 explained 10:13 explains 7:18 23:14 28:23 explanation 9:17 9:18 explicitly 70:25 expose 62:2 express 6:17 extend 41:24 extensive 61:24 extent 30:13 42:6 64:5 extreme 9:4 30:19 extremely 60:21 eyes 38:15,23 F face 48:14 61:13 facial 48:6,7 49:12 facially 43:7,13 44:21,21 48:20 49:6,10 51:22 53:4 facie 14:15 29:24 32:18 34:5 35:4,8 35:15,22 36:5,10 37:9 44:2,14 46:18 48:5 50:5 50:10,12,22,22 51:7,20 52:8,10 53:2,10 54:22 59:8,23 64:23 67:13 68:19,22 70:17,22 71:7 72:4 72:14 74:6,10,13 75:6,14,22 76:3 fact 8:3,5 14:1 15:1 33:24 38:21 39:11 39:25 53:16,19 60:7 68:18 74:3 76:8 77:10 factors 62:7 facts 6:18 10:23 13:11 14:7 27:20	34:16 39:22 40:22 53:23 54:17 56:7 62:6,18 63:7 69:2 73:12 74:4,12 factual 45:25 failed 11:9 13:11 29:25 Failing 37:19 fair 19:22,24 21:3 77:11 fairness 21:10,12 faith 38:21 55:19 false 78:3 family 8:19,21 10:2 19:7 20:18 23:7 34:18 71:11 73:14 76:23 family's 34:22 far 9:5 12:11 23:1,2 55:18 fast 62:23 father 14:5 favor 28:17,18 37:2 39:10 60:14 61:15 62:20 February 1:17 30:7 31:10 federal 56:11 73:25 feed 78:16 feel 60:25 67:22,23 feels 44:9 fees 66:7 Felix 1:10 19:20 21:19 77:16 fellow 73:12 fighting 77:4 figuratively 17:16 figure 13:18 39:13 figured 57:13 file 55:1 78:16 filed 3:17 6:7 7:17 9:21 11:11 13:1,4 14:10 21:17 28:6 29:18 31:10 35:1 37:25 43:3,23	51:19 53:1,15 54:13 55:2 60:9 67:9 files 63:14 filing 11:20 17:18 47:20 filings 63:8 64:9 find 12:7 15:5 16:22 32:19 50:12 finding 32:13 51:8 59:24 72:14,17 74:6 75:5 finds 50:10 69:24 70:21 fine 59:10 finish 59:14 finished 65:24 first 5:14,18 18:6 29:6 36:23 41:4 60:5,5 71:3 five 5:5 FL 1:16 2:6,12,16 flawed 43:3 floor 40:14 Florida 1:1 3:9 7:23 12:3 15:7,14 44:16 45:3 46:6,9 46:20 51:17 59:1 61:17,23 76:19 79:1,5,17 focus 16:9 31:16 47:11 focused 16:17 follow 8:14 61:3 follow-up 37:14 followed 46:22 47:1 66:6 following 3:1 7:23 50:17 follows 3:3 force 57:22 forcing 58:1 62:8 foregoing 79:6,8 forgive 54:2 55:8 forgot 25:21	form 75:16 formal 34:25 37:19 formally 59:18 former 28:3 forthcoming 69:20 78:20 forward 17:1 20:14 22:16 40:20 41:20 69:3 72:17 75:2 fought 61:24 found 36:11 48:22 50:23 52:10 54:21 74:10 four 17:9,22 19:1,5 19:6,13 20:16,23 23:4 24:6,13 71:9 FPR 79:20 FPR-C 1:19 frame 57:7 framework 36:3 Frayman 6:10 9:13 26:16 28:2 29:22 30:18,25 31:25 32:25 36:11 44:8 47:21 48:2 49:1,5 54:10 58:5 60:21 68:3 70:10 77:15 Frayman's 5:24 9:24 12:9,17 16:15 27:8 32:10,21 45:15 48:12 49:3 59:24 68:24 72:14 free 31:1 63:12 Freedom 28:19 friend 1:4 frightens 13:24 Frontage 2:12 fulfill 70:15 71:4 fulfilling 35:23 full 30:6 fully 16:8 function 15:5 fundamental 71:3 further 8:22 21:20
--	--	---	--

54:25 66:16 69:4 69:5 75:7 79:7,11 future 8:19	governs 66:25 grant 17:10,25 19:12 20:23 70:8 70:12 granted 41:22 65:5 71:25 74:14 granting 75:12 grants 40:5 gray 10:24,24 guardian 10:16 11:3,15,19 guess 16:8 25:14 35:5 53:8 75:8 guidance 48:17	Hanson's 43:17 45:11 47:3,19 happen 22:8 40:7 64:22 happened 25:8 57:5 67:5 happening 9:11 13:25 39:8 56:3 60:17 happens 13:14 happy 10:20 harmful 10:5 22:5 31:7 harming 8:2 harms 34:18 hated 12:4 hatred 12:12 head 22:13 54:3 57:4 healthy 10:20 hear 5:11 9:11 19:9 heard 3:8 16:8 32:4 76:2 hearing 3:13,14 9:23 10:12,15 11:2 11:10 13:8 14:9 16:13,15,18 21:23 24:14 27:8 28:14 29:21 31:15 35:2 36:9,16,23,25 45:23 46:3 64:1 69:17 held 79:6 hell 73:14 help 13:17 68:25 Hey 29:11 HH 79:21 Hi 41:5 hid 39:17 hide 13:19 39:6 hiding 55:23 high-volume 6:22 highest 9:4 highlighted 17:24 highlights 47:10	Hillsborough 1:1 4:15 12:4 17:8 25:6 79:17 history 15:13 20:6 20:8 33:13 honest 75:6 Honor 3:25 4:7,13 5:12,19 6:19 8:14 8:24 13:14 14:6 14:20 15:12,15,23 16:1 17:13,21 18:13 18:17 19:17,25 20:4,15,25 21:17 21:24 23:9 24:3 24:15,18 25:20 26:5 27:10 28:16 29:5 33:2 40:1,11 40:14,17 42:2,16 42:21,25 43:1 45:1 45:13,22 46:1,4,14 46:23 48:15,18 49:16,20,22,24 52:16 53:25 55:20 56:24 58:9,11,22 60:18,24 61:6 62:18 64:16 66:5 67:3 68:10 69:8 72:9 73:10 77:8,19 hope 9:16 53:22 55:20 76:22 77:24 hoping 63:21 hostility 9:15 hours 5:22 15:21 33:18 63:4 hundreds 63:4 hurt 9:9 77:2
G gaslighting 73:22 general 2:11 4:21 28:21 42:7,23 50:1,20 General's 25:23 26:1 37:24 germane 40:22 getting 9:9 14:1 26:5 51:9,10 56:21 75:2 gift 65:12 GINA 1:9 give 13:6 23:5 25:13 27:15 30:9 31:20 39:20 40:14 42:2 55:4 57:7 58:8 60:11 64:4 65:13 71:15 given 8:17 9:18 17:2 25:7 61:8 64:1 gives 12:23 48:17 60:1 72:17 giving 5:21 13:18 16:2 34:17 54:13 62:8,11 go 12:11 18:15,15 27:20 29:8 52:18 64:14 go-to 9:4 goes 6:1 46:6 47:12 going 12:17,21 19:9 20:10 27:14,15,16 39:6 43:22 49:2 56:3,5 62:4 73:24 74:15,17 75:3 77:9 77:19 good 3:4 4:12 38:21 55:19 gotten 11:17	H HAHN 32:9 hand 64:14 65:24 79:16 handled 26:4 handles 10:7 Hang 32:3,3 hanging 22:12 Hanson 1:3 2:5 3:25 4:1,25 5:3,12 5:16,19 16:4 17:13 17:17,21 18:13,17 19:17 20:1,4,15,25 23:9 24:1,5,9 25:19,20 26:11 27:10 31:15 32:2,4 33:2 35:12 36:8 40:11 43:2,3 45:6 45:14 47:10 49:18 49:23,24 50:16 52:14,16,18,19 53:5,13 58:8,13,18 59:10,12 64:14,16 65:22 66:3,4 67:3 67:11,16,21 68:3 68:10 69:7,8 72:9 72:11,12 73:10 74:14,17,19,20,24 75:20,25 76:7,22 77:6,8 78:18,21	I idea 33:6 identified 37:7 39:12,15 74:8 identifies 17:9 identify 3:22 37:3 37:10 38:1,2 ignores 73:11	

imagine 57:10 Immediate 1:22 1:23 3:14,16 6:6 7:16 14:10 33:19 53:15,24 54:19 60:8 69:21,23 71:22,24 immediately 16:1 18:7 19:10 70:2,14 immensely 55:25 immunity 34:11 62:25 impact 56:16 imperative 56:19 implied 57:14 important 21:24 impressions 38:7 38:10 inapplicable 63:2 inappropriate 25:1 49:11 53:20 inappropriately 60:21 inclined 40:19 46:23 included 7:13 41:14 including 43:9 62:15 71:2 incomplete 1:23 3:15 27:1 69:22 71:23 incorporated 71:1 incorporates 30:13 incorrect 43:19,25 78:9 incredibly 11:24 74:11 incremental 20:13 indicated 16:10 73:5 indicates 17:18 individually 1:3	inextricably 33:20 information 10:17 46:13 initial 30:11,14 37:12 44:13 48:18 48:23 50:3 initially 11:8 44:19 initio 10:12 injustice 34:20 ins 25:10 insider 9:19 14:19 15:9 66:14 insiders 9:6,7 63:20 69:1 74:18 insinuations 11:18 instances 41:8 instructions 11:12 instructive 31:2 insufficient 49:10 intense 6:22 intentional 8:1,7 intentionally 13:13 interest 21:2,9 79:15 interests 22:6 interlocking 19:4 26:11 interpret 31:22 interrupt 32:5 intervene 24:19 71:16 intervention 24:21 investigation 7:24 invite 24:6 involves 7:2 48:19 issuance 35:10 51:1 58:19 issue 7:1,22 8:8 10:16,24 11:5 19:2 23:22 26:7 28:15 31:13 33:14,15 34:15 35:25 36:24	38:22 44:11 45:12 46:16 47:9 51:21 52:22 53:3 54:22 56:20 63:16 65:9 67:17,18 70:13,23 72:6 75:15 issued 30:8,9,15 31:24 33:1 45:7 47:2 58:16,18 59:5 59:25 60:1 67:14 70:10 71:20 issues 5:9,22 13:23 14:11 16:14,21 21:21 26:10 28:11 33:25 43:14 44:2 45:17,23,25 46:2 48:11,12 52:12 56:10 65:1 76:5 issuing 33:15 36:21 70:7	37:1 38:13,15 39:5 44:8 45:15 47:8 47:21 48:2,12 49:1 49:3,5 54:10,25 56:4,11,14 57:12 58:4 59:22,24 60:20 68:3,24 70:3,10,14 71:19 72:13,18 73:15 74:11 75:10 76:24 77:15,16,24 judge's 72:25 judges 4:9 9:1 13:16 23:14 24:17 24:21 60:22,25 73:13 76:25 judicial 1:1,8 4:9 4:21 5:7 18:9 24:17 34:11 62:25 66:15 70:3 72:13 72:25 73:4,22 judiciary 56:1 61:17 jurisdiction 23:15 23:18 25:3 32:14 jurisdictional 22:9 48:12 justice 1:9,14 12:13 23:16,19,23 39:3 63:18,21 73:21 justification 11:15 justify 76:10 justifying 75:3
J			
Jackson 2:15 January 9:23 13:2 29:19 30:15 31:25 32:11,25 36:9 45:7 47:9 54:20 55:2 58:5 67:5 70:9 Jessica 2:11 4:8 24:15 43:1 jessica.schwiet... 2:13 Johnson 46:8 joint 41:22 judge 1:9,10,10 3:5 5:24 6:10 7:19,19 7:20,21 9:13,24 10:3,9 11:2,6 12:8 12:17 16:15 18:8 19:20 21:1,5,9,13 21:19 23:6 24:11 26:16,16,21 27:8 28:2,12,21 29:22 30:18,25 31:25 32:10,21,25 36:11			
K			
keep 22:2 33:8 68:6 69:1 77:3,19 Keiana 2:14 4:13 25:4 41:5 keiana.wilkers... 2:16 KELLY 1:10 kid's 10:18 kids 8:2,4 10:20 11:16,25 12:8			

15:22 56:20 76:24 77:22 kind 41:17 42:7,16 47:12 48:17 kinder 7:9 knew 68:21 know 4:25 8:15 9:3 15:15 16:23 18:23 20:1 21:11 22:13 23:10 29:14 33:10 40:12,13 46:4 49:9 53:18 54:2 55:7 57:8,10 63:3 63:4,17 65:23 72:16,20,23 73:16 73:16,23 74:1 75:1 75:8 77:21,24 78:1 78:12 knowing 12:1 56:4 known 42:19	learn 53:25 learned 20:12 let's 17:3 18:6 24:5 26:8 letting 8:23 level 47:15 49:13 levels 7:12 life 21:25 77:23 light 33:12,24 35:6 54:18 60:7 liked 68:7 limited 28:24 48:22 line 18:3 linked 33:20 litem 10:16 11:3,16 11:19 literally 6:14 litigant 14:5 16:7 litigants 16:23 56:2 litigated 6:21 13:23 litigation 6:22 21:5,6,14 23:1 73:25 79:14 little 16:9 26:17 LLP 2:15 located 34:13 locks 63:19 long 15:13,16 38:22 57:3 longer 28:6 look 9:3 14:23,23 14:24 20:5,7,8,10 39:9,11 42:13 60:17 62:5,19 63:7 74:12 75:2 78:15 looked 9:2 15:19 65:25 looking 23:10 37:23 48:9 49:25 65:25 looks 10:23 13:10 23:12 62:2	loose 62:23 lot 40:17 73:24 M Madam 78:22 Madamus 50:3 main 11:4 making 32:17 60:14 man's 47:9 manage 23:16,17 23:19 mandamus 12:25 14:16 30:17 31:24 33:1,16 34:12 35:11 40:6 43:4,6 43:15 44:19 45:19 47:2,5,17 48:8 50:6 51:2,22 52:11 53:3 59:17 63:2 66:25 70:7,10,13 70:24 75:17 76:6 mandate 77:14 manner 10:7 61:22 69:4 March 41:25 79:16 MARIA 1:19 79:4 79:20 marital 8:9 massive 68:12 materials 11:1 55:17 matter 3:18 11:14 16:12 25:9,24 56:6,17 64:1 70:2 75:19 MATTHEW 1:10 mean 46:5 48:20 52:17 53:14 meaningless 60:6 means 52:20 mechanism 21:15 30:16 61:18 media 28:20 members 73:13	mental 38:7,10 mentioned 25:11 41:9 mercy 21:25 message 39:3 met 55:8 68:5 72:11 76:4 MIKE 1:10 mind 63:15 64:11 minimum 53:16 minor 1:4 minutes 5:5 miscarriage 73:20 misconduct 15:10 28:14 38:9 55:25 61:25 66:16 missed 37:22 41:12 moment 55:9 58:9 63:24,24 Monday 10:13 money 34:18 monopolize 40:12 months 28:11 36:20 38:20 39:23 62:15 63:3 66:6 73:23 Moore 1:10 35:7 35:20 51:12 52:6 59:3 moot 18:18 24:10 25:7 70:4 morning 3:4 4:12 Morris' 51:18 motion 3:14 5:16 5:23 6:6,9 7:16 11:11 14:10 17:4,7 17:11,12 18:1 23:2 24:14 26:13,25 27:9 31:16 33:14 33:19,20 41:22,23 42:4 47:11 53:15 53:24 54:4,19 55:8 60:8 69:12 69:21 70:8 71:22
---	--	--	--

73:8 74:15 75:12 75:23 76:1 MOTIONS 1:22 motivated 14:19 motivations 78:14 move 8:12 16:22 17:1 18:25 19:5 20:14 24:23 26:8 31:4 32:14 64:21 69:3 72:16 moved 69:6 moving 5:17 17:14 33:9 41:19 47:8 multiple 7:12 43:9 muted 6:14 mystery 34:15	11:14 28:6 39:13 67:12 new 44:11 45:13 47:1 70:13 Newspapers 28:19 nomenclature 26:25 none-complian... 66:12 normal 29:18 59:4 Notary 1:20 79:4 79:21 note 14:14 56:3 noted 24:9 29:24 51:14 notes 59:14 63:25 notice 12:20 33:4 72:13,25 73:4 noticed 3:13 16:13 16:16,18 17:8 31:15 35:1 number 6:9 7:14 7:15 9:1 13:3,4 15:21 18:6,25,25 19:1 25:7 33:14,15 33:16 53:23 79:21 numerous 71:8	obviously 73:20 occur 36:6 occurred 57:2 offer 49:18 offered 38:14,25 38:25 offering 38:16 office 2:11 25:23 26:1 37:24 Oh 46:17 64:13 68:6 okay 5:11 17:14 18:23 20:4 23:25 25:18 32:7,9 40:13 59:12 61:5 78:21 once 11:14 36:11 54:21 59:17 61:13 72:5 one's 72:15 ongoing 8:1 71:17 opening 7:24 openly 7:8 operate 15:5 operation 71:4 opportunity 4:23 16:2 20:10 29:2,4 29:6,14,17 31:21 32:20 36:2 37:23 66:20 70:15 75:18 76:14 opposing 6:16 25:23 opposite 27:21 option 57:25 64:20 order 1:23 3:16 12:17 13:6 14:13 15:25 20:22 22:25 27:1,7,9 32:11,21 32:22 33:3,8,21 33:23 34:5 40:5 43:20,24 44:3,9 44:10 45:1,7,15,18 45:19,20 46:23 47:6,9 48:13 54:11	59:22 61:6 69:1,19 69:23 71:3,21,23 72:2 73:4 75:2,5 75:12,15 78:10,12 78:15,20,21 ordered 34:9 ordering 50:19 67:14 orders 50:14 68:25 71:20 72:7 original 45:18 72:25 outcome 79:15 outrage 69:9 77:17 outright 57:15 outs 25:11 outside 18:8 47:23 65:16 66:24 70:3
N N 2:1 name 3:5 4:13 5:14 5:15 55:8 names 4:5 narrow 16:9 28:25 67:22 nature 37:4 nearly 63:10 necessary 9:8 necessity 73:3 need 11:19 12:8 23:4 28:24 43:15 45:20 60:10,23 67:16,17 needed 30:24 33:5 54:23 needing 63:15 needs 27:11,23 32:15 40:4 43:18 44:3,10 46:14,18 56:4 neither 79:11 neutral 1:23 3:16 18:8 19:8 20:19 69:23 70:3 71:12 71:24 72:21 74:3 never 6:23,23	O object 25:22 41:13 62:4 objecting 45:15 objection 25:21 26:5 69:25 objective 63:9 77:17 obligation 37:10 37:16 51:17 54:21 59:16 64:7 observer 72:21 obstruction 7:8 8:4 obvious 60:20 68:19 72:20	obviously 73:20 occur 36:6 occurred 57:2 offer 49:18 offered 38:14,25 38:25 offering 38:16 office 2:11 25:23 26:1 37:24 Oh 46:17 64:13 68:6 okay 5:11 17:14 18:23 20:4 23:25 25:18 32:7,9 40:13 59:12 61:5 78:21 once 11:14 36:11 54:21 59:17 61:13 72:5 one's 72:15 ongoing 8:1 71:17 opening 7:24 openly 7:8 operate 15:5 operation 71:4 opportunity 4:23 16:2 20:10 29:2,4 29:6,14,17 31:21 32:20 36:2 37:23 66:20 70:15 75:18 76:14 opposing 6:16 25:23 opposite 27:21 option 57:25 64:20 order 1:23 3:16 12:17 13:6 14:13 15:25 20:22 22:25 27:1,7,9 32:11,21 32:22 33:3,8,21 33:23 34:5 40:5 43:20,24 44:3,9 44:10 45:1,7,15,18 45:19,20 46:23 47:6,9 48:13 54:11	P P 2:1,1 page 17:16,19,19 46:10 pages 79:8 paid 28:8 painful 7:1 paint 14:4 paper 29:9 66:1 paragraph 19:12 51:14 part 14:13,16 15:18 20:23 23:4 24:6 24:13 26:9,9 33:19 40:9,9 47:11 51:15 65:14 68:1 69:1 70:1,5,6,8 71:9,25,25 73:6,15 74:15 75:12 77:6 participant 22:4 particular 18:5 22:25 69:14 parties 3:12 46:3 79:12,13 parts 27:11 33:3,7 33:9 65:14 70:25

party 4:5 5:17 19:23 pattern 66:11 pause 5:4 15:17 64:12 pawns 10:21 pay 29:9 66:8 peace 63:15 pending 21:5 people 9:9 77:2 performance 58:20 performed 52:5 period 51:23 61:8 permit 17:5 41:1 49:18 permitted 4:20 persists 10:14 pertinent 51:15 64:10 petition 12:24 25:23 29:22 30:11 30:12,14,17 34:3 41:25 43:6,7,12 44:1,1,5,18,20,23 45:24 47:3,17 48:7 48:19 49:14 50:3 50:20,21 51:5,22 52:7,8 53:4 54:8 59:17 64:23 petitioner 52:1 petitions 40:6 65:11 phrase 38:4 pick 29:9 Pinellas 1:14 3:8 79:2 place 1:14 8:21 25:21 35:6,17 placing 33:14 Plaintiff 3:17,19,24 4:1,2,19 41:8,18 41:21,23 42:8,13 46:24 47:12 58:25 Plaintiff's 25:14	69:21 Plaintiff/Petiti... 1:5 2:3 Plaintiffs 63:9 plan 31:4 play 55:21 62:23 71:2 plead 15:11 57:22 62:19 63:6 pleaded 8:10 pleading 67:4 pleadings 32:23 35:1 52:23 67:20 please 32:7 58:9 78:3 pled 68:18 plenary 23:15,20 71:14 plenty 28:9 point 26:22 32:15 36:7 40:17 43:11 45:5,22 47:12 48:3 58:7 67:23 pointing 77:19 points 41:7 popular 77:21 position 13:21 14:20 25:16 45:9 54:18 56:8 58:12 possibility 61:21 possible 30:19 64:3,5 post-disqualifi... 26:15 posted 7:13 posture 26:17 potential 34:21 56:16 potentially 29:15 39:21 powers 23:15,21 25:25 71:15 practice 4:22 23:11 precede 35:10	predating 43:24 prejudice 33:10,12 prepare 42:12 75:12 prepared 69:18 75:24 present 3:22 4:4 4:17 24:8 41:2 presiding 21:1 pressure 36:17 presumption 28:16,18,24 37:1 39:10 61:15 62:20 74:7 pretty 9:4,7 12:6 12:10 previously 44:8 prima 14:15 29:24 32:18 34:5 35:4,8 35:15,22 36:5,10 37:9 44:2,14 46:18 48:5 50:5 50:10,12,21,22 51:7,20 52:8,10 53:2,10 54:22 59:8,23 61:13 64:23 67:13 68:18 68:22 70:17,22 71:7 72:4,14 74:6 74:10,13 75:5,13 75:21 76:3 primary 64:7 prior 26:20 privilege 63:11 probably 12:2,3,12 20:9 77:20 problem 15:18 problematic 6:3 14:6 procedural 26:17 43:5 45:5 58:14 procedurally 43:2 43:25 44:17 58:21 procedure 27:13 46:21,22 47:1,7,13	50:8 51:18 54:10 54:11 59:2,20 60:3 66:24 67:7 67:25 proceed 5:17 20:13 31:3 41:4 46:19 63:6 proceeding 26:16 57:21 77:7 78:19 79:7 proceedings 3:1 5:10 19:21 23:23 33:25 34:2 79:6 process 12:15 13:18 19:22 53:10 58:3 59:15 60:4 produce 30:2 33:17 34:9 36:18 50:14 52:20 53:12 54:5,23 57:23 58:1 61:10,14 63:13 65:10 67:19 produced 34:7 36:14 37:8 38:12 39:1,17 52:22 57:17 production 15:25 28:3 34:6 36:22 55:17 65:18,18 66:18 progression 7:18 Prohibition 21:18 promptly 72:3 75:15 76:2 Prong 19:6 prongs 18:5 22:17 pronouncing 35:20 proper 30:16 47:13 47:14 proposing 40:24 protect 10:6 13:17 15:22 68:25 74:18 protecting 9:6 30:20 77:1,21
--	--	--	---

protectionism 9:19 14:19 66:15 protects 61:19 73:12 provable 78:11 proven 40:3 provide 9:17 24:21 61:7,11 provided 11:14 12:20 provides 65:16 provision 23:12 61:19 public 1:20 14:12 28:17,18,24 29:3 29:4 37:2,4,12 39:10 55:22 61:15 62:1,20 65:5 79:4 79:21 pulled 17:7 purpose 22:19 72:19 purposes 73:8 pursuant 71:19 push 8:8 40:19 53:17 put 15:11,24 16:3 22:16 27:2 38:22 42:15 53:11 62:14 65:4,23 77:6,15 putting 15:21 73:14 78:10	quo 32:24 quote 33:15	records 13:13,19 14:12,23 27:25 29:3,4,8 30:2 33:18 34:7,14 36:13 37:3,7,13,15 37:16 38:5 39:6,12 39:15 40:4 42:9,11 52:14,21 54:24 55:12,22 57:8,23 58:1 62:1,24 65:3 65:5,8 66:6,8 74:8,8 redo 59:22 60:2 reference 34:11 71:1 referenced 54:11 referral 22:11 referred 21:15 refused 39:2 refusing 10:4 refute 13:12 15:1 regard 9:22 18:21 regarding 8:9 22:25 26:18 36:10 38:5 39:3 53:19 57:1 59:3 regardless 54:16 regret 14:21 reiterate 58:12 reiterating 58:23 rejecting 38:20 related 7:4 11:1 14:12 56:17 66:13 relating 5:24 21:6 relationships 61:5 relative 79:13 relatively 36:4 49:13 relevant 56:9 relief 1:22 3:15 6:7 14:16 17:4,10,24 18:5,21 19:12 24:13 29:25 33:20 40:5 41:17 42:7 48:25 50:5 69:22	70:1,18,22 71:7,10 71:22 76:17 remained 29:16 63:9 remarks 16:5,12 remedy 31:8 remember 37:1 remotely 3:12 repeat 22:19 35:12 replace 39:22 reply 13:4 reported 1:19 3:2 14:1 79:7 reporter 1:20 32:6 78:22 79:2 represent 4:6 request 4:18 11:1 12:14 14:13 24:13 25:1,2,7,14 29:4 33:22 45:11 46:25 61:6 62:1 70:12 71:13 78:4 requested 17:4 19:12 40:5 41:21 48:25 57:18 65:3 65:10 66:5,8,18 70:1 71:10,11 75:22 76:17 requesting 10:25 26:12 45:6 46:17 58:18 70:1 requests 18:7 46:24 require 21:3 29:25 54:4,5 63:7 required 31:1 36:23 44:16,25 45:12,16 46:1 47:6 52:2,5 75:14 requirement 59:19 61:10 requirements 58:14 66:13 requires 30:1 requiring 33:17
Q qualification 65:12 question 22:9,19 31:18,20 35:13 64:18 74:22 questions 37:9 40:18 42:22 quick 14:3 quickly 21:22 64:21,22 quite 16:10 40:11	R R 2:1 Radford 50:1 raise 6:12 29:7,17 raised 6:3,5,13 12:18,18 16:11 22:10 30:23 45:25 47:21 64:14 raising 13:9 read 63:24 64:8 73:5 real 56:8 66:4 reality 57:5 really 6:1 9:16 13:24 22:6 31:7 56:21 58:4 60:18 60:18 62:2,2 78:9 reason 75:23 reasonable 33:23 36:19 reasons 72:1 rebrand 38:9 rebuttal 41:1 49:19 receipt 47:16 received 50:20 51:6 52:7 receives 44:18 receiving 49:14 reconnect 5:5 reconnected 5:6 reconsider 26:24 53:23 72:15 reconsideration 1:23 3:15 27:1 69:22 71:23 record 3:6,21,23 4:18 6:15 15:6 16:3 25:22 42:20 63:8 74:25 77:6 78:19 recordings 57:21 79:10	records 13:13,19 14:12,23 27:25 29:3,4,8 30:2 33:18 34:7,14 36:13 37:3,7,13,15 37:16 38:5 39:6,12 39:15 40:4 42:9,11 52:14,21 54:24 55:12,22 57:8,23 58:1 62:1,24 65:3 65:5,8 66:6,8 74:8,8 redo 59:22 60:2 reference 34:11 71:1 referenced 54:11 referral 22:11 referred 21:15 refused 39:2 refusing 10:4 refute 13:12 15:1 regard 9:22 18:21 regarding 8:9 22:25 26:18 36:10 38:5 39:3 53:19 57:1 59:3 regardless 54:16 regret 14:21 reiterate 58:12 reiterating 58:23 rejecting 38:20 related 7:4 11:1 14:12 56:17 66:13 relating 5:24 21:6 relationships 61:5 relative 79:13 relatively 36:4 49:13 relevant 56:9 relief 1:22 3:15 6:7 14:16 17:4,10,24 18:5,21 19:12 24:13 29:25 33:20 40:5 41:17 42:7 48:25 50:5 69:22	70:1,18,22 71:7,10 71:22 76:17 remained 29:16 63:9 remarks 16:5,12 remedy 31:8 remember 37:1 remotely 3:12 repeat 22:19 35:12 replace 39:22 reply 13:4 reported 1:19 3:2 14:1 79:7 reporter 1:20 32:6 78:22 79:2 represent 4:6 request 4:18 11:1 12:14 14:13 24:13 25:1,2,7,14 29:4 33:22 45:11 46:25 61:6 62:1 70:12 71:13 78:4 requested 17:4 19:12 40:5 41:21 48:25 57:18 65:3 65:10 66:5,8,18 70:1 71:10,11 75:22 76:17 requesting 10:25 26:12 45:6 46:17 58:18 70:1 requests 18:7 46:24 require 21:3 29:25 54:4,5 63:7 required 31:1 36:23 44:16,25 45:12,16 46:1 47:6 52:2,5 75:14 requirement 59:19 61:10 requirements 58:14 66:13 requires 30:1 requiring 33:17

36:21 58:16 research 19:19 69:15 reserve 40:25 resolve 46:1 respect 26:20 27:8 30:19 40:3,9 59:15 69:20 70:5 71:9 respond 24:9 31:19,21 32:21,22 33:5 34:4 36:2 40:15 41:25 42:5 43:16 44:15 45:17 45:20 47:4 50:8,9 51:1 52:19 53:7,8 53:11 59:6,13,16 responded 43:18 43:24 respondent 52:2 58:16 respondents 36:1 46:24 47:4 58:13 67:15 respondents/d... 44:25 responding 12:24 16:24 response 13:1,16 17:5 24:6 25:19 27:4 29:19 30:7,14 31:9 36:15,24 37:12,20,24 40:10 41:7,20 42:13,14 43:19 44:24 49:18 50:24 51:6,8 52:12,22 54:7,8 54:20 55:1,3,6 60:5,9 62:21 67:10 72:24 responses 18:4 24:12 32:12 41:1 64:21 responsibilities 32:16 47:14	responsibility 22:10 35:6,24 67:24 70:16 71:5 74:16 responsible 14:9 responsive 34:14 39:12 55:13 67:4 restricted 48:13 result 17:25 46:3 reverse 51:16 reversed 51:10 review 35:4,8,16 35:23 36:6 43:6 44:13 46:4 47:15 47:23 48:5,7,23 49:13 50:4 51:18 52:25 53:10 66:9 67:13 68:1 70:20 72:4 75:14,18,21 76:3 reviewed 9:5 49:5 50:21 52:8 64:2 reviewing 40:21 47:3 59:1,14 reviews 61:12 rework 55:6 right 3:4 4:3,11,16 5:4 17:22 24:4 25:18 26:8 31:11 33:13 36:12 51:9 53:5 54:1 59:9 63:22 64:8,13 65:20 72:16,18 75:11 76:15 77:3 78:17 rights 12:15 15:22 34:23 55:15 58:3 ripe 29:23 31:13 risk 8:21 22:14 Road 2:12 Roberts 46:8 Roc 2:5 RODRIGUEZ 1:19 79:4,20 role 55:21	rolling 8:22 38:15 38:23 round 67:6 routine 7:5 RPR 1:19 79:20 rug 39:24 rule 16:19 30:10 51:17,18 52:6 66:24 69:18 70:16 75:14 76:17 ruled 6:13 12:19 64:2 rules 4:20,25 7:23 32:16 47:25 50:8 59:1,19 60:2 64:10 67:7,25 ruling 16:19 26:24 46:16 64:4 73:6,7 73:8 76:21 rulings 26:20 60:14 72:7 S SABELLA 1:10 Safe 19:25 sanctions 27:23 sand 57:4 save 40:20 saying 39:14 78:2 says 9:25 50:2 51:15 52:6,25 69:2 scanned 29:10 scary 63:18 scenario 49:4 schedule 45:22 scheduling 38:6 school 10:18 Schwieterman 2:11 4:7,8 24:15 24:16 42:25 43:1 48:15 49:15,20 58:11 scope 15:20 16:11 16:21 47:23 seal 79:16	second 35:18 42:2 44:17 45:3 51:13 59:14 67:6 sections 17:23 security 57:14,16 57:20 see 5:11 9:18 10:19 38:1 48:5 63:8 64:13 70:16 seeking 26:23 41:18 42:8 seeks 62:1 seen 15:3 38:18 41:10 48:18,23 50:7 self-regulated 61:18 self-regulating 61:21 sends 39:2 sense 40:23 sent 29:3,11,13 sentence 18:11 52:1 separate 17:23 separation 25:24 sequence 35:14 serious 66:14 serve 52:2,3 56:13 served 12:25 23:23 41:9,15,16 42:17 58:24 59:18 67:9 service 28:5 29:20 41:11 43:18 serving 21:4,13 set 24:14 69:17 Sherwood 3:5 short 57:7 58:1 show 30:3 33:18 34:6 36:13 45:19 45:21 47:6 50:14 52:21 54:24 55:7 57:23,24 58:17 61:10 64:20 65:13 65:14,19 66:21
--	--	--	---

showing 64:23 shown 71:7 shows 12:10 15:7 55:24 60:22 66:11 70:17,22 side 63:20 sides 61:4 silence 14:3 silencing 12:19 silent 22:3 29:17 silently 78:1 simple 8:4,8 12:14 28:12 simply 33:7 48:13 71:18 simultaneously 72:3 single 8:25 51:14 sir 76:20 situation 8:13 10:1 12:6,9 14:22 21:4 34:19 60:15 66:13 slow 14:2 small 20:13 Smith 43:10 somebody 51:8,10 57:10 somebody's 22:21 somewhat 26:11 sooner 55:17 56:18 sorry 29:5 35:12 45:4 52:16 65:21 65:22,25 67:22 74:19,20 sort 38:16 sorts 20:11 sounds 67:1 space 26:20 speak 9:15 specific 17:9 18:21 23:3 48:16 58:19 specifically 19:18 21:19 27:7 spelled 5:15 sponte 30:22	staff 5:13 stage 24:11 stages 20:9 stamp 17:18 standing 64:11 start 5:23 27:14 59:6 started 30:6 56:24 starting 45:10 starts 67:9 state 4:5 15:17 33:3 37:16 40:15 43:10 45:2 46:8,11 56:12 73:25 76:18 79:1,5 stated 72:1 statements 15:1 53:19 states 46:12 48:24 stating 46:16,21 68:11 status 32:24 stay 16:17 17:15 stenographically 3:2 Stenotype 79:8 step 9:1 10:4 20:16 43:5 51:9,9 52:10 52:25 53:6,9 66:24 steps 8:15 16:23 20:14 50:19 51:3 52:7 stop 15:12,24 stopped 18:9 story 39:22 Street 1:15 2:15 stress 12:1 stressful 11:23 stricken 31:12 55:3 strike 27:17 striking 31:9 strong 10:20 28:17 61:15 62:20 strongly 62:4 structural 10:11	56:12 STUART 1:8 stuff 13:15,16 15:14 29:12 sua 30:22 subject 60:25 submit 42:4 submitted 46:2 subsequent 31:9 substance 64:18 substantial 42:12 Successor 1:23 3:17 69:24 71:24 successors 26:15 succinctly 27:2 suddenly 66:7 sufficiency 48:7 49:12 50:22,23 52:9,10 67:13 sufficient 43:8,13 44:21,22 48:20 49:6 73:7 sufficiently 76:12 76:13 suggest 14:8 suggested 61:12 suggests 50:7 suit 28:7 Suite 2:12,15 summary 11:7,13 summons 28:8 29:20 support 11:19 12:8 14:8 38:13 62:7 supporting 7:20 10:22 57:19 suppose 55:5 supposed 35:4,9,9 35:16,22,25 36:6 64:21,22 suppress 15:8 22:5 suppressed 10:17 Supreme 3:9 21:16 22:11 44:16 46:6	46:20 sure 16:6,17 17:17 22:15,20 25:10 33:5 35:19 42:10 50:17 51:4 64:8 73:2 sustainable 13:20 15:23 sweep 39:24 switch 62:17 system 13:20 22:7 39:4,6 56:1 57:20 61:21 63:19,22 73:22 77:22 systemic 9:19 14:19
T			
tactics 62:16 tagged 34:10 tailored 28:25 take 8:23 21:20 32:6 35:16 55:5 63:24 70:20 72:13 73:3 76:15,15 taken 8:15 talk 17:3 52:17 60:15 talking 15:16 18:24 55:22 60:24 74:21 Tampa 2:6,12,16 79:17 tangential 23:22 task 35:24 48:19 67:12 71:5 tasked 44:19 tasks 52:5 technology 4:24 5:1 66:9 teeth 54:23 60:1 65:15 tell 74:12 telling 75:9 tempered 64:6 terms 7:9 38:4			

57:18 terrible 39:3 terrifying 15:20 testimony 11:8 thank 3:25 5:12,19 16:1 18:17 20:15 24:4 47:7 49:24 59:9 75:19 78:17 78:20 therapists 10:19 thereof 79:10 thing 21:24 45:14 46:12 54:12 63:22 75:6 things 8:16 9:8,10 10:25 11:5 16:6,11 16:16 20:11 31:5 32:22 38:4 63:25 64:9,20 68:12,15 68:16 69:5 72:22 75:7,10 77:15,17 think 4:17 8:14 9:3 13:24 18:10,18 20:25 24:23,24 25:24 27:10 31:3,5 35:18 47:10,18 48:16 53:13 54:6 54:15 57:6 60:23 61:3 64:16 65:7 66:16,20 67:3,5 68:10,17,23 69:9 72:21 73:6,19 76:25 77:3 78:2,8 78:10,13 third 52:9 THIRTEENTH 1:1 1:8 thought 55:10 74:20 thousands 63:5 threat 38:17 three 18:25 19:3 24:7 26:9 40:10 51:9 70:6 threshold 72:10	throw 68:17,24 time 3:7 13:18 15:16 16:2 18:19 18:22 19:18 22:16 24:2 27:22 28:7,9 29:2 30:10,25 32:7,15 34:17,22 35:13 36:9 39:20 39:21 40:13,21 41:1,10,24 42:5 45:17 47:4 49:19 57:7,7 58:2 59:6 59:10 60:7,10,11 61:8 62:8,12 65:2 timing 8:6 today 3:13 15:12,24 16:12,18,20,22 17:9,11 23:2 24:14 26:18 30:11 31:13 31:15 34:25 35:2 40:7 47:19 64:5 69:12,17,18 73:8 74:6,12 75:22,24 76:20 77:6 78:19 today's 26:12 27:7 told 7:4 8:25 12:5 22:1,2 29:11 57:9 top 54:3 touch 5:7 transcribed 3:3 transcript 12:12 78:22 transcription 79:9 transfer 19:7 20:18 23:7 24:20 26:7 71:11 transferring 22:25 transparency 12:16 58:3 61:22 61:24 66:12 traumatic 12:10 treat 38:6 treatment 11:22	trial 21:3 44:18 51:16 52:4 trier 21:1 triggers 36:12 troublemaker 6:20,25 true 75:10 78:2 79:9 truth 8:25 12:5 15:2,5,6,9 22:1,2 78:5 try 5:8 20:13 27:24 38:3 39:23 trying 7:6 15:22 21:18 22:18 28:11 37:14 39:19 53:25 56:13,14 62:14 74:21 76:10 turn 24:5,7 42:22 51:11 55:9 Twitter 7:13 two 7:4 9:23 12:7 18:25 19:3 24:7 26:9 40:9 42:4 51:9 53:9 63:10 70:5 type 19:3 55:10 U ultimate 33:1 ultimately 45:10 45:18 undergoing 11:22 underlying 7:2 10:2 19:7 20:18 25:15 61:25 71:11 understand 20:7 22:7,9,20,23 26:10 33:6 34:2 40:20 51:5 56:2 58:14 62:11 73:2 76:8,9,20,23 understanding 47:18 understatement	68:12 unethical 8:20 9:10 unfair 56:21 unfortunately 48:21 unique 13:21 26:17 unlawful 13:9,10 14:14 27:11 33:8 68:16,25 unlawfully 30:20 unreasonable 68:23 unrefuted 8:1 uphold 26:2 upsetting 12:6 urge 57:21 urgency 53:17 63:7 use 7:8 26:25 V v 28:19 43:10 45:2 59:3 vacate 6:10 27:11 31:22,23 32:10 33:3,7,21 46:23 70:9 vacated 44:10 45:8 vacating 70:5 75:5 vague 11:17 value 9:5 vehicle 69:14 video 7:22 11:4 38:13,15,16,24 39:1 57:10,14,16 videoconferen... 3:2 view 6:17 violating 58:2 void 10:12 voluntarily 25:9 42:17 58:24 vs 1:6 35:7,20 46:8 46:11 50:1 51:12 52:6
---	--	--	---

W wait 5:4 waived 55:15 63:10 66:20 waives 37:21 want 4:4 5:6 8:11 15:17 16:6,8,17 17:1 19:22 20:7 22:15 28:13 31:16 38:6 40:8,12 51:4 59:10,13 63:20 64:4,8 68:6,8 69:15 72:22 74:22 74:24 76:15 77:5 78:5,5 wanted 8:12 11:11 22:2 41:19 42:15 42:19 76:1,1 wanting 41:12 wants 9:11 wasn't 41:16 42:17 55:4 watched 57:9,11 way 13:19 15:19 32:24 46:6 57:13 62:3 ways 6:3 we'll 3:6 34:19 50:24 we're 14:8 18:24 25:10 26:16 27:14 45:5 55:22 60:16 we've 72:1 weaponized 8:5 week 13:7 18:19 70:21 welcome 16:5 welfare 62:6 well-document... 78:11 weren't 16:16 57:12 58:24 wherefore 17:20 19:13 20:17,24 whichever 41:3	white 77:18 Wilkerson 2:14 4:12,13 25:4,4 41:5,6 49:22 58:22 wish 18:4 19:15 22:23,24 24:8 49:17 53:7 66:3 wishing 17:6 WITNESS 79:16 wonderfully 10:18 words 7:8 19:4 work 5:8 22:4 53:6 63:4 69:3 workers 6:21 23:11 worse 73:21 wouldn't 6:14 33:7 49:10 77:13 Wow 9:3 writ 6:1,2,10 7:16 12:25 14:11 21:18 28:1,3 29:23 30:11 30:12,17 31:13,24 32:11 33:1,16,22 34:1,3,25 35:11,25 36:21 37:20 40:6 41:21,21 43:4,14 44:12,19 45:13,19 45:25 47:2,5,17 48:8 50:3,9,13 51:1,21 52:4,11 53:3,9,15,24 54:4 54:8,19,22 58:15 58:17 59:5,15,17 59:25,25 60:1,8 61:14 64:18 65:9 67:10,14,17,18 70:7,9,13,23 75:16 76:5 writ-compelling 65:17,18 66:17 write 11:7 70:6 written 9:14 11:15 wrong 31:4 63:20	X Y y'all 63:23 64:11 75:19 ya 27:17 yeah 7:14 45:8 59:12 76:22 year 7:10 32:12 years 6:21 13:23 56:21 63:10 77:23 young 12:7 76:24 Z Zoom 3:2 4:23 5:14,21 32:5 o 1 1 1:24 25:7 1.140 71:2 1.360 67:4 75:14 1.630 51:18 59:2 66:25 68:1 70:25 71:1 1.630(d) 70:16 1.630(d)(2) 70:24 100 77:9 1008 28:22 11:20 78:23 113 28:20 12th 32:25 134 46:9 13th 3:7 4:8 9:23 10:8 13:11 18:9 21:19 24:16 26:3 27:21 28:22 29:1 30:20 31:25 32:11 33:12,17 34:21 36:9 37:25 45:7,8 47:9 53:20 54:21 55:19 56:25 58:5 61:23 68:13 70:3 70:9 77:12 14 46:10,10	14250 1:15 16 6:21 1700 2:15 17th 21:23 184 46:10 1930s 46:7 1935 46:12 1938 46:10 1997 51:13 19th 13:1 1st 79:16 2 2.4.0(L) 27:14 2/15/27 79:22 20 13:6 27:18 28:4 28:4 29:19 30:2,6 31:1 34:3,6 36:22 36:24 43:16,17,19 44:15 50:7 51:7 52:12,20 55:1,4 60:5 65:4 67:6,9 67:10 20-day 54:7,8 59:19 200 2:12 2003 45:4 2022 43:11 2024 8:11 11:20 2025 11:1,4 79:17 2026 1:17 22nd 11:10 23rd 41:12 25-CA-010255 3:7 25-CA-10255 1:6 25-page 7:24 2d 28:20,22 45:2 2nd 30:7 31:10 3 3 33:14,15 326 46:9 335 43:10 33602 2:16 33607 2:12 33634 2:6
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3507 2:12 363312 79:21 377 :14,16 3934 2:5 3d 43:10 4 40 13:3 401 2:15 45 13:4 4733 :17 48 33:18 47:9 49 6:9 49th 1:15 4th 11:3 42:1,14,15 5 5,000 66:10 52 6:7 531 28:20 6 6 1:17 17:19,19 7 79 1:24 795 43:10 8 840 28:22 86 48:11 8th 13:2 29:19 30:15 55:2 67:5 9 9:30 1:18			
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EXHIBIT 3

Hearing Transcript — Apr. 13, 2026 (Hon. Sherwood S. Coleman) (excerpt)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-04-13 | 30 pp.

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH, FLORIDA

CASE NO. 2025-CA-10255

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and
as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend
for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old],

Plaintiff,

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,
CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH
JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT
COURT ADMINISTRATOR), CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER
C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS,
JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE,

Defendants.

_____/

Page 2 TRANSCRIPT OF HEARING PROCEEDINGS Motion for Protective Order to Stay Discovery VOLUME 1 (Pages 1 - 53) DATE TAKEN: April 13, 2026 TIME: 10:00 a.m. - 11:12 a.m. PLACE: REMOTE BEFORE: SHERWOOD S. COLEMAN, Circuit Judge This cause came on to be heard at the time and place aforesaid, when and where the following proceedings were reported by: Kathy Wong, Digital Reporter Job No.: 446278	Page 4 I N D E X Proceedings Defendant's Motion RE: Motion for Protective Order to Stay Discovery RULING: E X H I B I T S (None marked.) PAGE 16
Page 3 APPEARANCES: On behalf of Christopher Hanson: Christopher Hanson 3934 East Eden Roc Circle Tampa, Florida 33634 BY: CHRISTOPHER HANSON, ESQ. cahanson77@gmail.com On behalf of Thirteenth Judicial Circuit et al.: Office of the Attorney General 3507 East Frontage Road Suite 200 Tampa, Florida 33607 BY: JESSICA SCHWIETERMAN, ESQ. Jessica.Schwieterman@myfloridalegal.com Also Present: Noreen Marcus, Website Reporter, Florida Bulldog Chris Nauman, Assistant General Counsel in the 13th Circuit Legal Department	Page 5 Proceedings began at 10:00 a.m.: THE COURT: So, I'm Judge Sherwood Coleman. We are here for proceedings today in case number 2025-CA-10255. These proceedings are being held in Clearwater, but are proceeding through the Circuit Court of the 13th Judicial Circuit involving an action assigned by the Supreme Court to discharge. I'm going to go ahead and have those individuals who are present as litigants identify themselves for the record. And I'll start with the plaintiff. Go ahead, sir. CHRISTOPHER HANSON: This is Chris Hanson for the plaintiff, and also serving as plaintiff attorney. THE COURT: All right. And someone is identified as the box labeled "owner" on my Zoom screen. I'm going to mute that screen just because it's providing some amount of feedback, Mr. Hanson - CHRISTOPHER HANSON: I don't think it's me. Is it? THE COURT: It was picking up some part of your microphone and was highlighting -- or it had some background noise. I don't believe it was you because I could see a face briefly at the owner

Page 6 1 screen, and it didn't appear to be you, sir. So, I 2 think we're okay. But they've unmuted themselves. 3 Owner? 4 MS. MARCUS: Yes, sir. I'm a website reporter, 5 Florida Bulldog. My name is Noreen Marcus. 6 THE COURT: Okay, ma'am. The only reason I'm 7 muting your microphone is there's some sort of 8 background noise on your screen. 9 MS. MARCUS: Please, I'm sorry about that. I 10 just want to be a fly on the wall. 11 THE COURT: Oh, I understand completely. But I 12 didn't want to miss what Mr. Hanson was saying, 13 which is what happens when a different box lights 14 up. So looks like we're muted now. And I also want 15 to make sure our court reporter gets an accurate 16 record. So representing defendants? Ma'am? 17 MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes, Your Honor. Jessica 18 Schwieterman, on behalf of the 13th Judicial 19 Circuit, the current court administrator, Chief 20 Judge Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, and Judge Matthew 21 Felix. 22 THE COURT: Right. I know who the box labeled 23 owner is. There's a box labeled KCN. Is that an 24 attorney or litigant in this proceeding? If it is 25 an attorney or litigant in this proceeding, I'm not	Page 8 1 asked to watch the hearing. That's all. I do not 2 represent the Thirteenth Circuit in this. Just Ms. 3 Jessica does. I just quickly logged on to the work 4 computer. Was unable to change my name and 5 literally am just listening to the hearing. I can 6 get off if it makes it easier, but I am not a party 7 or representing any party in this matter. 8 THE COURT: All right. You don't have to leave 9 it. It's certainly an open public courtroom and 10 open public virtual courtroom. I will mute you just 11 like I did with the other folks, just so any stray 12 background noise doesn't enter our record and 13 prevent me from being able to hear the arguments and 14 remarks of counsel as clearly as possible, and 15 prevent an accurate transcription of those. Thank 16 you, sir. So, everybody, as I was indicating, we 17 are here for proceedings that have been scheduled 18 with the court. The court's calendar in the 19 original notice that the court accepted for a 20 virtual hearing was filed on April -- was last filed 21 and updated on April 9th to notice of a virtual 22 hearing on a motion for protective order to stay 23 discovery. That's on behalf of your client, Ms. 24 Schwieterman -- 25 MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yes, Your Honor.
Page 7 1 able to -- all right. I'm going to have you make 2 your appearance for the record so our court reporter 3 knows there were additional counsel present. I will 4 ask you -- says you don't have a mic, but I'm 5 showing that we have an audio connection to your 6 box. 7 So I'll just go ahead and read your name for 8 the record in the Zoom chat. User identified in 9 Zoom KCN has identified himself via the chat module 10 as Assistant General Counsel Chris Nauman, N-A-U-M- 11 A-N, Madam Court Reporter. And indicates that he is 12 observing these proceedings. 13 MR. HANSON: Excuse me, Your Honor. I didn't 14 catch. Assistant General Counsel of what, please? 15 THE COURT: I don't know the answer to that 16 question. Ms. Schweiterman, do you know the answer 17 to that question? 18 MR. NAUMAN: Your Honor, can you hear me? You 19 said you saw mic. Can you hear me? 20 THE COURT: I can hear you, sir. 21 MR. NAUMAN: Okay. I do not normally use Zoom 22 from my desktop. I was just watching, but I can -- 23 since you can hear me, I will let you know I am 24 Chris Nauman, the Assistant General Counsel in the 25 Thirteenth Circuit's Legal Department. I was just	Page 9 1 THE COURT: All right. On April 10th at 10:30, 2 there was, I believe filed by you, Mr. Hanson, or 3 someone on your behalf, a plaintiff's cross-notice 4 virtual hearing indicating that we should please 5 take notice that the plaintiff, Christopher Hanson, 6 has scheduled the following manner to be heard 7 concurrently with the defendant's previously noticed 8 hearing via Zoom video conference in the matters 9 identified there as the plaintiff's motion for 10 summary final order compelling production of public 11 records and entry of a peremptory writ of mandamus. 12 I'll typically start with the first in time being 13 noticed in those sorts of things. 14 But as my office, I think, as communicated back 15 to all counsel, the court does not routinely permit 16 counsel to simply cross-notice and attach themselves 17 to other counsel's hearing time and do those sorts 18 of things so it appears that we need to do a little 19 bit of case management before we get started. 20 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, if I may? Or if I'm 21 jumping again, I'll stay silent for now. 22 THE COURT: You can, just for a second. But 23 let me make sure something I should have started 24 before. Are both counsel able to hear me clearly 25 okay? I should have made sure I had good connection

Page 10 1 for you like I did for everybody else. 2 MR. HANSON: Yes. 3 MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Yeah, Your Honor. I'm able 4 to hear you. 5 THE COURT: Okay. Well, Mr. Hanson, I'll let 6 you tell me if you think there's something that 7 would help clarify or address these matters in a 8 moment. But let me just make sure that I understand 9 the lay of the land and then we can see. It may be 10 that what you had to say would clarify that further 11 but let me have you understand where the court's 12 understanding lies so that you know what you may 13 need to correct or adjust about my understanding 14 first. Okay? 15 MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor. 16 THE COURT: Having reviewed at preliminary 17 level, your motion is noticed here because I think 18 it was filed just about the same time or immediately 19 before. Your motion was a few days ago. There are 20 times that the court does, as my practice 21 preferences indicate that I sent back out a lot of 22 court to resolve interlocking issues or where we can 23 use additional time that's available on a court's 24 calendar to cross-notice for efficiency and 25 expediency's sake and tend to make good use of the	Page 12 1 interrupting. I'm just trying to do case management 2 at this point. And I'm trying to make sure that I 3 understood your motion. So my question, if we can 4 move back to it, is you've cited Rule 1.510 and 5 indicated that it is as amended to the modern 6 standard in Florida to the Florida conforming itself 7 to the federal Celotex standard. 8 Is that a motion for summary judgment, or is it 9 not a motion for summary judgment? Because it reads 10 like a motion for summary judgment where you're 11 saying there aren't any disputed issues in material 12 fact, and therefore the court should rule in your 13 favor. So can you clarify, is it a motion for 14 summary judgment or is it not a motion for summary 15 judgment under 1.510? 16 MR. HANSON: It's not -- 17 THE COURT: Because I want to make sure that I 18 follow the right rule. And Rule 1.510 is the one 19 that you're telling me I should follow in motion. 20 MR. HANSON: Right. And, Your Honor, it 21 provides a structure for the court's analysis in 22 terms of whether to issue the writ today. I don't 23 think that a motion is necessary. The writ process 24 is expedited by rule. There's a presumption in 25 favor of access. And the failure on the part of the
Page 11 1 limited resources that we have. 2 Of course the most limited those being time. 3 But I became concerned upon seeing the title of your 4 motion. And reading further into it, that it 5 appears to be a motion brought under Rule of Civil 6 Procedure 1.510, which deals with summary judgment. 7 It's not titled as a summary judgment in your 8 caption. But it appeared to the court from you 9 citing to 1.510 that summary judgment and your 10 reference to the Celotex standard that summary 11 judgment is what you're moving for by this motion. 12 Is that accurate? 13 MR. HANSON: Not exactly, Your Honor. I don't 14 know that there was -- actually thinking about now, 15 I could have worded it better. And if I could go 16 back I would word it as motion to comply with 17 expedited requirements for writ proceedings. It's 18 something that's just required in the law. Once 19 they've had the opportunity to respond -- they've 20 had three opportunities to respond now. They 21 haven't met their burden. It's time to issue the 22 writ. And your order on the writ at docket number 23 62 notes that the court may enter the writ without 24 further notice of hearing. So -- 25 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, pardon me for	Page 13 1 defendants to meet the burden of demonstrating a 2 material fact regarding an exemption, that's the end 3 of the writ case. So it's not -- 4 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, and I'm sorry, because 5 you are going back into the summary judgment 6 framework of then demonstrating an issue of material 7 fact. But the rule that you cited to the court in 8 your motion gives them a period of time to 9 demonstrate an issue of material fact, and gives 10 them a chance to file a response to your motion. So 11 I understand the framework that the court's supposed 12 to apply in resolving issues under Rule 2.420, and 13 was prepared to set a final hearing in this matter 14 when I saw that you had propounded discovery, which 15 I assume, if you propounded discovery, you wanted an 16 answer to your discovery request. 17 So if this is not a motion for summary 18 judgment, then I'm going to move back to what we 19 originally scheduled for hearing today. So, I feel 20 like I'm pretty clear when you respond to; this is 21 not a motion for summary judgment. Is that right? 22 MR. HANSON: No, Your Honor. For the purposes 23 of today, it is not, and I hope this doesn't 24 continue past today. But it may become one. But 25 for purposes of today it's not a motion for summary

Page 14 1 judgment. 2 THE COURT: Well, Mr. Hanson, things don't 3 become things. Okay? And I'm trying to conduct 4 this case in an expedited way. But if you file 5 motions that cite to rules and then change what the 6 motion is and set it for hearing outside of court 7 procedures, and if you then say, "well, it's not 8 that today, but it may become that in the future," 9 you're not helping me get this to the expedited 10 conclusion that I'm supposed to get it to. 11 So if you're going to file another -- if you 12 are going to file a motion for summary judgment, I 13 expect that it will be filed pursuant to Rule 1.510, 14 and will be titled as such, and it will stay as 15 such. I don't want to start doing a bunch of 16 summary judgment research, having responses filed, 17 and then come back and say, "Well, it's not actually 18 what Rule I cited to before. It's something 19 different." That will assist the court by providing 20 clarity. It will assist my analysis. It will 21 assist my ability to set the right kind of hearing 22 and the right kind of time and to analyze the right 23 things, so that I can get this done faster and more 24 accurately. 25 So I'm going to put aside the cross-notice here	Page 16 1 record now. So I would argue that it was defendants 2 that initiated the discovery rules. 3 THE COURT: Oh, well, was it? That's fine. I 4 don't know the initial disclosures are discretionary 5 in the proceedings under the Rules of Civil 6 Procedure. They're now constructed. But I didn't 7 mean to impugn whoever initiated discovery. I was 8 just saying that since our last hearing, I looked at 9 the docket and saw several entries where you had 10 propounded discovery, whether in response or 11 initiating, isn't of any particular moment to the 12 court here. 13 So that discovery hadn't been propounded. It 14 appears to have been received by the defendants 15 because the defendants had moved for protective 16 order. So I'll hear argument in favor of that 17 motion and an argument against that motion. And 18 then I'll -- if I don't have any additional 19 questions at that time, I'll allow the defendants 20 doing a closing remarks in support of their motion 21 and attempt to rule if I can here today. Otherwise, 22 I will take the matter under advisement. 23 Defendants, you can proceed with your motion. 24 MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Thank you, Your Honor. 25 We're here on a motion for protective order to stay
Page 15 1 and the cross-noticed hearing. And I'm not going to 2 be taking up the matters cross-noticed under the 3 motion for summary final order that you have filed 4 with the court on this date. It can be scheduled in 5 the future as appropriate when necessary. 6 So, turning to the matter in today's notice of 7 hearing. Today, what I have scheduled for hearing, 8 I've got here is a motion for protective order to 9 stay discovery. As I indicated, I saw from the 10 docket, Mr. Hanson, I believe that you propounded 11 several types of general discovery. I think I saw a 12 request for admissions and some other things. So I 13 have not reviewed exactly what that discovery is in 14 detail because that's normally a matter that the 15 court allows the parties to work out between 16 themselves in answers and responses, except for, as 17 we have here, a motion for a protective order to 18 stay discovery that's been filed by the defendants. 19 So let's decide -- 20 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, if I may just add one 21 fact to that. It was actually defendants who 22 initiated discovery in requesting my initial 23 disclosures when they first came on the case. So I 24 had a question about whether I actually had to do 25 those, but I did them. And they're part of the	Page 17 1 discovery, as this is a mandamus proceeding and 2 discovery is not appropriate, pursuant to Florida 3 Rules of Civil Procedure 1.630. Florida Rules of 4 Civil Procedure 1.280(c), "protective orders may be 5 issued upon motion by a party or person from whom 6 discovery is sought, and for good cause on the court 7 in which the action is pending may make any order to 8 protect a party or person from annoyance, 9 embarrassment, oppression, or undue burden or 10 expense that justice requires." 11 In this proceeding, this is a mandamus 12 proceeding. It is not a regular civil case. 13 Discovery is not appropriate. Rule 1.630 provides 14 the instruction for the issuance of a writ of 15 mandamus, and the initial pleading has the rules 16 specifically laid out, and the rule states, "the 17 caption must show the action filed in the name of 18 the plaintiff in all cases and not on the relation 19 of the state, when the complaint seeks a writ 20 directed to a lower court or to a governmental or 21 administrative agency. A copy of as much of the 22 record as is necessary to support the plaintiff's 23 complaint must be attached." 24 In this proceeding, we are looking at mandamus 25 and what it is supposed to do. Mandamus is a common

Page 18 1 law remedy used to enforce and establish legal right 2 by compelling a person in an official capacity to 3 perform an indisputable ministerial duty required by 4 law. And that's exactly what we're here for in 5 these proceedings. 6 Mr. Hanson is claiming that these records were 7 not provided, and that the video that the defendants 8 are claiming is protected. Mr. Hanson is seeking an 9 alternative means to get that video without 10 following Chapter 119. Additionally, the discovery 11 that Mr. Hanson is seeking, is exactly what this 12 mandamus proceeding is designed to accomplish. Mr. 13 Hanson is seeking depositions of the judicial 14 defendants in order to seek if they have additional 15 documents or if additional documents exist. 16 However, it is not appropriate, given the 17 scenario, until a ruling has been issued by this 18 court. And we still have additional issues to 19 address within the mandamus. Mr. Hanson must 20 demonstrate he has a clear legal right to the 21 requested relief, and the respondent must have an 22 indisputable legal duty to perform the requested 23 action, and the Petitioner must have no other 24 adequate remedy at law. 25 And we maintain that those have not been met by	Page 20 1 divorce proceedings. It's domestic relations 2 proceedings. And it's wholly improper to depose a 3 judge based on their decisions and their rulemaking. 4 The party may not depose or otherwise compel 5 the testimony of a judge unless the testimony is 6 absolutely necessary to establish factual 7 circumstances not in the record. Mr. Hanson has 8 court orders. He has all kinds of written 9 communication that have been attached to the initial 10 complaint. And I know that there was an amended, 11 but it's in the record. We have it. 12 And as it pertains to the court's mental 13 impressions involved in this litigation, they're 14 protected by judicial immunity, and they are not 15 subject to discovery. If Mr. Hanson is upset with 16 how a ruling was made or how behavior was during the 17 proceeding, there are other ways to obtain those 18 records, and deposition of a judge is improper. 19 In conclusion, mandamus is an extraordinary 20 remedy that should be limited to compelling clear 21 legal duties and not resolving complex factual 22 disputes that require extensive discovery. Allowing 23 discovery would transform the mandamus proceedings 24 into ordinary civil litigation that undermine its 25 streamlined nature. I realize that this has been
Page 19 1 Mr. Hanson. Further, this is an action under the 2 state's public records acts, as codified in Chapter 3 119. And Mr. Hanson has to show that he made a 4 specific request for public records, that it was 5 received, the requested public records exist, and 6 that the defendants improperly refused to produce 7 the public records in a timely manner. 8 And as it relates to public records disputes in 9 discovery, it has very rarely been addressed. But 10 the Florida Supreme Court in State v. Smith 11 established that discovery disputes are redressable 12 by appeal and not by mandamus. Discovery is not a 13 part of the mandamus framework, specifically because 14 Rule 1.630 requires that it is -- the records that 15 need to be addressed are to be attached in the 16 initial proceedings. 17 If there are records that were not attached, 18 discovery is not appropriate. And Mr. Hanson needs 19 to include those. Additionally, Mr. Hanson is 20 seeking to question the judges and other court 21 administrators in relation to their role as the 22 judges and the hearing officers in their official 23 positions within the public records request. 24 And these judges have overseen his lower court 25 or his other court proceedings. I believe it's	Page 21 1 lengthy and ongoing, and this court has had to issue 2 multiple orders at the motion and filings of Mr. 3 Hanson. 4 However, that is not the responsibility of the 5 defendants, and it's not the responsibility of the 6 court. Unfortunately, Mr. Hanson has caused these 7 proceedings to extend longer than they should. And 8 he is seeking the exact same documents in discovery 9 that he filed the mandamus action for. 10 I understand that Mr. Hanson is seeking public 11 records, and those public records were provided. 12 However, Mr. Hanson was not happy with how those 13 public records were provided, as he did not feel 14 that they were provided in a means that met 15 discovery and in a responsive format. However, that 16 is not how public records requests work. Public 17 records are not discovery. Discovery is not public 18 records. 19 And while Mr. Hanson's misunderstandings are 20 understandable if you have not dealt with public 21 records, it's not a basis for discovery, and it is 22 not a basis for overcoming judicial immunity. But 23 more importantly, it's wholly improper for a 24 mandamus proceeding to allow for discovery in the 25 exact documents in which, or the video specifically,

Page 22 1 which is subject to this proceeding. 2 So we would request that this honorable court 3 issue an order staying discovery until a ruling on 4 the writ or after an evidentiary hearing, if Your 5 Honor so decides. Thank you. 6 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, you may respond. 7 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, in all of that, I 8 didn't hear anything about an exemption to 9 production of any of the records that I've 10 requested. And I believe that your order from 11 February 17, request that information. They're 12 asserting exemptions but they don't have any actual 13 evidentiary support for any of them. And they talk 14 about this immunity idea. Where is there any 15 authority that immunity has any place in the 16 analysis of responding to public records? I'm not 17 seeking damages. I'm seeking access to information, 18 which is a basic constitutional right in Florida. 19 And these are very serious issues that we're 20 dealing with here, and the delays that have already 21 happened. And I will stipulate, no discovery's 22 needed. The court's already found that I have 23 asserted prima facie cases for relief here. That's 24 happened twice. Once it just caused a delay. But 25 two independent judges have found that I've	Page 24 1 conceal evidence of judicial misconduct to my 2 detriment and to the public's detriment. 3 I understand that Judge Ayers has decided to 4 run for reelection. This video and these other 5 records that I'm seeking are critical to the public 6 interest. Additional delays are completely 7 unsupported by the facts in the law. There's no 8 basis for the court not to enter a writ today. 9 Given the two prior findings of prima facie 10 cases, the lack of any good faith objection based 11 upon exemptions or any other law -- for example, 12 Your Honor, their conduct even in these proceedings 13 is so deceitful and presumptive of, "we just don't 14 have to follow the law." They're required to 15 identify the records that they concealed, that they 16 did not give me. Which they didn't do any privilege 17 log. They've never done a privilege log in this 18 case. Which under 1.280 parenthetical (e)(6), is 19 conclusive. The failure to do a privilege log is 20 waiver of that privilege. Given the findings of 21 prima facie cases, case is over. 22 The rule requires an expedited nature for these 23 proceedings. They fail to meet their burden of 24 proving any exemption, the case is over today. I 25 would like an explanation under the facts and law
Page 23 1 presented prima facie cases for relief. 2 That shifts a burden to the defendants to show 3 that there's a genuine issue of fact as to some 4 exemption. There's some reason as to why they 5 shouldn't have to comply with the public records 6 requests. And we're talking about severe judicial 7 misconduct here. And the cover-up is getting just 8 as bad as the judicial misconduct was. 9 And the court seemed to go about this insider 10 protectionism like it's business as usual. It's 11 violative of constitutional rights. Not just of 12 mine where this evidence is directly relevant to a 13 hearing that I have on Friday on the exact same 14 motion that was heard on April 4th of 2025, where 15 Judge Ayers was rolling her eyes at me repeatedly, 16 lied about it, incorporated the video into the 17 record. And her bias was already at issue. 18 I'd already filed a motion to disqualify her 19 back in January of 2025. I'd requested that the 20 attorney general's office investigate the Thirteenth 21 Circuit in early 2025. Now they're representing the 22 Thirteenth Circuit. That's an obvious 23 constitutional separation of powers issue beyond the 24 conflict of interest and the fact that we have two 25 branches of government actively working together to	Page 25 1 for any delays beyond today before issuing the -- if 2 we're not going to issue the mandamus for 48 hours. 3 I need these records. 4 There's a hearing where it's critically 5 relevant to my argument that a dishonest attorney 6 and a corrupt judge colluded to weaponize my kids 7 now for over a year. And the courts just sits back 8 and says, "We get to do this. We get to do what we 9 want. We can hide the records and do whatever we 10 want to your family." 11 The courts have a responsibility. And that's 12 to pursue the good -- pursue truth in good faith and 13 to decide issues in accordance with the law. And 14 when they start to have biases to a certain attorney 15 or to other judges, that is as serious of a 16 violation of one's constitutional rights as one can 17 have. 18 There has been multiple occasions throughout 19 this litigation including the underlying litigation 20 against the Florida Bar where there's pure bad faith 21 and advancement of this entitlement argument where 22 those in power don't have to follow the rules. And 23 my family's because of that. I see it every day. I 24 put hundreds of hours into this. And I know the 25 law. I know the facts, and it's conclusive that I'm

Page 26 1 entitled to relief here. 2 There's a presumption of public access here. 3 The court has ignored that throughout these 4 proceedings. And there's case law that speaks to 5 the fact that in public records litigation, delay is 6 tantamount to denial. And in the defendant's 7 motion, they actually suggest that I need to proceed 8 with the underlying family law litigation, which is 9 marred by misconduct and bias. That will be further 10 evidenced in the records that they're concealing. 11 So their argument seems to be, "You have to 12 deal with the underlying proceedings with all the 13 corruption that the judge introduced and maybe we'll 14 give you the records later." Well, that's not how 15 the law works. So, Your Honor some of the records 16 that they have not identified. 17 I would hope that the court and defendants 18 would agree that there's a duty under either Rule 19 2.420 invoking the Rules of Civil Procedure or 20 directly in 119 which defendants repeatedly cite, 21 that requires any materials withheld to be 22 identified. And if you look at their motion for 23 protective order to stay discovery, here's how they 24 identify the records that they didn't produce. 25 The last sentence starts at, "while the	Page 28 1 about it. This court has a duty to hold them 2 accountable. And this continuing of sua sponte 3 party presentation principles that are delaying this 4 is incredibly inappropriate. It's the exact 5 opposite of what the constitution and the law 6 requires. 7 The only benefit served by delaying this 8 further is to protect insiders at the Thirteenth 9 Circuit. There's no facts or law on that side. And 10 we appreciate an explanation for the court. If the 11 court is inclined to delay this further despite 12 multiple findings of prima facie cases, three 13 separate bites at the apple. The rules give them 14 one chance to respond to the petition for writ and 15 introduce evidence that shows there's some material 16 fact that requires further proceeding. They've had 17 three chances. They haven't done it. 18 And I don't know exactly where the court may be 19 getting lost in the process here, but the burden 20 definitely shifts after I submit the request prima 21 facie case findings in the case. They have the 22 burden. They haven't met it with respect to 23 anything. So the only reasonable option under the 24 facts and law in this case is an order compelling 25 production of everything that I requested and
Page 27 1 response to the public record request was not 2 provided to plaintiff in his ideal discovery format, 3 the documents received are responsive, and discovery 4 is improper for a mandamus proceeding as documents 5 subject to the litigation have been filed with the 6 court as part of the initial filing, or are 7 confidential and have not been provided in 8 accordance with Florida Statutes." 9 How would the court or myself have any way of 10 assessing that? They just have concealed documents, 11 not name them and said that we think that they're 12 covered. Well, I think that they're probably really 13 embarrassing for the Thirteenth Circuit. I'm pretty 14 confident that that's the reason for concealment. 15 There's no exemption or exception to public records 16 laws for it's going to embarrass the powerful 17 people. That's the precise reason that the 18 constitutional right is imperative. Is because 19 sometimes the people in power do things they 20 shouldn't. And they don't get to hide behind, "it's 21 confidential" when I can even tell you exactly what 22 it is. 23 But we're going to have this complicated 24 sentence with a little clause in the end that says 25 this is a step for concealing and you'll never know	Page 29 1 attorney's fees and costs on top of that. 2 The defendants constantly invoke Chapter 119. 3 I think that's applicable. I think that it needs to 4 be applicable in light of this case. I think that 5 there's. Much greater protections that need to be 6 enacted to protect individuals from court systems. 7 But attorney fees are appropriate either under 8 common laws given they admitted bad faith. 9 In my pleadings and during the hearings, I've 10 mentioned multiple times that they did a bait and 11 switch where they said, "These are the records that 12 you want." Made me pay for them. And there's a lot 13 of records I didn't request in there. And then the 14 records that I did request are described in a clause 15 at the end of a motion to stay discovery. 16 So that's as bad faith as a circuit can get in 17 terms of concealing evidence of misconduct that's 18 documented in public records. So, Your Honor, I 19 would ask that you enter an order compelling 20 production within 48 hours and awarding attorney's 21 fees and costs on the matter. Not based on any 22 motion that I've filed, just based upon Rule 2.420 23 and the Florida Constitution Article I, Section 24. 24 THE COURT: Well, Mr. Hanson, thank you for 25 that invitation to do that. But as you indicated,

Page 30 1 we all have rules to follow. And the rules that 2 dictate these court proceedings are not your 3 perception of whether you're correct or your 4 confidence in your position or the vigor with which 5 you assert it. The issues that are before the court 6 are what I'm supposed to address. 7 At past times, you have not been correct on the 8 law. So you'll forgive the court if the court 9 doesn't simply do it because you said so and doesn't 10 simply do it because counsel from the attorney 11 general's office says so. The court will discharge 12 its own independent duty and fulfill its 13 responsibilities to the people -- Florida. 14 MR. HANSON: Excuse me. When was I wrong on 15 the law? 16 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, you could probably go 17 back and read over my orders and find those, but. 18 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I haven't seen 19 anything where I've been wrong in the law and I'd 20 ask for you to support that statement. I think the 21 court has been wrong on the law. 22 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I heard you out and I 23 didn't interrupt you. So I'd appreciate the same 24 courtesy if we're going to proceed under the normal 25 rules for professional conduct in a court of law.	Page 32 1 an in-camera inspection. That's another independent 2 reason why the video is immediately due, is that 3 they have a duty to balance the public interest with 4 the security concerns. 5 And actually a really important concern for the 6 court is whether this security label is just a 7 complete made-up pretext. There's not even an 8 affidavit saying that the video is part of the 9 security system. So there's just no material fact 10 that's at issue in terms of whether they've met 11 their burden of proving some exemption or privilege 12 when there's not even an in-camera inspection. 13 I'm seeking information about who's viewed the 14 video. So if this is going to continue -- and, Your 15 Honor, I'm just baffled at the idea that this can 16 continue longer, given that everyone agrees that 17 there's not any more discovery. The defendants 18 agree that there's no need for more discovery. They 19 haven't even put forth a pleading that introduces a 20 genuine issue of material fact. And they have no 21 more discovery. 22 How is it possible that the court can justify 23 delaying this expedited by rule process further, 24 when they don't have any -- they haven't met their 25 burden under the law? It seems like it's completely
Page 31 1 Thank you. Mr. Hanson, we're here today on motion 2 for protective order to stay discovery, and that is 3 the issue that is in front of the court for the 4 court to decide on. 5 Motion court doesn't make decisions based on 6 unnoticed matters that you seek resolution of 7 without filing of an immediate motion. That is not 8 appropriate. The issue before the court is the one 9 the court intends to rule on. Now, you've had a lot 10 of other things to say. But I didn't want to 11 interrupt you. But I did make a note and want to 12 get back to one of your earliest points, which was 13 that you don't believe that any further discovery is 14 necessary in this proceeding. 15 So I guess that gets me to the question that I 16 noted, which is, are you still seeking this 17 discovery that they are trying to stay? 18 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, if the court is not 19 going to issue an order compelling them to produce 20 the information, then I have to look at it again 21 because I don't think that the court's following law 22 at that point. And yes, I would pursue discovery if 23 the court is going to delay this furthe. It's not 24 the exact same documents I'm seeking. I haven't 25 even learned whether the Thirteenth Circuit has done	Page 33 1 contrary to what the law would require. 2 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, it's slowing me down 3 from getting to a final decision in this case that 4 you are exercising your right to get this discovery. 5 But I want to make sure that if you believe that you 6 have discovery that you want to propound and that 7 you want to litigate and get answers to, then I give 8 you the opportunity to do that. And that's why 9 we're here today. 10 You repeating those same arguments breaks the 11 mind and notion of an old learned trial judge that 12 repetition does not equal proof. I understand your 13 position in these matters. I've heard it several 14 times, and I'm attempting to get this to an 15 expedited conclusion. But you sought discovery. 16 They sought to stop you from having that discovery. 17 And I have this motion in front of me that I'm 18 trying to decide. And so that's where we are today, 19 is trying to come to a conclusion on whether or not 20 you want this discovery. 21 If you don't want this discovery, and we then 22 are ready for a final hearing for the court to take 23 testimony, to review exhibits and arguments and 24 issue a ruling, then let's go. Let's move on with 25 it. If you want the discovery, then I need to

Page 34 1 decide this motion. So that's why I asked you if 2 you are still seeking the discovery, because at an 3 earlier point in today's argument, you indicated to 4 the court that you don't need this discovery, that 5 you're not seeing -- you don't see a point in 6 getting it, and this case is ready. 7 If that's the case, you're withdrawing the 8 discovery -- 9 MR. HANSON: Your Honor -- I'm sorry. 10 THE COURT: Please don't. Thank you. Then we 11 go down a different path towards getting closer to 12 the conclusion. If you want to have this discovery 13 because you don't want to take their word for 14 certain things and you want to gather more 15 information, that may be entirely appropriate. And 16 I want to make sure that your right to get what 17 you're entitled to get isn't compromised in any way, 18 shape or form. 19 But in order to know whether I need to answer 20 that question at all, I need to know whether or not 21 you want this discovery. And I believe your answer 22 to me is that you want this discovery. Is that the 23 answer? 24 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I really need to 25 understand what the court's position is. I don't	Page 36 1 the answer to my question. My question is, do you 2 still want these items that you have requested 3 through discovery? It's you either do want access 4 to those items through the discovery that you've 5 requested, including depositions, or you do not. 6 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I need to know what I 7 still need to prove. I don't know what's lacking in 8 my case. I don't know how I could possibly answer 9 that without having information about the court's 10 position, about the current status of the case. I 11 think the case is over. 12 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I appreciate that you 13 think the case is over. The case is not over. Do 14 you want that discovery, yes or no? 15 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, can you understand 16 that I need to understand why the case isn't over to 17 determine what discovery I need? 18 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I'm not here to teach a 19 law school course on mandamus or give you an 20 explanation until you are completely satisfied with 21 where things stand in every aspect and every realm 22 and every dimension of this case. I can't get to 23 the conclusion of this case, which is where you tell 24 me you want me to get to, until I resolve the 25 discovery dispute that's in front of me.
Page 35 1 understand what's lacking currently. 2 THE COURT: You don't -- I'm sorry. So you 3 don't need to understand what my position is. I 4 don't have a position. I want to make a decision on 5 this motion and on the ability of you to pursue the 6 discovery that you've requested. So you've 7 requested that discovery, and in order to make a 8 decision about whether or not you get that 9 discovery, I need the answer to a question. And 10 that question is, do you still want these matters 11 that you have sought access to through discovery? 12 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I need to understand 13 what the court's position is on the current issue. 14 I don't understand what the case posture is in now. 15 THE COURT: I'm asking you a yes or no question 16 and I expect a yes or no answer so that we can -- 17 hold on, Mr. Hanson. I just need to know whether or 18 not the items that you've requested in discovery 19 that was served on the defendants, do you still want 20 to pursue your discovery? 21 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, respectfully, I can't 22 answer that without understanding the court's basis 23 for not entering an order currently. So it seems to 24 me that the court doesn't have a basis for -- 25 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, Mr. Hanson, that's not	Page 37 1 The discovery dispute in front of me is you 2 have requested discovery because you say you 3 shouldn't have to take their word for it on certain 4 items. They say that, "No, this is a matter to be 5 resolved in a final hearing and discoveries 6 inappropriate under mandamus. Therefore, we're not 7 required to give him that discovery." 8 you still want answers to your questions in 9 discovery that you served under the various Florida 10 rules of civil procedure, then I need to decide 11 whether or not I should grant their motion. If 12 you're not still seeking discovery, then I don't 13 have to answer that question, and then I set a final 14 hearing in this matter. That's where this case 15 stands. That's the best way I can sum it up to you. 16 And it all leads us back to the question that I 17 started with, which is, do you still want this 18 discovery, yes or no? 19 MR. HANSON: For purposes of this hearing, no. 20 I want the court to address the arguments that have 21 been made, given the agreement of all involved, that 22 it's ripe for a decision. And then I'll see what 23 the court's order is. And I can't tell you the 24 future about what my position will be then. If it's 25 going to be delayed months, then I would pursue

Page 38 1 discovery. This isn't a complicated case, Your 2 Honor. 3 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, Mr. Hanson, Mr. Hanson, 4 repetition does not equal proof. You keep telling 5 me it's not a complicated case. I think it is a 6 complicated case. I think there's a lot of 7 important issues that you seek to raise before this 8 court, and they deserve a fair hearing, and they 9 deserve a correct ruling under the law and under the 10 facts. 11 MR. HANSON: Law and facts are a court's 12 concern. 13 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, please don't interrupt 14 me again. I'm trying to help this case get closer 15 to over, and you're interrupting is not helping it. 16 Because when you interrupt, you say the same things, 17 and they don't move us any closer to the finish. If 18 you are not seeking discovery, and you are 19 withdrawing the discovery, then we don't need to 20 continue on any further with a motion for protective 21 order to stay discovery. 22 That does not lead us to a point where, as you 23 say, everybody has agreed that the case is over. 24 That's not where we were at. Everybody else has 25 agreed that it's time for a hearing or that it's	Page 40 1 for the court to explain to Mr. Hanson, his 2 satisfaction, what things are still at issue in this 3 case. 4 So I'm doing what's in front of me. I'll do it 5 correctly, and then I'll move on to the next thing, 6 and I do that correctly. And that's how we get to 7 the correct outcome. So, if you are not requiring 8 any further response from the defendants to your 9 discovery, that will mean that we don't proceed any 10 further on their motion for protective order to stay 11 discovery. It'll be deemed moved at this time, 12 unless the responses for discovery are requested 13 again by the plaintiff. 14 So, that being the status of the case at this 15 point in time, case management-wise, what the court 16 would do is the court would move forward with 17 setting a final here in this matter. There may be 18 the need to take evidence in that matter. The court 19 anticipates that it would be an in-person hearing in 20 the courtroom, here in Pinellas County Justice 21 Center, Courtroom Annex A. 22 I don't know exactly how much time either side 23 may be anticipating, what witnesses you may all want 24 to present or not present, and how much time to set 25 aside. But I certainly don't think it will be
Page 39 1 time for a resolution. I agree it's time for the 2 case to move forward. And this step that would come 3 next is, if you're not seeking discovery any 4 further, then the court is going to set an 5 evidentiary hearing. 6 And those issues, based upon the court's review 7 of your petition and the response, will be to rule 8 on those remaining issues where the court needs to 9 take evidence. That's where we stand. So that I'm 10 clear, and I only want an answer to this question, 11 Mr. Hanson, not anything else you wish to address at 12 this moment because I'm trying to address this 13 motion. So let me make sure that it is clear for 14 our record, you are not, at this time, seeking 15 responses to the discovery that you propounded to 16 these defendants. Is that correct? 17 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I'm not going to 18 withdraw the discovery. But I'm going to -- I'm not 19 getting an answer to what law or facts are still at 20 issue. If the court could give you an answer to 21 that, that would really help. 22 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, that's not what we're 23 here for today. Today I'm here, as the notice of 24 hearing indicates, to have a hearing on motion for 25 protective order to stay discovery. Not a motion	Page 41 1 months for now, especially if all discovery issues 2 are resolved. And I'll have my judicial assistant 3 send out a proposed block of dates so that we can 4 get your final hearing scheduled so that the court 5 can issue a ruling, and this matter can be 6 concluded. 7 I would anticipate probably being able to give 8 you some dates in mid to late May. So, as usual 9 with my scheduling process, I'll have my judicial 10 assistant send out a block of proposed dates to the 11 counsel, and then I will ask you for any 12 unavailability that you have during this time 13 periods. And then we'll get that matter set. 14 If I have other trials that are already on my 15 docket already scheduled, canceled, and they are no 16 longer going to be taking up court time, it may be 17 that I can move you up to an earlier hearing date as 18 schedules permit. But the court does have some 19 trials scheduled in between now and then, as well as 20 some medical appointments that needed to be attended 21 to. And then I'll be able to get you your hearing 22 here. 23 That is where we stand for today. Mr. Hanson, 24 just so that I know what date blocks to look into, 25 do you have any dates that you know are unavailable

Page 42 1 for you in the month of May? 2 MR. HANSON: Well, Your Honor, I still don't 3 have any information about what they're concealing 4 other than confidential and have not been provided 5 in accordance with Florida statutes in this idea of 6 immunity. So if the court is going to refuse to 7 give me any basis in law or fact for not issuing the 8 mandamus today, but just not issue it, then I'm 9 going to pursue all of the discovery. Because I 10 can't wait on this. This is harming me and my 11 family. 12 And despite the fact that the court can't cite 13 any fact or law that supports its opinion, it's just 14 going to push it back to protect insiders. I need 15 some time to depose them. And like I said, I need 16 the discovery. It sounds like the court's not going 17 to issue an order, not going to tell me any factual 18 or legal basis for failing to comply with the 19 expedited requirement in the law. 20 They haven't even identified what they're 21 concealing. This whole procedure is designed to 22 delay and conceal for the powerful insiders. So I'm 23 going to depose everyone that I need to to figure 24 out what records are at issue. I can't go to a 25 final hearing and argue about the records that they	Page 44 1 That's not the process. The process actually laid 2 out is, you file a petition, they file a response 3 after the court conducts an initial review that is 4 only at the prima facie level. After the court 5 conducts a prima facie review and orders that 6 response, they file their response. 7 The court compares the response to the initial 8 pleading. On any issues that are not resolved by 9 the response in the initial pleading, the court then 10 conducts a hearing. I think you will find, if you 11 look through the authorities in this matter, that 12 that is the actual process. And I am trying to 13 schedule that final hearing. If you don't want me 14 to schedule that final hearing so that you can 15 continue to pursue discovery, I will give you the 16 right that you have and allow it to be fully 17 exercised for you to seek discovery. 18 MR. HANSON: The part that you're missing -- 19 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, Mr. Hanson, Please 20 don't interrupt. 21 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I thought you were 22 done. This happened twice where I didn't do it on 23 purpose. 24 THE COURT: Well, then wait a little longer. 25 MR. HANSON: Okay.
Page 43 1 conceal that are confidential and not provided in 2 courts with Florida statutes. The burden is on them 3 to produce an exemption and to go to an actual trial 4 on it. It's going to be trial by ambush because I 5 haven't even had any identification of what the 6 records are. 7 And the lack of any attempt to view the video, 8 lack of any affidavit, all of that needs to be 9 investigated. It doesn't if you follow mandamus 10 procedures. But if the court refuses to do that in 11 order to continue protecting the insiders, I would 12 love it if the court would give me a basis in law, 13 fact, or anything that motivates its opinion or 14 decision to postpone mandamus other than protecting 15 insider judges across the Howard Frankland. 16 And if the court can do that, that might change 17 my position. But it seems to me that's what the 18 court wants to do. And I do need the discovery if 19 that's the court's position. 20 THE COURT: I think, Mr. Hanson, if you read 21 the case law and the precedent interpreting Rule 22 1.630, you would see, and in some of the cases that 23 we've cited in earlier periods, the matter isn't 24 just, you say they violated. They file a response. 25 You say they're wrong. I give you what you want.	Page 45 1 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, until discovery is 2 completed, as you've indicated, you don't want a 3 final hearing. So if you want discovery, I will set 4 the -- I won't set the final hearing. If you want 5 the final hearing, where we resolve these issues, 6 everybody makes their final arguments and the court 7 gives you a ruling, then I will set the final 8 hearing. But you can't eat your cake and have it 9 too. So, do you want to pursue the discovery? 10 MR. HANSON: Yes, sir. I will pursue the 11 discovery if you're going to proceed as you are. 12 But the part that you miss in your analysis is that 13 they have to raise exemptions with evidence creating 14 a genuine issue of material fact. Can the court 15 tell me any place where they've raised any issue of 16 material fact about any exemption? 17 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I'm not here to conduct 18 a lecture or a lesson and tell you how to litigate 19 and evaluate the evidence. We're not at that stage 20 because I'm dealing with your discovery requests. 21 MR. HANSON: No, Your Honor -- 22 THE COURT: Sorry, Mr. Hanson -- 23 MR. HANSON: -- don't need discovery. 24 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, you had told me you 25 don't want discovery. You've told me you do want

Page 46 1 discovery. You've told me you don't want discovery. 2 MR. HANSON: Well, Your Honor, you're just not 3 -- 4 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, we are past the amount 5 of time that I've allotted for this on the schedule. 6 And I have other matters and other hearings that 7 need to be attended to. So, if you'll indulge me, 8 then we can move this to a conclusion for today. Do 9 you want to pursue this discovery? In which case I 10 will need to render a ruling on the motion for 11 protective order. Yes or no? 12 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, if you're not going to 13 issue the -- 14 THE COURT: That's not yes or no, Mr. Hanson. 15 MR. HANSON: I know, Your Honor. 16 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson -- 17 MR. HANSON: But Your Honor, I think that 18 you're a very problematic judge. I don't think you 19 should be on the bench if you can't rule based upon 20 the law and the facts. And you're showing you can't 21 rule based upon the law and facts. You've shown 22 that at multiple hearings. 23 THE COURT: Well, Mr. Hanson, I think -- Mr. 24 Hanson Mr. Hanson, I think I can rule on the law and 25 the facts. I think I've established a long track	Page 48 1 signing an order as I sit here at this very moment 2 in time at 11:09 a.m. on April 13th, 2026, in your 3 favor. 4 But that's not what I am here to do today. 5 What I'm here to do today is make a decision on 6 motion for protective order to stay discovery. In 7 order for me to be able to do that, I need you to 8 tell me whether or not you want that discovery. 9 Then we can move on. So, I need to know, and I need 10 to know whether with a yes or a no, not an 11 explanation, because it's a very simple binary 12 question. And you are in charge of making decisions 13 about your case based on what you know. And this 14 isn't a moment for you to weigh in on your 15 qualifications or your opinions about my 16 performance. 17 I am sure there will be other times to do that. 18 This is for me to be able to rule on motion and 19 schedule for a hearing today. And that motion 20 scheduled for hearing today, is a motion for 21 protective order to stay discovery. So, as the 22 title implies, I need to know whether there's any 23 discovery that needs to be stayed. So, are you 24 still seeking that discovery, Mr. Hanson? 25 MR. HANSON: I think I have to, Your Honor,
Page 47 1 record of being able to rule on the law and the 2 facts. I think, perhaps, if I can offer an 3 observation, it may be that you and opposing counsel 4 disagree on the law and the facts. We have a 5 process for working through that. 6 If the law and the facts were exactly what you 7 said and there were no other possible view of the 8 law and the facts, why would we have an adversarial 9 system? It would just be Mr. Hanson as the judge 10 and he gets to decide the case. But that's not the 11 universe we're in, Mr. Hanson. Mr. Hanson -- 12 MR. HANSON: No, I'm sorry. Go ahead. 13 THE COURT: Thank you. Mr. Hanson, if you want 14 the discovery, you have a right to the discovery. I 15 will make a decision based upon the motion for 16 protective order that is in front of me about 17 whether you can pursue that discovery. That's the 18 decision that's before this court. 19 MR. HANSON: The expedited -- 20 THE COURT: That is the decision, Mr. Hanson, 21 that I'm trying to make. But you, depending on what 22 you think, have told me at different times you want 23 to pursue that discovery or you don't want to pursue 24 that discovery. And then you challenged me to offer 25 you some sort of justification for why I am not	Page 49 1 with the obstruction that I'm getting. There's a 2 constitutional requirement that you expedite these 3 proceedings to avoid the type of harm that I'm 4 suffering. 5 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I am doing my very best 6 to do that. So I am going to take the matter under 7 advisement. I'll issue a ruling this week on this 8 motion for protective order to stay discovery. I 9 will issue it as soon as possible. I will docket it 10 with the Thirteenth Circuit, but I will also send a 11 ruling out to you all directly by email, as a 12 courtesy. And then we can proceed forward. I will 13 also attempt to get some periods of scheduling 14 blocks for you so that I can get the final hearing 15 scheduled as soon as possible. 16 But that will depend, of course, on how long 17 you want to pursue discovery, Mr. Hanson. I want to 18 give you the fullest opportunity to pursue that if 19 you believe it's necessary in order to support your 20 case. So that will be the advisory of the court, 21 that the matter is taken under advisement for 22 further consideration and ruling, which I will 23 attempt to do as soon as possible. Thank you all. 24 MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I would just ask that 25 the court look at its duty to expedite these

Page 50 1 proceedings. That's what the court's duty is. And 2 there's prima facie findings. You're going to do 3 nothing with those. You're going to allow the 4 response to just continue to delay everything. 5 THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, do you understand the 6 difference between prima facie and other burdens of 7 proof in the court system? 8 MR. HANSON: Well, I understand burden 9 shifting. And a prima facie case entitles me to 10 relief absent them showing that there's evidence of 11 an exemption. That's the end of the story. 12 THE COURT: Oh, well, that's the end of the 13 story. Thank you, Mr. Hanson, for letting me know 14 it's the end of the story. 15 MR. HANSON: Well, you tell me, what am I 16 missing, Your Honor? 17 THE COURT: Mr Hanson, you say it's the end of 18 the story and it's the end of the hearing. So thank 19 you -- today. 20 MR. HANSON: Well, what am I missing? You're 21 not following the law on purpose to protect another 22 judge. That's what we've come to in Thirteenth 23 Circuit and in Sixth Circuit. 24 THE COURT: (indiscernible). Thank you 25 everybody for your time today.	Page 52 CERTIFICATE OF DIGITAL REPORTER 1 2 3 I, KATHY WONG, a Digital Reporter for the State of 4 Florida, do hereby certify: 5 6 That the foregoing proceeding hereinbefore set forth 7 was accurately captured with annotations by me during the 8 proceeding. 9 10 I further certify that I am not related to any of 11 the parties to this action by blood or marriage, and that 12 I am in no way interested in the outcome of this matter. 13 14 IN WITNESS THEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand this 15 13th day of April, 2026. 16 17  18 _____ Kathy Wong Digital Reporter 19 20 21 22 23 24 25
Page 51 1 MS. SCHWIETERMAN: Thank you, Your Honor. 2 (Proceedings concluded at 11:12 a.m.) 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25	Page 53 CERTIFICATE OF TRANSCRIPTIONIST 1 2 3 I, DENNIS MURORI, do hereby certify: 4 5 That said audio transcription is a true record 6 as reported by me, a disinterested person. 7 8 I further certify that I am not interested in 9 the outcome of said action, nor connected with, nor 10 related to any of the parties in said action, nor to 11 their respective counsel. 12 13 IN WITNESS THEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand 14 this 1st day of May, 2026. 15 16  17 _____ Dennis Murori 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25

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**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT,
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA — FAMILY LAW DIVISION**

Case No. 2024-DR-001150, Division A

SARAH HANSON v. CHRISTOPHER HANSON

COMPENDIUM VOLUME II

Case No. 2026-CA-010255 Pleadings & Orders (13th Circuit Records Mandamus)

Filed with Respondent/Husband's Request for Judicial Notice — Hearing of May 29, 2026

EXHIBIT 4

Docket 047 — Alternative Writ in Mandamus (Frayman)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-01-13 | 3 pp.

IN THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
CIVIL DIVISION

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually
and as attorney for himself and attorney/
next friend for his minor children,

HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY CCC
Filed: 01/13/2026 14:35:19

Plaintiffs/Petitioners,

v.

Case No.: 25-CA-10255

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA,
JUDGE KELLY AYERS,
JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX,
COURT ADMINISTRATOR GINA JUSTICE,
MIKE MOORE, AND
CLERK OF COURT VICTOR CRIST,

Defendants/Respondents.

ALTERNATIVE WRIT IN MANDAMUS

THIS CAUSE came before the Court on the Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, filed by Plaintiffs/Petitioners on November 13, 2025 (the "Amended Complaint"). Pursuant to Rule 1.630, Fla. R. Civ. P., this Court has conducted a review of the Amended Complaint, as further set forth below, and has determined that certain parts of the Amended Complaint show a prima facie case for relief. As such, the Court directs the Defendants to respond to this writ as provided in Rule 1.140 and as further set forth in this writ.

As an initial matter, this Court finds that it is without jurisdiction pursuant to Fla. R. Gen. Prac. & Jud. Admin. 2.420(l) to determine certain matters raised in the Amended Complaint. That rule provides:

(l) Denial of Access Request for Administrative Records.

Expedited review of denials of access to administrative records of the judicial branch shall be provided through an action for mandamus or other appropriate relief, in the following manner:

(1) When a judge who has denied a request for access to records is the custodian, the action shall be filed in the court having appellate jurisdiction to review the decisions of the judge denying access. Upon order issued by the appellate court, the judge denying access to records shall file a sealed copy of the requested records with the appellate court.

(2) All other actions under this rule shall be filed in the circuit court of the circuit in which such denial of access occurs.

This rule relates to the procedure for review of a denial of access to “administrative records,” defined as “all other records made or received under court rule, law, or ordinance, or in connection with the transaction of official business by any judicial branch entity.” Fla. R. Gen. Prac. & Jud. Admin. 2.420(b)(1)(B). This category of records is contrasted with “court records,” defined as “the contents of the court file, including the progress docket and other similar records generated to document activity in a case, transcripts filed with the clerk, documentary exhibits in the custody of the clerk, and electronic records, videotapes, or stenographic tapes of depositions or other proceedings filed with the clerk, and electronic records, videotapes, or stenographic tapes of court proceedings.” Fla. R. Gen. Prac. & Jud. Admin. 2.420(b)(1)(A).

Pursuant to Rule 2.420(l), to the extent the Amended Complaint seeks review of a denial of an access request for administrative records by one or more of the individual judges who are alleged to be the custodian of such records, this Court lacks jurisdiction to review such claims.¹

¹ This would include any request for “administrative records” sought from Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, and Judge Matthew Felix.

In addition, the Court finds that there is a lack of a prima facie showing for an entitlement to declaratory relief under Chapter 86, Fla. Stat. The procedure to pursue a request for records from the judiciary is clearly set out in the Florida Rules of General Practice and Judicial Administration and the Amended Complaint fails to allege a legal basis for resort to an action for declaratory judgment.

Notwithstanding the above, as the Amended Complaint sets forth an, albeit inartful, prima facie case for relief, the Defendants² shall respond to the Amended Complaint within the time period and otherwise in accordance with Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.140. Upon filing their responses, or upon the expiration of the time for response, the parties shall set a Case Management Conference for the purpose of setting an evidentiary or other hearing to the extent same is required for the court to decide the merits of the case.

DONE AND ORDERED in chambers in Clearwater, Pinellas County, Florida, on this 13th day of January, 2026.



Evan G. Frayman³, Circuit Judge

cc: Counsel and all pro se parties

² All defendants as it relates to the request for “court records” in their custody, and only the non-judicial officer candidates as it relates it “administrative records.”

³ Sitting by special designation as a Judge of the 13th Judicial Circuit per Fla. S. Ct. Assignment Order 2026-40.

EXHIBIT 5

Docket 048 — Case Management Conference Order (Frayman)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-01-13 | 1 pp.

IN THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
CIVIL DIVISION

Case No.: 25-CA-10255

Christopher Hanson,
Petitioner,

v

Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court,
Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella,
Judge Kelly Ayers, Judge Matthew Felix,
Court Administrator Gina Justice,
Mike Moore and Clerk of Court Victor Crist,
Respondent.

HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY CCC
Filed: 01/13/2026 14:35:48

CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE ORDER

THIS CAUSE came on to be heard for a Case Management Conference pursuant to Rule 1.200, Fla. R. Civ. P. After proper notice to the parties, the Plaintiff(s) appeared ☒ self-represented and/or ☐ by/with counsel, _____, Esq., and the Defendant(s) appeared ☐ self-represented and/or ☒ by/with counsel, Jessica Schwieterman, Esq. on behalf of the served Defendants (Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, Court Administrator, Chief Judge Sabella, Judge Ayers, Judge Felix). The Court being advised in the premises, it is **ORDERED** as follows:

The parties appeared for a case management conference before the undersigned. The Court advised that the alternative writ of mandamus was in the final process of being prepared and would issue today. The Court reviewed the alternative writ of mandamus with the parties and offered them the opportunity to ask questions about the procedure going forward. The Court declined to hear argument or any attempt to further "establish a record" as this was not an evidentiary hearing nor a hearing to make any determination on the merits. The Court assured the parties that the record reviewed was thorough and enabled the court to perform its review for the purpose of issuing the alternative writ.

DONE AND ORDERED in Chambers, Clearwater, Pinellas County, Florida this
13th day of January, 2026.



JUDGE EVAN G. FRAYMAN

cc: counsel and pro se parties

EXHIBIT 6

Docket 049 — Motion to Vacate or Disqualify Frayman

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-01-16 | 10 pp.

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY,

FLORIDA CASE NO.: [25-CA-10255]

DIVISION: [B]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], Plaintiffs

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT, et al., Defendants

VERIFIED MOTION TO VACATE, FOR CLARIFICATION, REHEARING, AND ENTRY OF AN ORDER CONSISTENT WITH THE RELIEF REQUESTED IN THE AMENDED PETITION, AND ABSENT IMMEDIATE AND SATISFACTORY RELIEF OR EXPLANATION, DISQUALIFICATION OF JUDGE FRAYMAN FROM THESE PROCEEDINGS

INTRODUCTION

1. Plaintiff submits that the Court misapplied Rule 2.420(l), overlooked the "integrated" nature of the records sought, introduced intentional and unlawful delays, and defied constitutional transparency requirements. All of the Court's actions align with defendants continuing self-preservation mode involving delays, distraction, and burdening the undersigned.
2. Based on the facts, law, and argument herein, Plaintiffs request the Court vacate specific portions of the January 13, 2026, Alternative Writ of Mandamus that dismissed claims for "administrative records" and "declaratory relief" without notice or hearing, for entry of an order consider with Plaintiff's Motion for Immediate Writ (Docket #37), and absent a compelling clarification for the Court's actions based in law and fact and/or satisfactory relief, disqualification of Judge Frayman.
3. The Court's sua sponte assertion, analysis, and determinations on defenses not raised by the defendants, all while literally silencing plaintiff from making a record, raise serious bias and due process concerns.
4. Judge Frayman's sua sponte actions benefitting defendants appears to continue the same very problematic theme throughout the underlying litigation and this public records request process – insider protectionism that's above any obligation to truth or justice.

5. Plaintiff is entitled to a fair process. The rules require it be expedited. Plaintiff requests a hearing on these issues for the Court's earliest available time, and the Court's attention in expediting this process.

A. Background on underlying family law case and prior, more deferential language in arguments requests for relief:

6. Plaintiff recognizes that Judge Frayman does not have information about Plaintiff's core litigation in the family law case and the nightmare that ensued for his family. Plaintiff is willing to make any or all of the evidence in the family law case available to Judge Frayman if relevant to his determinations although will provide a certified statement here as party and officer of the Court.
7. The sole conflict in the family law case in May of 2024 was Plaintiff's insistence on financial discovery related to Wife's income she kept in a separate account and openly concealed from Plaintiff during and after the marriage.
8. Initially, Judge Ayers and Attorney Scott Davis and now others obstructed that simple issue from resolution and now have prolonged unnecessary litigation for nearly 2 years. It's caused significant financial damage to Plaintiff and damaged the overall well being of the family.
9. The obstruction gradually became more about covering up for the attorney and judicial misconduct readily observable in the record. However, the damage to plaintiff and his family is all the same.

B. Plaintiff continued to push for the most efficient path to a fair result, consistent with my obligations as an attorney under the Florida Bar.

10. The Truth is most highest responsibility as an attorney, and I have a duty to speak it, especially when the powerful people around me want it silenced.
11. Plaintiff did not want to spend years of his life in this incredibly stressful situation as evidenced in his pleadings and the good faith he showed in waiving any attorney client privilege in the underlying family law case. He simply wanted the fairness and peace of mind the Florida Family law system and its framers intended.
12. Plaintiff wanted this issue resolved back in 2024, and didn't even want to handle it himself, hiring 2 separate attorneys.
13. Plaintiff's initial comments about the corruption and misconduct he observed were much more deferential in terms of questioning irregularities, inconsistencies, and intent, suggesting that the Court proceed fairly.
14. After over a year of having multiple judicial officials and institutions ignore these concerns, Plaintiff has become more direct and simply wants to put the facts out there for anyone with jurisdiction and authority over the case.

C. Impact on Public Confidence in the Judiciary given delays and Court's unnoticed, sua sponte actions:

15. Judge Frayman's actions in this matter are all consistent with an intent to shield the 13th Circuit from accountability although Plaintiffs are open to any alternative explanations the Court may offer, especially in light of the additional information provided above. .
16. Plaintiff's unrefuted allegations demonstrate a long and concerning pattern of judicial misconduct and a cover up attempts that continue this pattern of expanding judicial misconduct and insider protectionism. The most concerning aspect of all related cases (described at Docket #41), is the consistency with which judicial officials dismiss and provide cover for allegations against fellow insiders. The financial barriers and finding a lawyer willing to expose systemic corruption and judicial misconduct almost universally prevent the type of litigation at issue before this Court.
17. The constitutional mandate on Courts for transparency cannot be ignored in these facts where credible allegations of judicial misconduct exist.
18. Given the obstacles the judiciary has placed to fairness and transparency, it would be impossible for any non-lawyer litigant to get a fair result in Plaintiff's position.
19. No attorneys are willing to take Plaintiff's claim on to oppose the Circuit, the Florida bar, and the JQC, limiting citizen's access to justice given the culture of fear and insider protectionism.
20. It is concerning to consider how often this happens in other cases if the Courts continue to ignore the simple, undisputed facts in front of them in this one.

I. FACTS

21. Plaintiff, a licensed attorney representing himself and his minor children, initiated this mandamus action to enforce fundamental constitutional rights to public records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution. Plaintiff's continuing efforts in the present action and related ones illuminate obvious and severe misconduct the 13th Circuit is working desperately to conceal.
22. Judge Frayman failed to justify the facts and law that support his decision that provides defendant significant assistance, protection and support
23. There are 15 different actions and barriers to constitutional transparency that Judge Frayman's handling of the case already created, all in favor of defendants and in direct conflict with relevant law, constitutional mandates and the basic principles of our judicial system.

A. Procedural Actions Benefitting Defendants and causing delays with no basis in law or fact provided.

Resetting the Responsive Pleading Clock:

24. Despite the Defendants being served with the Amended Petition on December 19, 2025, and filing a formal response on January 8, 2026, the Court's order grants them a fresh 20-day window to respond under Rule 1.140 (offering no factual or legal justification for the "do-over" gifted to the defendants. Defendants didn't even have to allege they needed it.
25. Converting an Expedited Proceeding into a "Slow-Track" Civil Track: While Rule 2.420(l) mandates "expedited review," the Court's order defers the scheduling of an evidentiary hearing until after a future Case Management Conference, effectively stalling the summary nature of the writ.
26. Granting a "Second Bite at the Apple": By resetting deadlines after the Defendants had already failed to refute specific factual allegations of "document dumping" in their January 8 response, the Court provided the defendants an unauthorized opportunity to formulate new theories on a lawsuit Judge Frayman already addressed to limit.
27. Deferring Immediate Production Following a Prima Facie Finding: The Court correctly identified a prima facie case for relief but failed to order the immediate production of any records, despite the presumption in favor of expedited transparency and unrefuted evidence of defendants' misconduct.

B. Sua Sponte Advocacy and Due Process Violations

28. Unilateral Narrowing of Claims Without Notice: The Court sua sponte struck Plaintiff's claims for "administrative records" and "declaratory relief" during the initial assessment phase without providing an opportunity for Plaintiff to present arguments.
29. Acting as Supplemental Defense Counsel: The Court invoked the jurisdictional bifurcation of "administrative" versus "court" records under Rule 2.420(l)—a specific defense the Defendants themselves failed to raise or prioritize in their January 8 opposition.
30. Silencing the Plaintiff at the CMC: During the January 13 conference, the Court declined to hear oral arguments or allow Plaintiff to establish a record, proceeding instead based on its own independent research and findings.
31. Constructing a "Black Box" via Rule 2.420(l): By labeling the individual judges' communications as "administrative" sua sponte, the Court effectively immunized them from discovery at the trial level and diverted core evidence of "clubhouse corruption" to a delayed appellate track.

C. Inconsistency with Constitutional Transparency and Openness

32. Reversing the Constitutional Burden of Proof: Under the "strong presumption of public access" established by the Florida Supreme Court, the burden is on the custodian to justify closure; however, the Court's order forces Plaintiff to justify entitlement (again), and now after the judicial assist tipped what to assert and argue on these second change responsive pleading.
33. Ignoring the "Integrated Record" Exception for Video Evidence: The Court dismissed claims regarding the April 4, 2025, hearing video as "administrative" without considering that Judge Ayers integrated the video into the judicial record by offering it on the record to resolve a dispute about her integrity.
34. Permitting a "Bait and Switch" on Confidentiality: The Court's actions allow the 13th Circuit to continue withholding correspondence they confirmed exists, but have actively and intentionally concealed.
35. Failing to Address Unrefuted Misconduct Admissions: The Court ignored the legal significance of the Defendants' silence regarding specific "document dumping" accusations, which constitutes a tacit admission of bad faith under Fla. Stat. § 90.803(18)(b).

D. Direct Evidence of Bias and Impairment of Fairness

36. Derogatory Labeling of Plaintiff's Work: In its order, the Court gratuitously characterized Plaintiff's Amended Complaint as "inartful," a subjective comment that Plaintiff asserts demonstrates bias against his pursuit of transparency. Judge Frayman is asked to provide clarification on what about Plaintiff's case or work warranted the "inartful" label.
37. Mislabeling Plaintiff's Legal Capacity: Despite Plaintiff appearing in his official capacity as attorney of record for himself and his children, the Court's order repeatedly refers to him as "self-represented" or "pro se," diminishing his professional status on the record.
38. Favoritism Disguised as Procedure: The Court's actions—filling in unasserted defense theories, granting extensions past due dates, with a do over for another bite at the apple—reflect motive based in the insider protectionism culture absent some other explanation from the Court.

III. MOTION TO VACATE AND REHEAR: JURISDICTIONAL ERRORS UNDER RULE 2.420(I)

39. The Court's sua sponte actions at the January 13, 2026 Case Management Conference raise serious due process concerns. Florida law requires that parties be given notice and an opportunity to be heard before adverse rulings are made, especially when constitutional rights and presumptions are implicated. See *Universal Property Casualty Insurance Co. v. Andre*, 4D22-2680, 2024 WL 130123 (Fla. 4th

DCA Jan. 17, 2024) (reversing sua sponte default entered without opportunity to be heard).

40. Here, the Court sua sponte raised defenses not pleaded by Defendants, including the jurisdictional bifurcation of "administrative" versus "court" records under Rule 2.420(l).
41. The Court went beyond simply refusing Plaintiff time for a response – which is in itself violates the fundamental fairness and adversarial principles underlying Florida's judicial system. See *Jones v. Sayer*, 313 So. 3d 126 (Fla. 4th DCA 2021) (trial court may not sua sponte dismiss claims based on affirmative defenses not raised by parties).
42. Here, the Court silenced Plaintiff to prevent a record, actually muting Plaintiff during the hearing.
43. Judge Frayman's actions already tilt the case in favor of Defendants in a manner difficult or even impossible to remedy.
44. For these reasons, the Court's jurisdictional rulings and procedural orders should be vacated and reheard with full opportunity for Plaintiff to respond as the Court should immediately proceed to order production of, at a minimum, all court records which would obviously include the critical April 4, 2025 hearing video and documents relating to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings involving serious due process violations.

IV. THE COURT'S FAILURE TO REQUIRE ANYTHING OF DEFENDANTS NOT ALREADY DUE JANUARY 8, 2026 DESPITE "PRIMA FACIE" CASE AND LACK OF ANY FACTUAL DISPUTE OR LEGAL EXEMPTION

45. In contrast to the above on the Court's sua sponte actions benefitting defendants, Judge Frayman made no findings on plaintiff's prima facie cases, and placed no burden on the defendants to provide any records.
46. Despite the presumption in plaintiff's favor, prima facie cases consistent with the statute, and unrefuted facts demonstrating severe defendant misconduct, the Court acted only in favor of defendants' interests, refusing to require anything of defendants or allow Plaintiff anything against Defendants' interests.
47. Under Florida mandamus procedure, once a plaintiff establishes a prima facie case showing a clear legal right to the records, a ministerial duty of the defendants to produce those records, and the absence of any adequate remedy at law, the court is generally required to issue an alternative writ or order compelling production without delay. The burden then shifts to the defendants to demonstrate a valid legal exemption or justification for withholding the records. See Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.630(d)(2); *Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir.*, 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003); *Grant Stern v. DeSantis*, 1D22-1574 (Fla. 1st DCA 2023).

48. In this case, Plaintiff met the prima facie burden by showing entitlement to judicial records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, supported by unrefuted factual allegations of concealment and bad faith. Defendants failed to meet their burden of demonstrating any valid exemption or justification for withholding the records.
49. Accordingly, the anticipated order under Florida law would be an immediate alternative writ or order compelling production of the requested records, including the critical April 4, 2025 hearing video and communications related to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings. Delays or deferrals to a future case management conference or additional response periods contradict the expedited review mandate and the constitutional presumption favoring disclosure.
50. The Court's failure to do so not only violates procedural due process but also undermines public confidence in the judiciary and perpetuates the concealment of judicial misconduct only prolonging the damage and pain to the family at the center of this petition.
51. This Court moving the goalposts for Judicial accountability farther in the distance to benefit another Court already actively working to conceal the records is an interest of great public concern.
52. Moreover, the Court improperly shifted the burden onto Plaintiff to justify entitlement to records despite the strong constitutional presumption of public access under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution (irrespective of the underlying facts raising serious concerns about insider protectionism in the Court system).
53. The burden is on the custodian to justify closure, not on the requester to prove entitlement. See *Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir.*, 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003).
54. The Court gave no consideration to and refused Plaintiff the opportunity to suggest consideration of why the 13th Circuit is fighting so hard against transparency especially related to the video that a sitting Judge placed in the proceedings during a hearing.
55. Plaintiff offers a reasonable, unrefuted explanation, the Court is unwilling to consider the simple truth in front it.
56. Judge Frayman cites no facts or law in his order that might justify such a procedural gift for the defendants, that directly defies the constitutional presumption of public access to judicial records and Rule 2.420's "expedited process for these actions.
57. In fact, there are no facts (or even factual disputes) in the record that could lead to such a conclusion.
58. The materials Plaintiff and Defendant have filed to date show a long, undisputed history of misconduct involving Judge Ayers' bias and misconduct against plaintiff, with various other judicial officials committing misconduct independently, and in furtherance of attempted cover-ups for Ayers.

59. What other facts are there on which Judge Frayman relied in gifting a do over with an easier assignment (after cutting the claims himself) to the defendants? What basis is there to accept any facts other than those Plaintiff alleged when all the defendants and their counsel failed to refute any of them?
60. Given that the additional time and right to a do over with no obligation to produce anything is inconsistent with the facts and the law, what could Judge Frayman's motivation or basis be, other than precisely the same judicial insider protectionism referenced throughout Plaintiff's filings in this matter.
61. Plaintiff drafted an entire article on the precise problem Judge Frayman's January 13, 2026 hearing conduct and order illuminate – The Florida Legal System's failures in oversight and the current culture where insider protectionism controls over the facts, law, and citizens' access to justice. See Docket #45, p.12 - 40 in the reply which includes the article, "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse: The Perfect Storm for Judicial Accountability."
62. With all due respect to Judge Frayman and still requesting he provide clarification on the factual and legal basis for order, the Court's demeanor with plaintiff and the order appear to fall uniformly in line with what the article suggests about the pervasiveness and power of insider protectionism.
63. The facts and law, up to and including Florida Constitution require expedited action to address the 13th Circuit's public records violations, and Plaintiff pleads for relief in that regard.

V. Conclusion and request for disqualification absent compelling explanation or relief grounded in law and facts:

64. Plaintiff continues to plead with this Court for efficiency and a focus on the relevant facts and law, with the primary goal of finally resolving his family law case.
65. The core objectives of the Courts are truth and justice, neither of which can exist unless the laws apply to everyone, including judges and lawyers.
66. The Florida Constitution's mandate on transparency of judicial records is a safeguard against precisely the type of abuses that pervade the litigation across multiple related trial and appellate cases.
67. The precise issue before all of those courts is whether the system is more committed to truth and justice or protecting insiders from consequences.
68. Plaintiff pleads with the Court for vacating the current order and entry of an order consistent with that demanded in the amended petition for writ of mandamus (Docket #12) and the motion for immediate writ (Docket #37).
69. Absent some compelling justification based in fact and law, the levels of bias and open disdain for Plaintiff on the record and in the order require disqualification for institutional integrity and due process.

70. Disqualification is required when a party has a **"well-founded fear that the judge cannot act impartially or where there is evidence of bias."** (Florida Statute § 38.10 and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.330, which allow a party to seek disqualification if they do not believe they can receive a "fair process").
71. As noted in *Berry v. Berry*, 765 So. 2d 855 (Fla. 5th DCA), it is of 'essential importance' that presiding judges remain free from bias and prejudice.
72. Here, the Court's actions—raising defenses not raised by defendants, sua sponte dismissal of claims without notice, and failing to require anything of defendants not already past due—create an objective, well-founded fear that Petitioner will not receive the fair process guaranteed by law
73. In light of Plaintiff's well-documented history and longstanding concerns over 13th Circuit misconduct, concealment of records, and uniform refusal of relevant judicial institutions to address the simple facts, Judge Frayman's immediate animosity towards Plaintiff raise precisely the same fears Plaintiff keeps finding despite going through proper judicial channels and leadership.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff, Christopher Hanson, individually and as attorney/next friend for his minor children, respectfully requests that this Court:

- A. **VACATE** the portions of the January 13, 2026, Order/Alternative Writ of Mandamus that *sua sponte* dismissed Plaintiff's claims for "administrative records" and "declaratory relief" without notice or a hearing;
- B. **ENTER** an order consistent with the relief requested in the **Amended Petition (Docket #12)** and the **Motion for Immediate Writ (Docket #37)**, including an order compelling the immediate production of the April 4, 2025, hearing video and all records relating to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings;
- C. **PROVIDE** clarification based in fact and law for the Court's *sua sponte* actions, its "inartful" characterization of Plaintiff's work, and the "procedural gifts" granted to the Defendants in light of the circumstances described herein;
- D. **GRANT DISQUALIFICATION** of Judge Frayman from these proceedings if, following the requested clarification and rehearing, Plaintiff remains unsatisfied with his ability to receive a fair and impartial process. Plaintiff asserts that the Court's actions to date—including raising unpled defenses and silencing the Plaintiff—have created an objective, "well-founded fear" that the Court cannot act with the impartiality required by **Florida Statute § 38.10, Rule 2.330**, and *Berry v. Berry*; and
- E. **GRANT** such other and further relief as this Court deems just and proper, including attorney's fees and costs as requested in the Amended Petition

Certification/Declaration:

I, Christopher Hanson, both as plaintiff and plaintiff's attorney, and as an officer of the Court, declare under penalty of perjury that the above is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Certified and executed on January 16, 2026.

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson

cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

FL bar #44094

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal with service via the Portal's e-service system on January 16, 2026.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

EXHIBIT 7

Docket 050 — Order on Motion to Vacate (Frayman self-disqualification)

Filed in Case No. 2026-CA-010255 (13th Jud. Cir.)

2026-01-21 | 2 pp.

IN THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
CIVIL DIVISION

Case No.: 25-CA-10255

Christopher Hanson,
Petitioner,

v

HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY CCC
Filed: 01/21/2026 14:37:24

Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court,
Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella,
Judge Kelly Ayers, Judge Matthew Felix,
Court Administrator Gina Justice,
Mike Moore and Clerk of Court Victor Crist,
Respondents.

**ORDER ON PETITIONER'S VERIFIED MOTION TO VACATE, FOR
CLARIFICATION, REHEARING, AND ENTRY OF AN ORDER CONSISTENT WITH
THE RELIEF REQUESTED IN THE AMENDED PETITION, AND ABSENT
IMMEDIATE AND SATISFACTORY RELIEF OR EXPLANATION,
DISQUALIFICATION OF JUDGE FRAYMAN FROM THESE PROCEEDINGS**

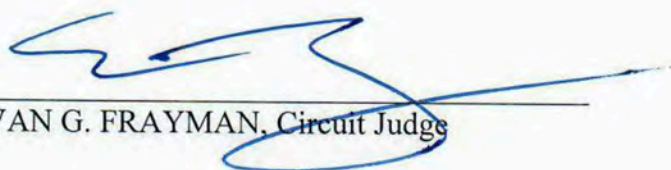
THIS CAUSE came before the Court without a hearing on Petitioner's "Verified Motion to Vacate, for Clarification, Rehearing, and Entry of an Order Consistent with the Relief Requested in the Amended Petition, and Absent Immediate and Satisfactory Relief or Explanation, Disqualification of Judge Frayman from these Proceedings" (the "Motion"), filed on January 16, 2026. The Court having considered the Motion and being otherwise apprised, it is hereby ORDERED as follows:

1. This Order is addressed solely to the alternative relief requested in the Motion, namely the request to disqualify the undersigned.
2. Rule 2.330(h) of the Florida Rules of General Practice and Judicial Administration governs the determination of an initial motion for disqualification and requires that the Court determine only the legal sufficiency of the motion. If the motion is legally sufficient, the Court shall immediately enter an order granting disqualification and

proceed no further. The Rule prohibits the Court from disputing the truth of the facts alleged. As such, an order finding a motion legally sufficient does not constitute acknowledgement that the allegations are true.

THEREFORE, it is **ORDERED** that the Motion is GRANTED, as legally sufficient.

DONE AND ORDERED, in chambers at Clearwater, Pinellas County, Florida this 21st day of January, 2026.



EVAN G. FRAYMAN, Circuit Judge

CC- all parties listed